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INTELLECTUAL HISTORY OF TAMIL NADU

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Intellectual History of Tamil Nadu

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Introduction

According to Thomas Carlyle universal history is nothing but the work of great men. Charlas Oman agreed with this idea and listed the great men, who decided the course of history. Great men naturally bring out changes. In every society the intellectuals have a key role to play. Whether it was a Sangam period or the modern period one cannot under estimate the great role of intellectuals.

The progress of mankind owes much to the contribution of intellectuals. The various institutions such as society, government, religion and marriage are created by the wise guidance of intellectuals over a period of time. Through the life of these great men, we can understand the changes that shaped history. This work is an attempt to briefly explain the life and work of several intellectuals from various field under the title "Intellectual History of Tamil Nadu". Since the Sangam Age the great role played by intellectuals in the development of Tamil Society is analysed in this work. To make the student understand and to follow the role palyed by the great leaders of Tamil Nadu, the subject was introduced in the syllabus.

This work deeply covers the Sangam literature and its growth. Sangam literature like eight anthologies and ten idols are discussed. It also emphasizes the role of eminent poets of Sangam period. This book highlights the socio-religious thoughts of Tamil intellectuals like Vaikunda swamigal, Vallalar, Ayothidasa Pandithar, Bharathiyar and Bharathidasan. It also describes the intellectual contribution of the religious saints like Alwars and Nayanmars, Thirumular, Ramanuja and Veeramamunivar. This work speaks about the emrgence of non-brahmin movement and its role in reforming the Tamil society. It also describes the evolution of Justice Party in the beginning of Twentieth century and the administration of Justice Ministry in Tamil Nadu. In this area, the work of T.M.Nair, Natesa Mudaliyar, Thiagarayachetti and Periyar E.V.Ramasamy are discussed.

BLOCK-I

SANGAM LITERATURE AND ITS GROWTH

Unit- I Intellectuals of Sangam Age

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1.0 Introduction

Sangam Age

The period roughly between the 3rd century B.C. and 3rd century A.D. in South India (the area lying to the south of river Krishna and Tungabhadra) is known as Sangam Period. It has been named after the Sangam academies held during that period that flourished under the royal patronage of the Pandya kings of Madurai.

At the sangams eminent scholars assembled and functioned as the board of censors and the choicest literature was rendered in the nature of anthologies. These literary works were the earliest specimens of Dravidian literature. According to the Tamil legends, there were three Sangams (Academy of Tamil poets) held in the ancient South India popularly called Muchchangam.The First Sangam, is believed to be held at Madurai, attended by gods and legendary sages. No literary work of this Sangam is available.The Second Sangam was held at Kapadapuram, only Tolkappiyam survives from this.

The Third Sangam was also held at Madurai. A few of these Tamil literary works have survived and are a useful sources to reconstruct the history of the Sangam period.

1.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Describe the importance of Sangam Literature
- Explain the types of Sangam Literature
- Understand the role played by the Sangam Poets

1.2 Intellectuals of Sangam Age

The first Sangam was held at southern Madurai or Then Madurai and lasted for 4,400 years. It was supported by the Pandyan kings beginning with Kaychinavaludi and ending with Pandyan Kadumkon. Among them seven kings were poets. 549 poets including Lord Siva, Muruga, Guberan, agasthiyar and Mudinagarayar participated in the deliberations of the Sangam. 4,449 poets presented their composition in the first Sangam including the works like Mudunarai, Kalariyavirai and Mudukurunooru. Agathiyam was the grammar of this Sangam. Due to the erosion of Indian Ocean, Thenmadurai was destroyed. It ended the first Tamil Sangam. Several Tamil works of this period were lost.

The second sangam was held Kapadapuram, located near port Korkai. Among the 59 members of this academy agathiyar, Tolkappiar and Mosikeerenar, Vellurkkappiyanar, Siru Pandurangan, Irundaiyur, Karungoli, Thirayanmaran the king of Dwaraka and Kirandai were important members. This academy lasted for 3,700 years and 3,700 poets presented their work in this academy. Agathiyam, Tolkappiyam, Isainunukkam, Mapuranam and Bodha puranam were used as basic grammar books giving guidelines to other poets. The composition includes Kali, Kurugu and Vijayalamalai Agaval. The second Sangam also declined due to the destruction of Kapadapuram by another sea erosion. Except a fragment of Tolkappiyam several of the works of this period were also lost.

The third Sangam was held at the presnt Madurai. This third Sangam lasted for 1,850 years. Agathiyam and Tolkappiyam were used as grammar. It started during the reign of Mudaththirumaran and it lasted up to the period of Pandiyan Ukkirapperuvaludi. 49 poets including Nakkirar, Senthanputhanar, Perumkundrur Kizhar, Ilamthirumaran and Maruthan

Ilanaganar were the members of third Sangam. Among the 449 works presented Thirukkural, Pathupattu, Ettuthogai were important works accepted by the Sangam. The poems presented were Nedunthogai, Kurunthogai. Aingurunuru, Paditruppattu, Paripadal etc. The third Sangam was attended by a large number of poets who produced voluminous literature but only a few had survived.

1.3 Sangam Literature

For the historians, Sangam literature provides valuable information about the Sangam age. The poets of this period composed a number of works which may be classified in the Ettuthigai, Pathuppattu, and Eighteen minor works or Pathinenkeel kanakku. Like the Greeks, the Tamils provided importance to valour and love, which are adored in Sangam literature that is concerned with both puram and aham. Puram denotes the public matters like government, war, charity, trade, agriculture, etc., and aham to matters strictly limited to love and domestic life. The twin epics or Irattai Kappiyangal Silappathikaram and Manimekalai and Thirukkural were written during this period.

Agathiyam

Sage Agathiyar was regarded as the one who brought the Tamil language from Lord Siva himself. But the theory was challenged by many scholars as an Aryan invasion. He is believed to have written a Tamil grammar Agathiyam. He has twelve disciples including Tolkappiyar. Agathiyam was the basic grammar work for the first Sangam. Agathiyam had concluded to exist and we only hear about its existence from other literary works.

Tholkappiyam

The Tholkappiyam is the oldest available Tamil work on poetics. It is a general treatise on poetry, since it includes akam and puram poetry and deals with the five branches of grammar as well. Tholkappiyam means ancient book. It is generally believed by many scholars that the name comes from 'thol' which is ancient and 'kappiyam' which comes from Sanskrit 'kavya'. However, both Ilampuranar and (12th century A.D.) and Nachinarkiniyar (14th century A.D.), claim that they come from the 'Kappiya' village in which the author was born. U.V. Swaminatha Iyer, recognizes Kappiyakkudi, south-east of Sirkali as the place where

Tholkappiyar was born. Tholkappiyam may be broadly divided into three parts. They are Eluthu (orthography), Sol (Etymology) and Porul (Matter). Tholkappiayam contains 1610 poems under three major divisions. Each division was subdivided into nine subdivisons.

The first part is the book on letters that is Elhuththathikaram, and it deals with phonetics, phonology, graphemics etc. The second part is the book about words that is Sollathikaram, and it is dedicated to etymology, morphology, semantics and syntax. The third part is dealing with the subject matter that is Porulathikaram, and it consists of nine chapters.

Check Your Progress

1. Who wrote Agathiyam?
2. How many athikaram are there in Tholkappiyam?

1.4 The Eight Anthologies – Ettuthokai

Thokai means an anthology. Ettuthokai or the eight anthologies consist of poems divided into two broad categories. Ettuthokai is a collection from Madurai Tamil Sangam.They are Akam (interior) and Puram (exterior king, heroism, battle, ethics and wandering bards and poets).Purananuru and Pathitruppathu are the only two that belong to Puram category.

1. Natrinai: This anthology has 400 poems composed by 175 poets. The poems have 8 to13 lines. In this Natrinai, poem 234 is missing, and only parts of 395 have been recovered. There are 59 references to historical incidents.

2. Kurunthokai: This anthology has 400 poems composed by 205 poets. The poems have 4 to 8 lines. U.V.Swamintha Iyer's edition has added as 401. One poem must have been added later, probably the invocatory poem. There are 27 historical references in Kurunthokai.

3. Ainkurunuru: This is an anthology with 500 short poems, as the title specifies. The poems have 3 to 6 lines. It is prescribed in five sections, each of 100 verses, each dealing with once surface of Akam, Kurinji, Neythal, Marutham, Mullai and Pālai.

Within the main 5 divisions, the poems are sets of 10 with thematic headings as monkeys, boars, peacocks etc. etc. Each set of 10 poems are based on a single topic. It has seventeen historical references. Kapilar

composed the Kurinji poems, Orampokiyar wrote the Marutham poems, Ammoovanar composed the Neythal poems, Peyanar wrote the Mullai poems and Othalanthaiyar composed the palai poems.

4. Pathitruppathu: This has eighty poems and they belong to the Puram category. The name means, 'The ten tens'. It deals with the exploits and achievements of just one dynasty that is the Cheras. It is exclusive in that sense since it is exclusively devoted to the Cheras. The poems have 8 to 56 lines.

5. Paripadal: This is unique among Sangam books, since it has both Akam and Puram poems. It is one of the later anthologies. The collection has 22 poems. The poems have 32 to 140 lines. The topics for the poems are Thirumal, Murukan, and Vaikai River.

6. Kalithokai: Kalithogai has 150 poems in the kali meter, of 12 to 80 lines by 5 poets, each of whom has treated a different Akam theme. S. V. Damodaram Pillai who found these original manuscripts and wrote the commentary for them, believed that the entire book was the work of one poet and that it was written a couple of centuries later than the other books. Also, the prolific Sangam poet Kapilar lived a few centuries earlier than the 'Kapilar' who wrote the Kurinji poems in this collection. Either there are two Kapilars, or the Kurinji poems were erroneously assigned to Kapilar since he was a Kurinji Thinai expert. The poems have 11 to 80 lines.

7. Akananuru: This anthology has 400 poems written by 142 poets. This anthology has also been named 'Nedunthokai Nanuru' since the poems are long. All the poems are in Akam thinai, as the name implies. The poems are from 13 to 31 lines, and they have all grasped us intact. There are 288 historical references.

8. Purananuru: It has 400 poems and they deal with Puram (exterior). These collections were written by both male and female poets. The poems are 4 to 40 lines, and are composed by 156 poets. There were 14 kings, and 15 women among these poets. The female poet Avvaiyar wrote 33 poems. There are a total of 138 poems which praise the 43 kings belonging to the three great dynasties, Chera, Chola and Pandiya. There are 141 poems in praise of 48 chieftain kings, the main ones are Athiyaman Neduman Anji, Vel Pari, Ay Andiran, Pekan, Kumanan, Kari, Nanjil

Valluvan, Pittan Kotran and Elini. There are 121 poems whose heroes are unknown due to missing words, defective colophons, fragmentary nature of the poems etc.

1.5 Ten Idylls - Pathuppattu

It can broadly be classified in to Attruppadai works, Aham and Puram works. Thirumurukatruppadai, Porunaratruppadai, Sirupanatruppadai, Permpanatruppadai and Malaipadukadam belongs to the forst category. Kurinjippattu, Mullaippattu and Pattinappalai comes under Aham while Nedunalvaadai and Madurai Kanchi come under Puram.

1. Thirumurukatruppadai: This song has 317 lines in the Asiriyappa/Akaval meter, and was written by the poet Nakkeerar for Murukan.

2. Porunaratruppadai: This song has 248 lines in Asiriyappa/Akaval meter. It was written by Mudathamakkaniyar. One bard guides another bard to go to King Karikala Chozhan.

3. Sirupanatruppadai: This song has 269 lines in Asiriyappa/Akaval meter, and was written by Nathathanar. One bard guides another bard to go to king Nalliyakōdan.

4. Perumpanatruppadai: This song has 500 lines in Asiriyappa/Akaval meter. It was written by Kadiyalur Urithirankannanar. One bard guides another bard to go to King Thondaiman Ilanthiraiyan.

5. Mullaippattu: This song has 103 lines in Asiriyappa/Akaval meter, and was written by poet Nappoothanar. The king is Thalaiyalankanathu Cheruvendra Neduncheliyan.

6. Mathuraikanchi: This song has 782 lines in the Asiriyappa/Akaval meter, and was written by poet Mangudi Maruthanar, for the Pandiyan king Neduncheliyan.

7. Nedunalvadai: This poem has 188 lines in Asiriyappa/Akaval meter, and was written by poet Nakkeeranar (son of Madurai Kanakkayanar), and the king is unknown. Some scholars speculate that the king is Pandiyan, since there is a description of neem leaves tied to spears.

8. Kurinjippattu: This song has 261 lines in Asiriyappa/Akaval meter and was written by Kapilar for the north Indian king Brahadatha. This song describes the Tamil mountain country, its fauna and flora, and its marriage customs.

9. Pattinappalai: This song has 301 lines. There are 153 lines in Vanji meter and 138 lines in Asiriyappa/Akaval meter. It was written by Kadiyalur Urithirankannanar. The King was Cholan Karikalan.

10. Malaipadukadam (Kootharatruppadai)ïêThis song has 583 lines in the Asiriyappa/Akaval meter, and was composed by Perunkousikanar. One bard guides another bard to go to King Nannan Venman.

Check Your Progress

3. Who wrote Thirumurugatruppadai?
4. Nedunalvadai comes under which category?

The Eighteen Minor Works- Pathinenkeel kanakku

Pathinenkilkanakku comprises eighteen works about principles and morals. The most important among these works is Tirukkural composed by Thiruvalluvar, the Tamil great poet and philosopher. These are small in size and classified to three divisions based on their theme. It represents the old literary tradition on the poems of love and war. While the Sangam tradition treats social life as aham and puram the Pathinenkeel kanakku added aram (moral) and placed it first.

The Pathinenkeel kanakku consists of the following works. 1. Naladiyar 2. Nanmanikadigai 3. Inna Narapathu 4. Iniyavai Narpathu 5. Kar Narpathu 6. Kalavali Narpathu 7. Ainthinai Aimpathu 8. Ainthinai Elupathu 9. Thinaimalai Aimpathu 10. Thinaimalai Nootraimpathu 11. Kainilai 12. Thirukkural 13. Thirikadugam 14 Acharakkovai 15. Palamoli 16. Sirupanchamoolam 17. Muthumolikkanchi 18. Elathi.

The Irattai Kappiyangal

Irattai Kappiyangal means twin literary works. They are Silappathikaram and Manimegalai.

Silappathikaram

Silappathikaram is composed by Ilango Adigal. The story revolves around an anklet. The name literally means the tale of an anklet. Author Ilango Adikal is supposed to be an ascetic-prince and the younger brother of Chera king Senguttuvan. A chief character is Kannagi, who seeks revenge on the Pandya kingdom for her husband who was wrongly put to

death. The poem provides a lot of insight into contemporary Tamil society, polity, values and social life of the people. Silappathigaram helps us to fix the date of the Sangam age. It consists of three kandams, Puhar kandam, Madurai kandam and Vanchi kandam. The first two kandam deal with the life of Kannagi in her mundane existence and last with her as the deity in a shrine. The work started at Puhar. And covers the happenings in Madurai and Vanchi, thus touching the Chola, Pandiya and Chera territories.

Manimekalai

Manimekalai is composed by Seethalai Sathanar. The story is taken from the death of Kannaki and is an outcome of Silappathikaram. It centres round the heroine Manimekalai, the daughter of Kovalan and Madavi. Manimekalai is a poem of thirty books, each containing from fifty to five hundred lines. Propagation of Buddhism seems to be a religious motive of this work. It describes three types of Karpu or chastity (mudal, idai and kadai karpu), the city of Puhar and its destruction, the celebration of Indra Vila for twenty eight days, the brisk trade of the Tamil, etc.

Check Your Progress

5. Who composed Silapathikaram?
6. Which religion was propogated by Manimekalai?

1.6 Sangam Poets

Among the classical works available, 486 poets and poetesses contributed to the literature of the last Sangam. Some of the poets in Sangam age came from urban areas and cities, while most of the authors and poets were mainly from the rural areas and villages. The poets and authors hailed from several professions like soldiers, bullion dealers, blacksmiths, goldsmiths, carpenters, cloth merchants, dispensers, astrologers, teachers, ministers and minstrels. Not just men, but women also became well known as authors and poets during the Sangam era. Few noted poets belonging to the royal lineage also composed famous poems in that period. Some of the distinguished royal kings who became poets in Sangam age were Cholan Nalankilli, Killivalavan, Pandyan Netunceliyan and Kopperun-cholan. They also contributed for literature. Ukkirapperuvaluthi was a Pandya ruler and an accomplished poet. It was in his days that Thiruvalluvar composed his Thirukkural and submitted it for

the approval of the Sangam. Due to his encouragement the Ahananuru verses were compiled in to a collection. He was praised by avvaiyar. He is credited with two verses, aham, and Narrinai.

There were poets belonging to different religious faiths. Damodanar was a Vaishnavite, Ilampodiyar a Buddhist and Ulochanar a Jain. But most of them were Saivites.

The Sangam society respected womenhood. Though the type of education given to them was different from that of men, they shined in different fields. There were women poets too from the royal family down to the ordinary folk. While Koperumpendu and Pari Mahalir were of the royal family, Venikuatiyar, Avvaiyar, Velli Veedhiyar, Kuramakal and Ilaveyini were commoners. Thirty two women poets are said to have sung poems in this period. Their works can be traced from the four anthologies, Ahananuru, Kurunthogai, Narrinai and Purananuru.

The poets commanded respect at the court and the society. Kapilar, Avvaiyar and Paranar enjoyed the patronage of the rulers, and played the role of ambassadors. They gave advice to the rulers pointed out the heavy burden of taxation, averted wars, and guided the rulers to take the right path. One can understand the valor of Sangam women from their work. It covers all the aspects of human feelings and the versatile nature of these gifted poets. Naturally education and intellectual attainments were not restricted to any privileged group. It also reflected the values women respected during Sangam age.

1.7 Answers to check your progress questions

1. Agathiyar
2. Three
3. Nakkirar
4. Puram
5. Ilanko Adigal
6. Buddhism

1.8 Summary

- The period roughly between the 3rd century B.C. and 3rd century A.D. in South India is known as Sangam period.
- The first Sangam was held at Southern Madurai or Then Madurai and lasted for 4,400 years.

- The second sangam was held Kapadapuram, located near port Korkai.
- The third Sangam was held at the presnt Madurai. This third Sangam lasted for 1,850 years.
- Sangam literature provides valuable information about the Sangam age.
- The Tholkappiyam is the oldest available Tamil work on poetics.
- The eight anthologies or Ettuthogai consist of poems divided into two broad categories – Akam (interior) and Puram (exterior).
- Ten Idylls or Pathuppattu is a collection of ten long poems.
- Pathinenkilkanakku as suggested by the title, is a collection of eighteen works.
- Irattai Kappiyangal means twin literary works. There are Silappathikaram and Manimekalai.
- The poets of the Sangam age were drawn from all sections of the society.
- Women poetesses also contributed in the Sangam period.
- Thirty two women poets are said to have sung poems in this period.

1.9 Key words

- Sangam : The Sangam means an 'association'. Here, it refers to Tamil Sangam, an association of Tamil poets, which flourished in ancient history of South India.
- Athikaram : part or chapter of poem or prose.
- Idyll : a poem or prose work describing an idealized rural life, pastoral scenes, etc
- Anthology : An anthology is defined as a book that has a large collection of writings in similar form, from a similar time, or about a similar subject manner, but by various authors.

1.10 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. Write a note on Tholkappiyam
2. What do you know about Eight Anthologies?
3. What are the features of Twin Epics?

Long Answer Questions

1. Give an account of the Sangam literature.
2. Describethe contribution of the Sangam intellectuals.

1.11 Further Readings

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Unit-II Thiruvalluvar-Avvaiyar-Tholkappiyar

2.0 Introduction
2.1 Objectives
2.2 Thiruvalluvar
2.3 Avvaiyar
2.4 Tholkappiyar
2.5 Answers to check your progress questions
2.6 Summary
2.7 Key words
2.8 Self Assessment Questions
2.9 Further Readings

2. 0 Introduction

The history of the Tamils instigates with the Sangam age. The word Sangam is not revealed in any of the literary works of that age. It was first used by Tirunavukkarasu in his Devaram hymns in 7th century A.D. However, the word Sangam is frequently stated in the commentary on the Iraiyanar Ahapporul of the 8th century A.D. According to the Iraiyanar Ahapporul the Pandya rulers established three Sangams, the First Sangam, Middle Sangam and Last Sangam. The sangam poets were great scholars. The Iraiyanar Ahaporul Urai mentions the number of Sangam poets as 449, and they belongs to different classes. It indicates the popularity of education. Thiruvalluvar, Avvaiyar and Tholkappiyar were prominet scholars among the Sangam poets. Normally during the early period, education and mastery over poetry were limited to certain sections of society. But in Sangam period education might have available to almost all sections of society without ant discrimination.

2.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Discuss the role of Thiruvalluvar to Sangam Literature
- Assess the contribution of Avvaiyar
- Describe the work of Tholkappiyar

2.2 Thiruvalluvar

The Thirukkural was written by Thiruvalluvar consists of 1330 verses, divided equally into 133 chapters. Thirukkural is the greatest contribution of Thiruvalluvar not only to the Tamil society but also to the whole world. Thirukkural is unanimously celebrated as the greatest Tamil classic. Although numerous stories are available on the life of Thiruvalluvar tradition relates his birth at Mylapore in the present day Chennai city or in ThirunayanarKuruchi, a village in Kanyakumari District of Tamil Nadu. He was regarded as a petty official of the state. Eventhough weaving is attributed to his profession we have no evidence in this regard from his masterpiece. There were several stories exist about Valluvar and his wife Vasuki. They were regarded as a couple made for each other. The chestit and virtuous nature of Vasuki besides her dedication to Thiruvaluvar were stories passed on from generation to generation without any trace of authenticity. Thiruvalluvar is thought to have lived sometime between the 3rd century BC and the 1st century BC. The Tamil poet Mamulanar of the Sangam period mentioned that Thiruvalluvar was the greatest Tamil scholar. Thiruvalluvar is thought to have lived sometime between the 3rd century BC and the 1st century BC. The Tamil poet Mamulanar of the Sangam period mentioned that Thiruvalluvar was the greatest Tamil scholar. After analyzing various theories one may safely assume that he may lived around 200 A.D.

He was probably a Jain ascetic of humble origins who worked as a weaver. Both Buddhists and Shaivites, however, claim him as their own, and he is especially revered by those of low caste. According to Jain tradition the author of Thirukkural was a Jain named Kunda Kundacarya. The term ‘Valluvar prefers to such a community. They were public drummers of the state. While there are various claims as to who Tiruvalluvar was-a Jain, Whoever he was his thoughts have been addressing universal values. Jains claim that he might have been influenced at least with the tenets of Jainism, Ahimsa, Asteya, Aparigraha. But these tenets are themself drawn from yogic concept developed by rishis and munis and hence cannot be narrowed down to a subsect, of universal philosophies.

Though many writers including Vaiyapuri pillai a great commentator, regarded Thiruvalluvar as a Jain, Dr.schweitzer contradicted the argument. He places several points for his arguments. While the Jain way of life is a total nagayion of society. Thiruvalluvar's work describes the full enjoyment of life in its totality. His vivid description of the beauty of women in the third part of the book again stressed the point that it might not be written by a Jain ascetic. From the legend it was understood that he was a householder, who enjoyed the family life with his dedicated wife Vasuki.

Thirukkural

Thirukkural is the masterpiece of Tamil literature with the utmost and purest terminologies of human thought. Thirukkural was written by Thiruvalluvar, who is supposed to have born 30 years before Jesus Christ. The Tamil Calendar is dated from that period and mentioned as Thiruvalluvar Aandu (Year). It is written in the form of verses clarifying various parts of life. It comprises 1330 stanzas, divided into 133 chapters of 10 stanzas each.

Thiruvalluvar's idea revolves around the thinking that one should gather wealth to lead a purposeful life, and enjoy the domestic life to the fullest possible way. After that one can renounce life and surrendered to God to end the chain of endless births. It stresses a universal code of morals in the three divisons on right contuct, the science of politics and wealth and love. Thirukkural's immortality and universality are indisputable. Its morals and values are appropriate to all religions, countries and time. It has been translated in over sixty languages of the world. The first four chapters were introductory on God, Rain, Virtue and Ascetics while the next sixteen chapters deals with the ideal householder. The remaining chapters in the forst book described the ideal ascetic and how grace is an essential component for an ascetic of high order. In the second book, the Royalty is described in twenty five chapters and Thiruvalluvar portrayed the ideal sovereign in it. While the ideal statesman or ministers of state were explained in ten chapters and another twenty two chapters deals with an ideal state. The remaining thirteen chapters in this book describe the ideal citizen dreamed by Thiruvalluvar. The twenty five chapters in the third book on love portrayed the ideal lover and the enjoyment of lovers before

their wedding. Naturally it ended with the wedded life. The effect of love and lust on men and women, its varied moods were portrayed with human touch.

Translations

The Thirukkural, considered equivalent to the Vedas of the Hindu scriptures, has been widely translated both in Indian and European Languages and is among the oldest literary works of the world. Researchers have traced the age of this work to 300 BC. Nearly two hundred years ago, the famous Jesuit missionary Constantius Beschi, who lived in Tamil Nadu for 42 years, translated the first two parts of the works into Latin. Rev. G.U. Pope, who hailed Thiruvalluvar as "The Bard of Universal Man" printed this. Dr. Graul used the manuscript of Beschi for his translation of Thirukkural into German as well as Latin. The English translation done in the early twentieth century was by the great freedom fighter and patriot Late Sri V.V.S. Iyer who lived between 1881 and 1925. Selected couplets have been translated in English by the well-known freedom fighter and statesman, late Sri C. Rajagopalachari. In recent years, a full English translation is published by the M.P.Birla Foundation in 1988.

Muppal

Thiruvalluvar called his work s 'Muppal'. It deals with the object of aram, porul, inbam. Ten commentaries have been written on it by medieval scholars. No other work of Tamil literature has been translated into so many languages as the Thirukkural. It is the first book in Tamil to open with an invocation to God. Thiruvalluvar never mentioned any name of the creator but only refers to "Him".The first book deals about the moral values like chastity and education. The second book deals with polity and administration. He compared the king with rain. "the world flourishes, looking up to the sky for rain, so citizens look up to the kings scepter for production. The third book on "Inbam" deals with love themes. No one explained love like Valluvar. Dr.G.U.Pope viewed it as an unparalleled work in any language.

According to Vaiyapuri Pillai " The utter simplicity of his language, his crystal clear utterances,precise and forceful, his brevity, his learning, culture and wisdom, his catholicity and eclecticism, his gentle humour and wholesome counsel have made him an object of veneration

for all time and his book is considered the Veda of the Tamils". It is a great tribute to Thiruvalluvar that almost all sects in Tamil Nadu claim him as its own. It is because he went through the life with a pure mind without any prejudices In Tamil Nadu, efforts were made to popularize Thirukkural. The Valluvar Kottam and the 133 feet statue of Thiruvalluvar at Cape Comerin are some attempts in this direction. Thirukkural is also a part of the curriculum in schools and colleges. Nearly after the passage of two thousand years, its message is fully relevant today. The government of Tamil Nadu also allocated fund to promote Thirukkural among the masses.

2.3 Avvaiyar

Tamil women are great poetesses, temple builders and social reformers. The term Avvai is a significant term and means on old lady, a esteemed and aged matron. Tradition says that this accomplished poetess led, a life of peace and happiness living as a spinster throughout her life. At least there is no evidence to show that she was ever married. From her girlhood she seems to have devoted her full attention to deep study and high thinking with its necessary accompaniment of plain living according to such standards as then obtained. Her writings are varied and many, scattered throughout the voluminous pages of Narrinai, Kurunthogai, Purananuru and Ahananuru.

. Scholars think that six women known as Avvai lived in Tamil Nadu. But linguistically speaking, we can see at least four Avvais clearly. The earliest mention of Auvaiyar occurs in 2nd century B.C.Then the other avvaiyar lived in the 8th century.Again, we come across her poems in the 12th century and finally in the 14 to15th century. The language of the poems draws a clear cut line.

The most famous Avvai existed during Sangam age i.e. 2000 years ago. She was well versed in Tamil and bold enough to challenge and advise the mighty Tamil kings. But she was respected by one and all. The Tamils were fighting among themselves from the very beginning of history. The longest infighting race in the world. Avvai was bold enough to advise them to stop fighting.

Avvaiyar and Athiyaman

Avvaiyar, a poet and friend of King Adhiyaman, ruler of Tagadur, is supposed to have helped avoid war between two kingdom states. King Thondaiman, ruler of Kanchipuram, had sent him a note declaring his intention to attack Tagadur. Adhiyaman requested Avvaiyar to visit Kanchipuram and tell Thondaiman that this war would bring him nothing. She was using a nice bit of psychology here. She says "Oh Thondiaman, how different indeed are your clean and shiny weapons from those of Adiyaman, always stained with blood and under repair." Thondaiman had far less experience in war and was unlikely to win. She was making this clear under the guise of praise. She was actually advising the young king to avoid a needless war in which he was bound to lose. The song follows the grammar of Tamil called as "Vanja Pugazhchi Ani" means, treachery hidden under praise.

She was in the court of Neduman Anji, the Adhiyaman Chief of Tagadur (Dharmapuri). He held her in high esteem and even gave her the Nelli (amla) with rare medical properties. She composed many poems on the generosity of Adhiyaman. For vigour and depth of feeling her odes to Adhiyaman are second to none in the Purananuru collections. She wrote 59 poems in Purananuru. After his death perhaps as the result of a mortal wound received in a battle, referred to by the poetess in Puram, sorrow completely clouded her heart. She sorrowed the loss of her warm and generous patron who esteemed her at once for her wide scholarship and skill. She left the place in great sorrow, wandered far and wide in the Tamil Nadu, Avvai took her themes from life in the palace and in the country farm.

Literary Works

The Sangam Avvai composed 59 songs which mostly deal with love and the pain of separation. Avvaiyar thus enjoyed great repute in all the Courts of the then kings in the Tamil land. Her poems simple but full of lofty maxims and practical wisdom caught the popular mind and she became thus a friend of the masses. The other Auvaiyar was a contemporary of Kampan and Ottak Kutthar has composed four ethical works. They are Aathichudi, Kondrai Vendhan, Vaakkundaam (Moodurai) and Nalvazhi. She wrote many of the poems that remain very popular even

now.These poems include a list of dos and don'ts, useful for daily life, arranged in simple and short sentences.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. Thirukkural have howmany chapters?
2. Which book of Thirukkural deals love themes ?
3. Who patronized avvaiyar?
4. What was the period of Sangam age Avvaiyar?

2.4 Tholkappiyar

Tholkappiyar is the author of Tholkappiyam, the oldest Tamil grammar. The work is based on agathiyam, an earlier grammar. According to tradition his parents named him Thiranathoomakkini. He was considered as the son of Jamathakkini of Brahmin origin. He was regarded as one of the twelve disciples of Agathiyar. The speciality of Tholkappiyam, the ancient Tamil grammar is that it deals not only with phonetics and prosody, but also of poetry. It formulated rules for the different types of poetic composition. Dr.Caldwell argued that Tholkappiyam must have been preceded by many centuries of rich literary tradition.

The dating of the earliest Tamil grammatical treatise Tolkappiyam has been debated much and it is still imprecise and uncertain and has seen wide disagreements amongst scholars in the field. It has been dated variously between 3rd century BCE and the 3rd century CE.

Tholkappiyam

The Tolkappiyam is a work on the grammar of the Tamil language and the earliest extant work of Tamil literature and linguistics. It is written in the form of noorpaa or short formulaic compositions and comprises three books. They are, the Eluttadikaram, the Solladikaram and the Poruladikaram. Each of these books is further divided into nine chapters each. While the exact date of the work is not known, based on linguistic and other evidence, it has been dated variously between the third century BC and the 10th century BC. Some modern scholars prefer to date it not as a single entity but in parts or layers. There is also no firm evidence to assign the authorship of this treatise to any one author.

Eluthathikaram deals with Eluthu or letters or deals with orthography including phonology. Sollathikaram deals with morphology or forms of words and Syntax. Porulathikaram is concerned with aham, puram, prosody, poetics and social conventions. The Tolkappiyam classifies the Tamil language into sentamil and koduntamil. The former refers to the classical Tamil used almost exclusively in literary works and the latter refers to the dialectal Tamil, spoken by the people in the various regions of ancientTamilagam.Tolkappiyam categorises alphabet into consonants and vowels by analysing the syllables. It grammatises the use of words and syntaxes and moves into higher modes of language analysis. The Tolkappiyam formulated thirty phonemes and three dependent sounds for Tamil.

Eluththathigaram

Eluththathigaaram is further subdivided into the following 9 sections. They are nool marabu, mozhi marabu, pirappiyal, punariyal, thokai marabu, urubiyal, uyir mayangial, pulli mayangial and the kutriyalukarappunariyal.

Sollathigaram

Sollathigaaram deals with words and parts of speech. It classifies Tamil words into four categories .They are iyar chol (words in common usage), thiri chol (words used in Tamil literature), vada chol (words borrowed from Sanskrit), thisai chol (words borrowed from other languages. There are certain rules to be adhered to in borrowing words from Sanskrit. The borrowed words need to strictly conform to the Tamil phonetic system and be written in the Tamil script.

The chapter Sollathigaaram is subdivided into the following 9 sections. They are, kilaviyaakkam, vetrumaiyiyal, vetrumaimayangial, vilimarabu, peyariyal, vinaiyiyal, Idaiyiyal, uriyiyal and the echchaviyal.

Porulathigaram

The Porulathigaaram gives the classification of land types, and seasons and defines modes of life for each of the combinations of land types and seasons for different kinds of people. This chapter is subdivided into the following nine sections, akaththinaiyiyal, puraththinaiyiyal, kalaviyal, karpiyal, poruliyal, meyppaattiyal, uvamayiyal, seyyuliyal and the marabiyal.

Features of Tholkappiyam

Grammar and literature determines the specialty of any language. The literary tradition of Tamil language highlights the achievement of Tamil society. The first important Tamil literary work belongs to Tholkappiyar. It is also an important treatise on grammar. It represented the culture and life style of early Tamil society. The period ascribed to Tholkappiaya was roughly three thoysands years from today. Tholkappiyar divided the life of people into aham and Puram. The inner life is termed as ahathinai and the outer life is termed as Purathinai. The love and affection exhibited by husband and wife is inner life or aham. It was classified into Ainthinai (five thinais) Kaikilai and Perumthinai.

Ainthinai represents love and lust. But Kaikilai refered to one-sided lust where love has no place at all. Perumthinai is related to improper lust (Kamam). Tholkappiyar identified the five physiographical divisions of the Tamil land suitable for each thinai. Kalavu refers to the relationship between the hero and heroine without the knowledge of the society. It was a secret affair, known only to the lovers. Karpu refers to the marriage life known to the society. If a men or women wedded due to circumstances, without any trace of love and affection, the life they are leading is termed as Perumthinai. If one partner is superior than the other in wisdom, wealth and in beauty that is referred to as improper life.

In the puram category, besides war, other aspects such as valor, generosity and virtue of rulers and patrons are presented. Tholkappiyar highlighted the cultural life of ancient Tamil society. The four fold divisions of the society based on occupation were stressed. People worshipped nature as well as the God in accordance with the nature of the land. Though different Gods were worshipped they have understood that all Gods are one. Soldiers killed in the battlefield were also repected and worshipped. A stone was installed at the palce of burial and it was a symbol of worship. The Tamils believed in fate and in divine will. Polygamy was practiced. The full life lived by the people is reflected in the systematic work of Tholkappiyar. The life of Tamil community was presented before us by Tholkappiyam.

Check your progress questions

5. Which is the oldest Tamil literature?
6. How many parts are there in Tholkappiyam?

2.5 Answers to check your progress questions

1. 133
2. Third book- Inbam
3. Athiyaman
4. 2nd century B.C.
5. Tholkappiyam
6. Three

2.6. Summary

- The sangam poets were great scholars
- The Thirukkural was written by Thiruvalluvar consists of 1330 couplets, divided equally into 133 chapters.
- Thirukkural has three major parts. The first part deals with Aram(Virtue).
- The second part is on Porul (Wealth).
- The third part is on Kamam or Inbam (Love).
- Avvaiyar, a poet and friend of King Adhiyaman, ruler of Tagadur.\
- The Sangam Avvai composed 59 songs which mostly deal with love and the pain of separation.
- Avvaiyar has composed four ethical works – Aathichudi, Kondrai Vendhan, Vaakkundaam (Moodurai) and Nalvazhi.
- Tholkappiyar is the author of Tholkappiyam, the oldest Tamil grammar.
- It comprises three books – the Eluthathikaram, the Sollathikaram and the Porulathikaram.
- Tholkappiyar divided the life of people into aham and Puram.
- The full life lived by the people is reflected in the systematic work of Tholkappiyar.

2.7 Key words

- Aram : Aram means discipline, how to perform an act with integrity, what are the values in life, importance of good conduct everything comes in Aram.

- Muppal : Three kinds of subjects of Thirukkural
- Iyar chol : The words in common usage
- Vada chol : Words borrowed from Sanskrit

2.8 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. Highlight the importance of Aram in Thirukkural.
2. What are the works of Avvaiyar?
3. Write briefly about the Sollathikaram of Tholkappiyam.

Long Answer Questions

1. Describe the place of Thiruvalluvar among the intellectuals of Tamil society.
2. Analyze the features of Tholkappiyam.

2.9 Further Readings

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Unit III Elango Adigal

3.0 Introduction
3.1 Objectives
3.2 Conversion of Elango Adigal
3.3 His Religion
3.4 Social and Political Thoughts
3.5 Answers to check your progress questions
3.6 Summary
3.7 Key words
3.8 Self Assessment Questions
3.9 Further Readings

3. 0 Introduction

Elanko Adigal is the celebrated author of the Silappathikaram belonging to the category of the grea Epics. He was not the ordinary bard wandering from court to court singing miscellaneous verses now in honour of this prince and then in honour of that. Elanko was the son of a king. He was the second son of king. Cheralatan reigning in the city of Vanji (Karuvur), the capital of the then Cheranadu and the younger brother of the famous king Cheran Senguttuvan. On this account he was called Ilanko or the younger prince and he was known as Elanko adigal after his renunciation of royalty and assumption of holy orders.

3.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Explain the early life of Elanko Adigal
- Understand his conversion from prince to ascetic
- Discuss the features of Silappathikaram
- Describe the socio and political thought of Elanko Adigal.
- Understand the impact of Silappathikaram in Tamil Society

3.2 Conversion of Elango Adigal

This young prince coming from such a distinguished family connected with the Cholas by marriage alliances, gave up the joys of life in the palace even when comparatively young and became an ascetic. It would be interesting here to narrate why and how he turned out to be a

monk. There once came to the Court of Cheralathan an astrologer who predicted the immediate death of the king and the passing of the throne to Elanko, the younger son. This was uttered in the presence of both the royal princes.

The elder received the news with great disappointment and the younger noticing his brother's sorrow wanted to get rid of the stumbling block which was himself. Hence he at once took to a life of asceticism, renouncing worldly pleasures in order to satisfy his brother's hopes and aspirations. Having thus assumed the role of what we would call a Sannyasin, Ilanko thought it improper to live in the palace in the midst of his kith and kin. So he left the palace and took up his residence without the city gates in the temple of Gunavayir-Kottam on the eastern side of the Capital, devoting his whole life to art and literature. And no wonder his secluded life afforded him a good opportunity and paved the way for his becoming an accomplished scholar as is clearly seen from this great epic.

When his scholarship had reached such a high state of perfection that he considered himself competent to write out a classical work, he took the theme and the plot from real life. Unlike other poets of his age who looked for patronage to a king, Elanko confined himself to writing an epic. Probably he conceived at first the plan of writing two works, the Silappathikaram and the Manimekalai. Learning, however, from his friend and companion Kulavanikan Sattanar that he had taken up the Manimekalai and even completed it, he gave up his original idea. From this it would appear that Elanko was in constant touch with the scholars and writers of the day. He advised them and was advised by them in turn. In this way it is evident that Elanko spent his days in the monastery.

3.3 His Religion

It is equally interesting to examine what was his religion and the age when he might have probably lived. As to his religion there are conflicting opinions. Mr. Kanakasabai has written that Elanko adigal became a monk of the Nigrantha sect. The view that he was a Jain and belonged to Jainism is supported by the fact that he has elaborately referred to Jainism, its tenets and institutes. Further he was called Adigal. Again the great commentator Adiyarkkunallar interprets Kottam in the line as Anukan koil which is generally the name given to Jain temples.

Against this it may be .argued that the title Adigal is common to all sects of the Hindus, and Kottam may mean any temple not necessarily the Jain temple. Pandit Swaminatha Ayyar favours the view that Saivism was his religion. He quotes several texts from the work to show that both Senguttuvan and his brother must have been Saivaites only. Wherever deities are mentioned, God Siva is given the foremost place. Again he says that his brother Senguttuvan's birth is due to the grace of Siva. These bear unmistakable testimony to the fact that their religion must have been Saivism. There are again elaborate references to legends gathered round Visnu in regard to his avatar and other heroic deeds.

The fact that Senguttuvan offered worship to both Siva and Visnu before his military expedition would bear the weight of testimony to conclude that the monarch was not necessarily a Saivaite but a tolerant Hindu. But to conclude that he was a Jain from the mere fact that he elaborately treats of Jainism in his work is unconvincing. It may be that the wave of Jainism was spreading wide in his time and that a poet who was engaged in narrating contemporary facts could not but refer more than once to one and the same thing. What is remarkable is the author's tolerant attitude to the other sects in the land of his birth.

Silappathikaram

The Silappathikaram consists of three Kandams. They are, Puhar kandam, Madurai kandam and Vanchi kandam. The first two kandams deal with the life of Kannagi in her mundane existence and the last with her as the deity in a shrine. This is the earliest work to employ varipattu in its composition. The Silappathikaram helps us to fix the date of the Sangam age. The Urai Peru Katturai states that Gajabahu of Ceylon was present at the consecration of Kannagi's image constructed by Senguttuvan.

The Ceylonese Chronicle, the Mahavamsa, states that Gajabahu I ruled Ceylon roughly between 171 to 196 A.D. Since Senguttuvan was the contemporary of Gajabahu, the period of the reign of Senguttuvan is fixed as the second half of the second century A.D. The Silappathikaram describes the significance of chastity, the fertility of the Kaveri river basin and the social and cultural condition etc.

The Story as contained in the Epic

The story contained in the epic is simple and is as follows. In Kaverippumpattinam, the capital of the Cholas, there lived a wealthy merchant named Masattuvan. He had a son Kovalan to whom was married a virtuous and devoted lady Kannaki by name, the daughter of Manaikan. Being a wealthy young man Kovalan moved in high social circles and took an active interest in the amusements of the day. Once his eyes fell on a beautiful young dancing girl Madavi by name, on whom he directed his love. He wasted all his wealth and money on this dancing girl and did not care for his devoted wife.

When at last he had lost all his riches, he thought that Madavi's love towards him had cooled and he became disgusted. Returning home he realized his past mistakes and resolved on .a commercial career. The same night he left for Madura with his wife Kannaki. He had nothing to fall back upon except her jewels. She placed one of her costly jewels (Silambu-anklet) ungrudgingly and willingly at his disposal. He took it to the market there to effect a sale. As misfortune would have it, he was arrested .as a thief of the royal jewels.

The king without inquiring into the facts of the case impatiently ordered his execution. It was done. Poor Kannaki, when she came to know of this, became bewildered as it were. She went before the king and proved his innocence beyond the shadow of a doubt. The Pandyan King Nedunjeliyan realized his guilt and could not bear it. He fell down from his seat brokenhearted and died immediately. Still Kannaki could not control herself and in a fit of great anger cursed that the whole city be consumed by flames. And so it happened, Kannaki then proceeded westward to the Malainadu and continued to do penance at the foot of a Vengai tree in the Neduvelkunram, a hill near Kodungolur according to Adiyarkkunallar .

Check Your Progress Questions

1. Who was the brother of Elanko Adigal?
2. Which Pandya king punished Kovalan?

3.4 Social and Political Thoughts

The work is an epic for the three ruling dynasties of Tamil Nadu. The joy and aspirations of the lower classes are also broughtout vividly in

this work. Thirukkural, Silappathikaram and Kaba Ramayanam are considered to be the choicest products of Tamil literature. Another notable feature is the respect shown by Elanko Adigal to all religious beliefs. It is a unique work and perhaps the only tragedy in Tamil literary History. Since the work quotes Kural, its age can only be later than that of Kural. Some scholars argued that the third part of the work on Vanjikkandam is added much later with the biography of the author. The spiritual message of Elango adigal is given through the voice of Kannaki. It asked every one to "rise above pleasure and pain in accordance with the approved course of conduct. Know God, and serve those who have known him. Fear speaking false hood. Avoid talebearing. Refrain from meat eating and abjure injury to any living to you."

Elanko Adigal incorporates various information on the socio-economic and political condition of Tamil Nadu. The religious beliefs and practices, the Tamils knowledge on Astrology, and the beauty of nature are described with vivid details. His work highlights the noble qualities of Kannaki and her chastity. Madhavi too, despite her birth as parathai lived a life of chaste women. On hearing the sad demise of Kovalan she renounced the world and surrendered to the lotus feet of God along with her daughter Manimekalai.

Elanko Adigal placed womenhood on the pedestal. The death of Pandyan queen following the death of Pandiya Nedunchelian also highlights this point. One cannot show any alternative to a woman after the death of her husband was the conviction of that period. The work stresses the necessity of just living in accordance with the moral code of the society. Among the intellectuals of Tamil Nadu, Elanko Adigal occupies an important palce after Tholkappiyar and Thiruvalluvar. His imagination, versatile writing and moral message glorifies the Tamil society.

3.5 Answers to check your progress questions

1. Senguttuvan
2. Nedunchezhiyan

3.6 Summary

- Elanko adigal is the celebrated author of the Silappathikaram
- Mr. Kanakasabai has written that Elanko adigal became a monk of the Nigrantha sect.
- The view that he was a Jain and belonged to Jainism is supported by the fact that he has elaborately referred to Jainism.
- The Silappathikaram consists of three Kandams: Puhar kandam, Madurai kandam and Vanchi kandam.
- This is the earliest work to employ varipattu in its composition.
- The Silappathikaram helps us to fix the date of the Sangam age.
- The Silappathikaram describes the significance of chastity, the fertility of the Kaveri river basin and the social and cultural condition etc.
- The work is an epic for the three ruling dynasties of Tamil Nadu.
- Elanko Adigal incorporates various information on the socio-economic and political condition of Tamil Nadu.
- Among the intellectuals of Tamil Nadu, Elanko Adigal occupies an important palce after Tholkappiyar and Thiruvalluvar.

3.7 Key words

- Kottam : a group of persons gathered together, usually for a particular purpose, whether religious, political, educational, or social.
- Kandam : a section or division of an epic poem etc.
- Silampu : Anklet used to wear in the legs of women. It will be tubular in structure with a single opening/closing. Inside the tubular structure people fill with pearls or rubies according to their status.

3.8 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. Write a few lines about the religion of Elanko Adigal.
2. Mention the social thougt of Elanko Adigal in Silappathikaram.

Long answer Questions

1. Write an essay about the role of Silappathikaram in Tamil literature.
2. Give an account of Tamil society portrayed by Silappathikaram.

3.9 Further Readings

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Unit-IV Revival of Tamil Language and Literature

4.0 Introduction
4.1 Objectives
4.2 Revival of Tamil language and Literature
4.3 Pure Tamil movement
4.4 Maraimalai Adigal
4.5 Thiru Vi.Ka.
4.6 Answers to check your progress questions
4.7 Summary
4.8 Key words
4.9 Self Assessment Questions
4.10 Further Readings

4.0 Introduction

Language is a vehicle for communicating the thought of one individual to another. The commentaries written on grammar and literature is the first major attempt of prose writing in Tamil. Prose conveys the thought of the author in a direct manner. Tamil literature has a rich and long literary tradition spanning more than two thousand years. The early Sangam literature, starting from the period of 2nd century BCE, contain anthologies of various poets dealing with many aspects of life, including love, war, social values and religion. This was followed by the early epics and moral literature, authored by Hindu, Jain and Buddhist authors, lasting up to the 5th century CE.

From the 6th to 12th century CE, the Tamil devotional poems written by Nayanmars (sages of Shaivism) and Azhvars (sages of Vaishnavism), indicated the great Bhakti movement which later surrounded the entire Indian subcontinent. It is during this era that some of the splendid of Tamil literary classics like Kambaramayanam and Periya Puranam were authored and many poets were patronized by the imperial Chola and Pandya empires. The later medieval period saw many varied minor literary works and also contributions by a few Muslim and European authors. By having the most ancient non-Sanskritized Indian literature, the Tamil literature is unique and thus has become the subject of study by

scholars who wish to delineate the non-Aryan and pre-Aryan strands in Indian culture. From the 19th century, Tamil literature was increasingly influenced by Western forms and ideas.

4.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Assess the process of revival of Tamil language and literature
- Discuss the functions of Pure Tamil Movement
- Explain the part of Maraimalai Adigal in Pure Tamil Movement
- Describe the role of Thiru.Vi.Ka to Tamil society.

4.2 Revival of Tamil language and Literature

A revival of Tamil literature took place from the late 19th century when works of religious and philosophical nature were written in a style that made it easier for the common people to enjoy. The entry of European Christian missionaries like Robert de Nobili, Caldwell, Beschi and G.U.Pope have enriched Tamil language by their scholarly contributions. Besides, the introduction of printing machines by them had its impact on Tamil prose. They used prose to spread Christian faith. Naturaly modern Tamil prose began to take root. With the help of local Tamil poets they flooded the Tamil country with lot of printed prose works. By the efforts Tamil was released from the grip of the north Indian languages. Like Veeramamunivar, they attempted on Tamil language reform. They simplified Tamil writing and reading. Newspapers, weekly, monthly magazines were published by other sections of society also. Even though prose writing was started in the 16th century, it developed mostly in the 19th century.

When the English consolidated its position in India, the missionaries started several schools in the 19th century. The Madras school book Society was established in 1850 and several prose works were published through it. In the 19th and 20th centuries several developments in the field of mass communication had its impact. Attempts were made not only in the field of comparative grammar, but also in Epigraphy, Archaeology and literary History. The use of language increased many

folds. The work of Christian missionaries may broadly be classified into religious service and intellectual work. They have translated Tamil literary work in their language. Several works were written on Tamil medicine, Tamil religion and Tamil literary history. Robert de Nobili wrote many prose works. T.P.Meenakshi Sundarm praised the benefits of Tamil grammar works written by Christian missionaries. The native writers also contributed for the development of prose. Printing machines helped the development of prose writing. Panchatantram, written by Thandavaraya Mudaliyar is an important prose work.

In addition to the work of European scholars several Tamil scholars also contributed for the revival of Tamil literature. Jaffna C.V. Dhamodharan Pillai and U.V. Saminatha Iyar did yeoman service to Tamil. Visiting villages and remote areas, they hace collected the palm leave manuscripts. It was organized in a proper format before publication. The History of the Tamil Sangam period and the glory of the people of that were brought to limelight. Arumuga Navalar, through his printing press and writings published several Tamil literary works in simple style. Vallalar who was a socio-religious reformer, spread awareness through schools and his works. The publication of ancient Tamil classics created interest in Tamil literature. Attempts were also made to study the origin, growth and decline of Tamil civilization.

Caldwell's theory, that the Tamil culture had a separate and independence existence before the arrival of Aryans into South India, stimulated enthusiasm. By propounding the Saiva Siddhanta Philosophy, non-Brahmin Tamil scholars attempted to present the Dravidian religious system as superior to the teachings of vedas. Through publications, public meetings and religious classes efforts were made for the betterment of Dravidians and their languages.

4.3 Pure Tamil Movement

Pure Tamil Movement is a movement of linguistic purism in Tamil literature attempting to restore Tamil to its pure state, avoiding Sanskrit loanwords. It was notably initiated by the writings of Maraimalai Adigal and Paventhar Bharathidasan, G.Devaneya Pavanar and Pavalareru Perunchitthiranaar. It was propagated by the Thenmozhi literary magazine,

founded by Pavalareru Perunchithiranar. V. G. Suryanarayana Sastri popularly known as "Parithimar Kalaignar", a Brahmin was also a 20th-century figure of the movement, who demanded, as early as 1902, classical language status for Tamil.

Tamil had been favoured by language policy since Indian independence. It had been used in high schools since 1938, and in university education from 1960. In 1956, the Indian National Congress party government passed a law instituting Tamil as the official language of the state, and in 1959 set up the Tamil Development and Research Council entrusted with producing Tamil school and college textbooks in the natural and human sciences, accounting, mathematics, etc. A series of children's encyclopedias in Tamil, "lucid commentaries" on Sangam poetry, and an "authentic history of the Tamil people" appeared in 1962-63. These measures, however, seemed insufficient to the proponents of "Pure Tamil", as expressed by Mohan Kumaramangalam in 1965, at the peak of the Anti-Hindi agitations,

Since the Congress government had also turned down a number of demands, such as the use of "Pure Tamil" rather than "Sanskritised Tamil" in schoolbooks, and resisting the name change from Madras to Tamil Nadu until 1969, concerned not to nurture separatist movements. This engendered resentment among the Tamil purists, expressed by Devaneya Pavanar in 1967: In the elections of the same year, Congress suffered a resounding defeat, and was replaced by the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) government under C. N. Annadurai.

Tamil Purism as a tradition goes back to the days of Tholkapiyam where non-Tamil words were classified as ‘northern’ (vadamoḷi) which means Sanskrit; and of-other-directions (thisaimoḷi) which means foreign. This is often cited as the earliest evidence of Tamil purism. With the passing of Tamil political and economic dominance from the South, first into the hands of the Deccan Vijayanagar feudatory in the 14th century, then to the Farsi speaking Muslim powers, Tamil clearly went into decline. Nonetheless, Tamil purism and obversely anti-Sanskritism remained among the literati and their local patrons as evidenced by Antao De Proenca’s Tamil-Portuguese Dictionary, compiled in 1679, that makes

mention of the acrimonious "anti-Kirantha" and the "pro-Sanskrit" tendency in Tamil phonetics. The coming of the English-speaking British colonialists and American missionaries introduced a spectacular revival in language development among the Tamils despite the European concerns about linguistic utility for administration and religious propagation. The modern revival of the Tamil Purist Movement (sometimes Pure Tamil Movement) is often attributed to Maraimalai Adigal who in 1916 committed himself publicly to defend pure Tamil. Advocates of purism not only popularized Tamil literature but crusaded for it. They went to villages and towns to run public rallies for literary figures, and resurrected the ancient linguistic Tamil purism and made it into a vital political issue.

4.4 Maraimalai Adigal

Maraimalai Adigal was born on 15 July 1876 to Chokkanata Pillai and Chinnammai. His birth name was Vedhachalam. He did his early schooling at Wesley Mission High School in Nagappattinam, but had to abandon his formal education with Fourth Form after his father's death. Maraimalai Adigal in spite of discontinuing his formal education after 9th grade, continued learning Tamil from the Tamil scholar Narayana Pillai, who was making his livelihood by selling Tamil palm-leaf manuscripts. He learnt Sanskrit and English through his own effort. He later authored several articles in Tamil monthly called Neelalochani. He later studied Saiva philosophy under Somasundara Naicker. With the help of Sundaram Pillai, author of Manonmaniam, he learned Tamil poetic dramas and thus acquired employment as a Tamil teacher in a school in Trivandrum.

At the age of seventeen, he got married to Soundaravalli and soon after his marriage, he moved to Madras to work as a sub-editor to a journal Siddantha Deepikai. Later, in March 1898, he quit this job to work with V. G. Suryanarana Sastri as a teacher in Madras Christian College. In his time in Madras Christian College he toured throughout Tamil Nadu giving lectures on Saivism. At about the same time he started a society for Saivism called Saiva Siddhanta Maha Samajam. As a young teacher he was popular with his students who would visit his house to listen to his lectures. In 1910 a decision was made by the Madras University to make the vernacular Tamil language optional for graduation in Arts subjects, leaving English as a medium of education. This decision caused many

Tamil teachers to lose their jobs. Realising the vast knowledge and his great capacity as a teacher, Miller, the then Head of Christian College Madras, and other friends insisted that Adigal be given a job in the college. As the opportunity to teach Tamil was considerably reduced and few students opted to study it, the need for a full-time teacher was not a required. Adigal refused the offer and resigned to lead an ascetic life in a serene atmosphere outside the city and to study and do research in Tamil.

After quitting his teaching job on 10 April 1911, Adigal moved to Pallavaram, a suburb of Madras. There he began to dress as a Sanyasin from 27 August 1911 and became known as Swami Vedhachalam. He became a sincere follower of Saivism and started an institution named Podhunilaik Kazhagam. The motto of the institution was set at Ondre Kulam, Oruvanae Devan (Mankind is one, and God is one). The Kazhagam made efforts to make people of all castes, creeds and religions to worship together.

In the year 1916 he became an expert of pure Tamil movement advocating the use of Tamil language devoid of loan words from Sanskrit. Thus he changed the name of Gnaana Saaharam to Arivukkadal and his title of Swami Vedhachalam to Maraimalai Adigal (where Adigal is Tamil for Swami). Thus he is referred to as the "Father of Tamil Puritanism".

He started the Thiru Murugan Press (TM Press) in his residence at Pallavaram and published a number of books and magazines. He also started a monthly called Gnaana Saaharam (Ocean of Wisdom).

Non-Brahminism

Apart being the called as father of pure Tamil movement, Maraimalai Adigal is also considered as father of Non-Brahmin Tamil movements. Maraimalai Adigal himself claimed that the non-Brahmin attitude of Self-respect movement was born out of his views and principles. Nevertheless, the atheist stance of Periyar E. V. Ramasamy, who was heading the Self-respect movement, was observed by Maraimalai Adigal and his followers as counter productive.

Literary Works

Apart from being a good orator, Adigal composed several Tamil poems. He authored more than 100 books. Other than essays and novels he wrote books dealing with literary criticism, philosophy and religion, history, psychology and politics. He has published several works on Mullaippattu, Kurinjpattu, Sivagnana Bodham, Thirukkural and Pattinapalai etc. In addition to Tamil he wrote these topics in English and in north Indian language.

He has translated the drama pf Kalidasa's Sakunthalam from Sanskrit to pure Tamil. For the benefit of the children he wrote several text books under the title "Siruvarkalukkana Sen Tamil " (Pure Tamil for children). He wrote the famous love story of Ambikapathy-Amaravathy as a drama. Evaluating the works of the poets he wrote a book on Ancient and Modern Poets" in English. He used to quote the scholars of other languages widely in his work.

His collections of poems to the Hindu god Murugan, which he composed during the times of illness were published as Thiruvotri Muruhar Mummanikkovai in 1900. He also wrote poems from recollections of his teacher Somasundara Naiker in 1901 as Somasundarak Kaanjiaakkam. This has been considered as one of his best works. He also released his research work on Tamil literature Mullaip Pattu Aaraichi for students of Tamil literature.

In 1911, he published his first novel, Kumuthavalli allathu Naahanaattarasi, an adaptation of English novel Leela by G. W. M. Reynolds. He also wrote books on the subjects of self-improvement, self-help and personality development. These included Maranathin pin Manithar Nilai (Human Life stage After Death), Mesmerism and Hypnotism and Tholaivil unarthal (Telepathy).

Check Your Progress Questions

1. When did the Madars school book society establish?
2. Who is called as the father of pure Tamil movement?
3. What was the name changed the Gnanasagaram by Maraimalai Adigal?
4. What was the book written by Maraimalai Adigal to children?
5. Which year Maraimalai Adigal published his first novel?

4.5 Thiru.Vi.Ka.

Thiruvarir Viruttacala Kalyanasundara Mudaliyar, better known by his Tamil initials Thiru Vi Ka , was a Tamil scholar, essayist and activist. He is esteemed for the strong humanism of his essays, the analytical depth of his commentaries on classical Tamil literature and philosophy, and the clear, fluid style of his prose. In the beginning of 20th century, the Tamil language was not properly used by the people. Due to their new found attachment towards English, Sanskrit and other nort Indian languages, people used the words of these languages regularly in their writings and in speech. It slowly eroded the richness of Tamil language as several pure Tamil words were replaced by words from other languages. In such a situation Thiru.Vi,Ka. Who stressed the importance of mother tongue Tamil. He spent his entire life for the enrichment of Tamil language by his writings and speeches. His works, along with those of V. O. Chidambaram Pillai, Maraimalai Adigal, and Arumuga Navalar are considered to have defined the style of modern Tamil prose.

Thiru Vi. Ka was born in the village of Thullam, near Chennai in 1883. He got his education at the Wesley College in Chennai where he also served as a teacher. He married Kamalambikai in 1912. But his marital life lasted only for six years after which his wife passed away. Later, he chooses public service as his life partner. Earlier he was a student of Jaffna Kathiravel pillai. He learned Tamil literature from Maraimalai Adigal and Siddhanta Sastra from Thanikasala Mudaliar. Thiru.Vi.Ka. was fond of the ahimsa principles of Mahathma Gandhi and spread the same in his writings. Through his writings in “Desa Bhaktan” he stimulated patriotism among the Tamils. When the British took action against its publication he has started “Nava Sakthi” as a weekly. He always highlighted the importance of women and their honour. He always fought for the rights of women. He stressed the necessity of women’s education and their employment in Government services. Thiru.Vi.Ka. strongly advocated the remarriage of widows. He was against the ‘Devadasi’ tradition in which girls were dedicated to temple service.he was in favour of a law against the Devadasi system.

Leader of Labour Union

Thiru.Vi.Ka. was one of the pioneer leaders of the labour union Movement in India. He was influenced by the Labour party leader Hardy in England. So Thiru.Vi.Ka. developed interest in the labour affairs. Thiru.Vi.Ka translated the articles appeared in Indian Patriot" on the grievances of mill workers. It was written by Kesava pillai and Thiru.Vi.Ka. published them in "Desa Bhaktan". In course of time the necessity for a labour union was felt. Thiru.Vi.Ka. approached Vadia, who was close to Annie Besant and belongs to Theosophical society, for starting a labour union. In April 1918, the first labour union was started in Chennai. Thiru.Vi.Ka. and Diwan Bahadur Kesava Pillai were elected as leaders to assist Vadia in Trade union affairs. In 1920 a central labour union incorporating various union was started under the leadership of Thiru.Vi.Ka. For workers demand , a strike was organized in the B&C Mill in 1921 which continued for six months. Despite suppression, police firing, and government pressure Thiru.Vi.Ka. successfully conducted the strike. Because of the efforts of sir. P.Thiyagaraja Chettiyar stressed that if such steps were taken against Thiru.Vi.Ka. the Justice party ministry would resign against such move. In 1947 after independence Thiru.Vi.Ka. was palced under house arrest for organizing another strike in the B&C Mills. With fighting spirit he guided the Trade union movement in Tamil Nadu.

His Literary works

Thiru.Vi.Ka contributed much for the revival of Tamil language. He started that Tamil is self sufficient to discuss any field of knowledge. He requested the young students to take care of their mother tongue, which was relegated due to the influence of other languages. To bring back Tamil society to its former glory, he stressed for attachment towards Tamil language. He wrote on different topics, which guides us towards a better future. Nearly 55 books were written by him besides several thought provoking articles in News Papers. He contributed both for prose and poems. In 1920, Thiru. Vi. Ka. started a new Tamil weekly magazine, titled Navasakthi. Navasakthi would be the vehicle for his thoughts for much of the rest of his life. Thiru Vi. Ka. sought to make his magazine a inspiration to the Tamil people. His writings reflected his philosophical

views, he published one of the first Tamil interpretations of the thought of Mahatma Gandhi, still regarded as an important milestone in Gandhian studies. He wrote a number of works on the religious and spiritual thought of Vallalar Ramalinga Swamigal, an influential Tamil Saivite philosopher saint of the 19th century, he wrote commentaries on a number of works of classical Tamil literature, which appeared as serials in Navasakthi.

His Pennin perumai or valkait tunai nalam was one of the most read books of that period. In his writings, Thiru Vi. Ka. developed a prose style which built on the inner rhythms of the Tamil language and produced a rhythmic, flowing text. The field of Tamil prose was still new, the style he developed was influential, his works are today seen as having given a new energy to the Tamil language and regarded as part of the foundations on which the modern Tamil prose style has been built. Thiru.Vi.Ka.'s speeches were compiled under the title "Tamil Thendral". In 1908 he wrote the history of Kathiravel pillai, his teacher. Several books were written as an addition to Hindu religious works. Thiru.Vi.Ka. was a social reformer. He followed the Gandhian Principles of prohibition, removal of untouchability and caste differences. In 1953 Thiru.Vi.Ka. comes out of the Congress party due to Brahmin domination.Despite poverty Thiru.Vi.Ka. lived a honest life. He was against the imposition of Hindi and fought against it. When he passed away in 1953 the entire Tamil Nadu shared the sorrow and loss to the Tamil society. Despite his difference of opinion with Periyar E.V.R., he joined hands with him in his self-respect movement later. He dedicated his entire life for the promotion of Tamil language and for the advancement of Tamil society.

Check Your Progress Questions

6. Which year first Labour Union was started in Madras?
7. What was the tiltle given to Thiru.Vi.Ka.?

4.6. Answers to Check Your Progress Qusetions

1. 1850
2. Maraimalai Adigal

3. Arivu Kadal
4. Siruvarkalukkana Sen Tamil
5. 1911
6. 1918
7. Tamil Thendral

4.7 Summary

- From the 19th century, Tamil literature was increasingly influenced by Western forms and ideas.
- A revival of Tamil literature took place from the late 19th century when works of religious and philosophical nature were written in a style that made it easier for the common people to enjoy.
- The Madras school book Society was established in 1850 and several prose works were published through it.
- In addition to the work of European scholars several Tamil scholars also contributed for the revival of Tamil literature.
- The publication of ancient Tamil classics created interest in Tamil literature.
- Pure Tamil Movement is a movement of linguistic purism in Tamil literature attempting to restore Tamil to its pure state, avoiding Sanskrit loanwords.
- The modern revival of the Pure Tamil Movement is often endorsed to Maraimalai Adigal .
- Maraimalai Adigal was born on 15 July 1876
- In the year 1916 he became an expert of pure Tamil movement advocating the use of Tamil language devoid of loan words from Sanskrit.
- He changed the name of Gnaana Saaharam to Arivukkadal and his title of Swami Vedhachalam to Maraimalai Adigal.
- Maraimalai Adigal is also considered as father of Non-Brahmin Tamil movements.
- He has published several works on Mullaippattu, Kurinjpattu, Sivagnana Bodham, Thirukkural and Pattinapalai etc.
- He also wrote books on the subjects of self-improvement, self-help and personality development.

- For the benefit of the children he wrote several text books under the title " Siruvarkalukkana Sen Tamil "
- Thiru Vi Ka , was a Tamil scholar, essayist and activist.
- He spent his entire life for the enrichment of Tamil language by his writings and speeches.
- Thiru.Vi.Ka. was fond of the ahimsa principles of Mahathma Gandhi and spread the same in his writings.
- Through his writings in " Desa Bhaktan" he stimulated patriotism among the Tamils.
- Thiru.Vi.Ka. was one of the pioneer leaders of the labour union Movement in India.
- Thiru.Vi.Ka translated the articles appeared in Indian Patriot" on the grievances of mill workers.
- In 1920 a central labour union incorporating various union was started under the leadership of Thiru.Vi.Ka.
- Thiru.Vi.Ka contributed much for the revival of Tamil language.
- Nearly 55 books were written by him besides several thought provoking articles in News Papers.
- He contributed both for prose and poems.
- He was against the imposition of Hindi and fought against it.
- He dedicated his entire life for the promotion of Tamil language and for the advancement of Tamil society.

4.8 Key words

- Saiva siddhanta : Saiva Siddhanta is the name of our school of Hinduism. It is today the oldest, most vigorous and widely practiced of the six forms of Saivism
- Senthamil : Senthamil means a flawless language which has so much prosperity and opulence that no one can find a fault in it.

4.9 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. Give an account of the resurgence of Tamil language?
2. List out the works of Maraimalai Adigal.
3. Write a note on Pure Tamil Movement.

Long Answer questions

1. Describe the contribution of Maraimalai Adigal to Pure Tamil Movement.
2. Elicidate the service of Thiru.Vi.Ka. to tamil society.

4.10 Further Readings

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BLOCK – II
SOCIO- RELIGIOUS THOUGHTS OF TAMIL INTELLECTUALS

Unit – V Sundaram Pillai

5.0 Introduction
5.1 Objectives
5.2 Sundaram Pillai
5.3 Manonmaniyam
5.4 Anti-Hindi agitation
5.5 World Tamil conferences
5.6 Answers to check your progress questions
5.7 Summary
5.8 Key words
5.9 Self Assessment Questions
5.10 Further Readings

5.0 Introduction

The introduction of western type of education and technological civilization during the nineteenth century A.D. has altered the cultural norms and thereby paved the way for social transformation. The western contact through the British rule set the pace for cultural renaissance, initial industrialization and growth of new political consciousness. The emergence of the social groups along with cultural awakening and reform movements in various parts of the country prepared the ground for political awareness and the national movement. A strategy was evolved not only for political independence but also for social, economic and cultural modernization of the society. The process of social transformation in TamilnHdu during the nineteenth century has been conceived through transition of various aspects of society – structure, culture, institution, ideology etc. Rapid propagation of Western ideas and formulation of the Dravidian civilization theory during the nineteenth century inculcated a sense of pride in educated Tamils, eventually leading to the birth of Tamil nationalism, which inspired both the Indian Independence movement as well as the DrHvidian movement. The Tamil press, comprising periodicals, journals, magazines and newspapers is an institution which has stimulated

progress in every phase of social, political and public life. It has quickened thought, moulded opinion, and modernized taste with a fresh orientation or outlook.

5.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Describe the contribution of Sundaram Pillai to Tamil literature
- Illustrate the features of the Tamil drama Manonmaniyam
- Understand the causes and course of Anti-Hindi agitation in Tamil Nadu
- List out the features of world Tamil conferences

5.2 Sundaram Pillai

Manonmaniyam P. Sundaranar was a tamil scholar, noted for the famous Tamil drama Manonmaniyam as well as the state song of Tamil Nadu Tamil Thai Vazhthu. He was born in the area of Alleppey to Perumal and Madathi Ammal. Sundaranar studied religious literature such as Thiruvasagam during his childhood. Nagapattinam Narayana Samy was his Tamil language teacher, he completed his B. A. in 1876 and in the following year, he married Sivagami Ammal. His career as an educator began in 1877, he became the Principal at a bilingual English-Tamil school in Tirunelveli, playing a key role in the school's development. Sundaranar taught philosophy at H. H. The Maharaja's University College, Thiruvananthapuram, he completed his M. A. in 1880. During that period he became familiar with Robert Harvey. Sundaram showed his respect for Harvey, a Scottish Professor of Philosophy and English at The Maharaja's College, by dedicating his drama Manonmaniyam to him, naming his farmhouse after him. Together they wrote the book, Some Early Sovereigns of Travancore.

In 1891 he was made a Fellow of the University of Madras. His archaeological research led to the publication of “The Early sovereigns of Travancore”. He was conferred with the title Rao Bahadur by the government of Madras in 1896. In 1897 he passed away at the early age of 42 due to illness.

Profesor Sundaram Pillai was a fervent Tamil scholar. He stressed the antiquity and greatness of the Tamil language. He regarded that before the arrival of Aryans, Tamil was a language used in the Indian sub-continent. He was also interested in the study of History and Epigraphy. His familiarity in Tamil and Malayalam language helped him to read several inscriptions of Travancore. His another important contribution was the fixing the age of the Thirugnana Sambandhar. Earlier, scholars like Caldwell and Nelson fixed the age of Thirugnana Sambandhar as that of 13th century and 14th century A.D. respectively. But Sundaram Pillai in his important paper entitled "Some Milestone in the History of Tamil Literature" held that age of Thirugnana Sambandhar was about the first half of the 7th century A.D.

Among his varied works, his writing of Manonmaniyam was noteworthy. Like Shakespeare as well as many other north Indian writers who contributed for drama, Sundaram Pillai also wish to write drama for Tamil language. His Manonmaniyam was a Tamil drama in five acts on the Shakespearean model. It was based on Lord Lytton's English poem "The Secret way". Sundaram Pillai's work exhibits the rare combination of dramatic beauty, wealth of philosophical ideas with a scientific touch. Manonmaniyam's glamorous allegory and moral teachings naturally elevated the spirit of the reader. He introduced the Tamil Deiva Vanakkam which was recited in every important social and government functions even today.

5.3 Manonmaniyam

Manonmaniyam is an immortal contribution to Tamil drama. It was a story of Manonmani the only daughter of Pandyan King Sivaka. Manonmani sees in her sleep a form of divine and irresistible beauty. She falls desperately in love and keeps the secret all to herself. Kudila was the minister of her father. He wanted to retain his influence by marrying her to his son Paladeva. After a series of trials and turmoil she garlands Purushothaman, the person whom she loved after her dream. Sundara plays the role of timely helper to the lovers. But before the happy end she was forced to be the bride of Paladeva. But just before she garlands the bridegroom, she saw Purushothaman in the gathering. With happiness and

joy she is locked in his embrace. He was actually Purushottama Varma of Travancore. Followed by explanations, the play closes with the blessings of the king, who was the happy father of the bride Manonmani. Even though the work is based on the English work, it was suitably modified to represent the Tamil culture. The characters, the way in which the story revolves around the key figures, political intrigue, purity of love and the moral message that evil forces would ultimately defeated by the purity of love makes the drama a real classical work. The work was a bridge between modernity and tradition. Professor Sundaram Pillai's contribution to Tamil drama is always worth remembered.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. What was the title conferred with by Sundaram Pillai?
2. What type of book is Manonmaniyam?

5.4. Anti- Hindi agitation

In the beginning of 20th century it was felt necessary to have a national language for India as a link language between various regions. Starting from Gandhiji several leaders stressed the need to have Hindi as a common language. Such sugestions naturally created resentment in Tamil Nadu. The attempt by Congress party to impose Hindi as a national language was regarded as an attempt to treat the Tamil speaking people as as second rate citizens. An organized attempt was made by the people of Tamil Nadu to resist the imposition of Hindi. The Language problem in Tamil Nadu has become a crucial one for various reasons. The Language Tamil is adored for its antiquity and for its rich literary works. When Hindi, the much younger language to Tamil chronologically, is imposed, the honour and self-respect of' Tamils have been questioned.

Anti- Hindi agitation- 1937

Rajaji was an ardent supporter of Hindi. He thought that it would bridge the gap between the North and the south. He thought also that Hindi, as a Lingua Franca would bring unity among Indians. In this regard he was very much under the spell of Gandhiji who wished that Hindi should be made as the National Language of India. Rajaji during his tenure

1937-39 as Premier of Madras Presidency made Hindi compulsory up to 3rd form in the academic curriculum. It was for two reasons he supported the imposition of Hindi. One, political the other one unity. He thought that the south Indian participation in the Indian Politics would not be possible if the South Indians did not learn Hindi. He also thought it was necessary for the unify of Indian people. But no individual can be a spokesperson of the complete masses as regarding self-respect and honour. Rajaji could not transcend the hearts of the Tamils as regarding their language sentiments at that time.

Hindi as a compulsory language challenged Tamil chauvinism. The Tamil literature insists ethics, valour, honour and self-respect. Besides this The Self Respect Movement in Tamil Nadu opposed the imposition of Hindi vehemently. A series of articles were written in protest of Hindi in their organs like Kudiarasu and Viduthalai . Anti- Hindi agitation was led by Anti-Hindi Demonstration Association. The agitation had spread like fire and ended up in a long march from Tirunelveli to Madras. Periyar E.V.Ramaswamy condemned Hindi and its imposition. He personally felt that the Hindi language was made compulsory to push back the non-Brahmins in all aspects. He boldly declared that there was no common language of India in the past as there was no united India before the advent of the British. The Self-respect movement, to which he was associated with, declared that the introduction of Hindi in Madras Presidency was politically motivated to replace Tamil with Hindi.

The Third Madras Province Conference which was held in Trichy on 26 December 1937, under the Presidentship of K.Subramania Pillai besides passing a resolution on condemning Hindi combined, anti-Congress and anti-Brahmins feelings." A conference was convened at Kanchipuram on 27 February 1938 under the Presidentship of K.V. Reddi Naidu, a Justice Party leader to ventilate the protest against the imposition of Hindi.

Rajaji introduced Hindi in 125 secondary schools. The Tamil Chauvinists and scholars like, Maraimalai Adigal, Eezhatthu Sivananda Adigal, K.Subramanla Pillai, Dr.Swaminatha Iyer, Na.Mu.Venkataswamy Naattaar, M. Kadiresan Chettiar and Ka.Appadurai vehemently opposed it saying that the imposition was a challenge to the self-respect of

Tamils. They also advised Rajaji not to pursue his language policy, as it was harmful to the Tamil people.

Now the Self Respect Movement had turned into anti-Hindi and anti-Brahmins Movement. A Provisional Committee under the secretaryship of P.Viswanathan was instituted in 1938 in Trichi. On 3rd June 1938, a formal non-violent agitation was launched against the imposition of Hindi. Eminent Communists leaders like M.Singaravelu and P.Jeevanandam in Madras State condemned the Congress Government's Order as regarding Hindi, as unnecessary and unwanted and instigative. The Justice party resolved that the imposition of Hindi was against the interest of the Tamil society.

The Governor of Madras Presidency Lord Erskin did not favour the introduction of Hindi as a compulsory subject. But he never interfered in the decision of the ministry though he could. The anti-Hindi agitation became vigorous and as many as 683 persons including 63 women were put behind the bars, in January 1939. C.N.Annadurai, a thinker, orator and writer, who was young then was arrested for picketing in front of the Premier's house. In March 1939 around 1273 persons were arrested in the anti-Hindi agitation. Two provincial leaders Thalamuthu and Natarajan lost their lives in the prison. Some of the Congress leaders also supported the Anti-Hindi agitation in Tamil Nadu.

The Government of Madras undeterred by the growing unrest in the presidency decided to handle the situation with an iron-hand by passing the Criminal Law Amendment Act 1938. At Rajaji's instance, section 7 of the Criminal Law Amendment Act was imposed against the agitators. Protesters were arrested. It was not tolerable even by Congress people and they insisted that the law should be repealed. The Act contained non-bailable section. It was horrible. Rajaji thought that E.V.Ramaswamy and his followers could be silenced through this law but E.V.Ramaswamy never yielded to the pressure of the Criminal Law Amendment Act.

Rajaji's appraisal of the situation in Madras during the anti-Hindi agitation in this period made him unpopular. His vision was veiled. When the Congress Ministry under Rajaji resigned in 1939, the British released E.V.R. Periyar. Anti-Hindi propaganda continued in Tamil Nadu. Finally in February 1940 the Governor abolished the order for the imposition of

Hindi. Hindi was however retained as an optional subject in the schools. Tamil leaders regarded the struggle as an opportunity to unite all the Tamils in defense of their mother tongue.

Anti- Hindi agitation- 1965

The Language Policy

During India's freedom struggle, national leaders carried on the movement through the medium of regional languages and demanded the replacement of English by a national language. After Independence, the Constituent Assembly debated the issue and arrived at a compromise formula. The Constitution spelled out the language policy and stipulated that Hindi would replace English after 1965. The official languages Commission, under the chairmanship of B.G.Kher, recommended the process of replacement within the constitutional time frame.

The joint parliamentary party reviewed the Kher commission report and on the basis of its recommendations, the President issued an order in April 1960. Following the presidential order, the Government of India introduced steps the first session of the non-Hindi speaking States.On 7 August 1959, Nehru came with a Agricola sorence that English would continue to remain the official language as long as non-Hindi people wanted. Nehru's Assurance was embodied in the Official Languages Act of 1963, removed the constitutional constraint on the use of English after 1965. Nehru displayed his quality of leadership by keeping the unity of multilingual India intact.

On 26 January 1965, the prescribed time period of 15 years to make Hindi the official language replacing English, as provided in the constitution, came to an end. Nanda, the Home Minister, and an urgent advocate of Hindi that under the dispensation of Shastri it should be easier to use Hindi for official purposes in the union administration.

The Agitation

The Dravida Munnetra Khazhalgam (DMK), the main opposition in the Tamil Nadu legislative assembly, jump at this opportunity to launch a statewide anti-Hindi agitation. The anti-Hindi agitation, under the leadership of C.N. Annadurai, escalated into a movement. On 25 January 1965, there were demonstrations, processions, meetings, and burning of effigies of the demon of Hindi. On the Madras City two agitators, burnt

themselves to death. There was Police firing at a student demonstration in which a student was shot dead. The Republic Day (26 Jan) was observed as a day of mourning. On 28 January the situation in Madras became explosive. The authoritarian attitude and the undiplomatic approach of the chief minister M. Bhaktavatsalam aggravated the situation.

Shastri's appeal to the agitators to withdraw the movements in view of a special law passed by Parliament enabling English to continue as the associate language went unheeded. The patient continues unabated. On 15 February 35 agitators were killed and 25 injured in a series of police firing as students in various parts of the states went on a rampage. Two police officers were burnt alive by the mob. The resignations of two central ministers – C. Subramaniam, Food Minister and O. V. Alagesan, Minister of State for Petroleum and Chemicals both from Madras state made matters worse.

Nehru's Assurance

On 12 February, the death toll in Police firings in Madras and Pondicherry mounted to 54. In the incidents in Coimbatore, Madurai, North Arcot, Trichy and Madras, 24 persons were killed in firings. On the same day, Acharya Vino Bave, undertook and indefinite fast in protest against violence in Madras. On 25 February 1965, a meeting of the CongressWorking Committee and Chief Ministers, held in New Delhi, arrived at agreed decisions on the language issue, in the teeth of opposition by 106 MPs hailing from Hindi speaking regions. Though the matter was informally discussed in the Cabinet, no decision could be taken.

In June 1965, agreed to give legislative sanction to Nehru's Assurances regard to the continued use of English for administrative purpose. The impact of 1965 agitation was felt in 1967 elections when the Congress government lost power in Tamil Nadu. A student leader, P Seenivasan, defeated Congress stalwart and former CM K Kamaraj in his hometown. DMK led by Annadurai captured power. Many student leaders of the agitation became political leaders of the future. The anti-Hindi imposition agitation ensured that the state followed a Two-Language Policy as against the Three-Language Policy proposed by the Centre.

Check Your Progress Questions

3. In howmany schools, Rajaji introduced Hindi?
4. Which Act was passed by Rajaji against the agitators?
5. Who died in the prison in the anti- Hindi agitation?
6. Who was the chief minister during 1965 agitation?

5.5 World Tamil conferences

The International Association of Tamil Research (IATR) was initiated by some eminent scholars who were extremely interested about the growth of Tamil studies on the occasion of the 26th International Congress of Orientalists held in New Delhi in 1964.

Rev. Father Thaninayagam, a Sri Lankan was a renowned scholar, when he was Professor of Tamil at the University of Malaya, Kualalumpur, conducted the First International Conference Seminar on Tamil Studies during January 1966. The Conference was hosted by the Malaysian Government headed by Hon Tunku Abdul Rahman, Prime Minister.

On the occasion of the First International Conference Seminar of Tamil Studies, held in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia, in April 1966, Sri. M. Bhaktavatsalam at that time Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu attended the Conference. In this Conference, he invited delegates and observers attending in the Conference to participate the Second Conference in Madras. This invitation was willingly acknowledged and the Second International Conference Seminar of Tamil Studies, sponsored together by the International Association of Tamil Research and the Government of Madras, was held at the University of Madras between 3rd January and 10th January 1968. To run simultaneously with the Second International Conference Seminar, a World Tamil Conference, aimed at a widespread audience and premeditated with a view to making an appeal of a more popular nature, was arranged by the Government of Tamil Nadu, by this time under the leadership of the C. N. Annadurai.

Third International Conference Seminar on Tamil Studies was held at Paris, France conducted by Prof. Jean Filiozat during 1970. Fourth International Conference Seminar on Tamil Studies was organised in Jaffna, Sri Lanka during January 1974. The Government of Tamil Nadu

hosted the Fifth International Conference Seminar on Tamil Studies was held in Madurai in January 1981under the chiefministership of M.G.Ramachandran. Sixth International Conference Seminar on Tamil Studies was held in Maaysia during 1986. The Seventh International Conference Seminar on Tamil Studies was held in Mauritius in 1989. The eighth International Conference on Tamil Studies was held in Thanjavur during January 1995 organised by the Government of Tamil Nadu led by Chief Minister Hon J. Jayalalitha. The International Association of Tamil Research, Malaysia (IATR, Malaysia) in collaboration with the Department of Indian Studies, University of Malaya was organized the 9th Conference from 29th January to 1st February 2015. The Tenth International Conference Seminar on Tamil Studies was organized at Chicago, USA, during 4th to 7th July 2019. The theme for the 10th World Tamil Conference was "New Historicist, Scientific and Comparative Study of the Antiquity of Tamils, Tamil language, Culture and Civilization"

Check Your Progress Questions

7. Which year IATR was founded?
8. Who organized the first International Conference on Tamil studies?
9. Where the fifth conference was held?

5.6 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. Rao Bahadur
2. Drama
3. 125
4. Criminal Law Amendment Act
5. Thalamuthu and Natarajan
6. M. Bhaktavatsalam
7. 1964
8. Rev. Father Thaninayagam
9. Thanjavur

5.7 Summary

- Manonmaniyam P. Sundaranar was a tamil scholar, noted for the famous Tamil drama Manonmaniyam as well as the state song of Tamil Nadu Tamil Thai Vazhthu.
- In 1891 he was made a Fellow of the University of Madras.

- He was conferred with the title Rao Bahadur by the government of Madras in 1896.
- Manonmaniyam is an immortal contribution to Tamil drama. It was a story of Manonmani the only daughter of Pandyan King Sivaka.
- The work was a bridge between modernity and tradition.
- Professor Sundaram Pillai's contribution to Tamil drama is always worth remembered.
- Starting from Gandhiji several leaders stressed the need to have Hindi as a common language.
- Such sugestions naturally created resentment in Tamil Nadu.
- Rajaji was an ardent supporter of Hindi. He thought that it would bridge the gap between the North and the south.
- Rajaji made Hindi compulsory up to 3rd form in the academic curriculum in 1937.
- Rajaji introduced Hindi in 125 secondary schools.
- The Tamil scholars like, Maraimalai Adigal, Eezhatthu Sivananda Adigal, M.Kadiresan Chettiar and Ka.Appadurai opposed this.
- The Self Respect Movement had turned into anti-Hindi and anti-Brahmins Movement.
- The Governor of Madras Presidency Lord Erskin did not favour the introduction of Hindi as a compulsory subject.
- Rajaji's appraisal of the situation in Madras during the anti-Hindi agitation in this period made him unpopular.
- In February 1940 the Governor abolished the order for the imposition of Hindi.
- The Constitution spelled out the language policy and stipulated that Hindi would replace English after 1965.
- On 26 January 1965, the prescribed time period of 15 years was came to an end.
- On 25 January 1965, there were demonstrations, processions, meetings, and burning of effigies of the demon of Hindi.
- The anti-Hindi agitation, under the leadership of C.N. Annadurai, escalated into a movement.

- The authoritarian attitude and the undiplomatic approach of the chief minister M. Bhaktavatsalam aggravated the situation.
- On 12 February, the death toll in Police firings in Madras and Pondicherry mounted to 54.
- On 25 February 1965, a meeting of the CongressWorking Committee and Chief Ministers, arrived at agreed decisions on the language issue.
- The International Association of Tamil Research (IATR) was established by some eminent scholars in 1964.
- Rev. Father Thaninayagam, organised the First International Conference Seminar on Tamil Studies during January 1966.
- The eighth Conference was held in Thanjavur in 1995.
- Tenth International Conference Seminar on Tamil Studies was held at Chicago, USA, during 4th to 7th July 2019.

5.8 Key words

- Tamil Thai Vazhthu : It is the State song of Tamil Nadu. The song was written by Manonmaniam Sundaram Pillai.
- Kudiarasu : Kudiarasu was a Tamil weekly magazine published by Periyar E. V. Ramasamy in Madras Presidency.

5.9 Self Assessment Questions

Short answer Questions

1. Write a short note on Manonmaniyam.
2. Mention the first phase of the anti-Hindi agitation in Tamil Nadu.
3. What do you know about the World Tamil Conferences?

Long Answer Questions

1. Describe the contribution of Sundaram Pillai to Tamil drama.
2. Write an essay about the anti-Hindi agitations of Tamil Nadu and explain its impact.

5.10 Further Readings

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Unit- VI Socio- Religious Thoughts of Tamil Intellectuals

6.0 Introduction
6.1 Objectives
6.2 Soicio-Religious Thoughts of Tamil Intellectuals
6.3 Vaikunda Swamigal
6.4 Vallalar
6.5 Answers to check your progress questions
6.6 Summary
6.7 Key words
6.8 Self Assessment Questions
6.9 Further Readings

6.0 Introduction

The amalgamation of the British rule in 1801 indicated a new epoch in the social history of Tamil Nadu. With the establishing of their rule, the fragmented theocratic states vanished and secular tradition developed. The British divided religion from politics and followed secular tradition. The new Government superseded State support to any religion and stretched equality to all religions which provoked structural alterations in the traditional society. The intellectual emerging among the Western cultured masses formed a conductive atmosphere for the social uprising. The community centered society of the past was converted as a civil society. The Reform movement kindled by the educated people of Bengal cleaned all parts of the country. The reforms were introduced against age long ills and illogical customs. The Government stopped cruel practice of sati, enacted legislation to legalise widow remarriage and prohibited child marriage. The reforms further ended into the eradication of Devadasi system and liberated women to the path of equality. The socio-political arising in Tamil Nadu was mainly due to the introduction and extent of Western education which operated under varied situations. It introduced an awakening among the people through administrative methods, missionary and volunteer initiatives.

6.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Explain the socio-religious thoughts of Tamil intellectuals
- Describe the ideology of Vaikunda Swamigal
- Understand the role of Vallalar in awakening the Tamils.
- Read the functions of Sanmarga Sangam

6.2 Soicio-Religious Thoughts of Tamil Intellectuals

The Indians have connection with the western culture. They were impressed by the western thoughts. The Enlish cultured Indians followed the western culture, society, religion and ideas. It appeared that the Indian would receive the western principles completely. The educated Indians rejuvenated the beauty of their own culture and tried to reform it. The Indians after accommodating it, refereed their social, religious and political customs on reasons and rejected their blind acceptance of trust. It caused in the socio religious movement in Indian history. Particularly in Tamil Nadu, the socio religious movement propagated the seed for the base of Tamil intellects.

The Tamil intellectuals like Valalar, Vaikunda Swamigal and others are the cause for the upliftment of the society, raise of humanism, equality, abolition of untouchability and other social evils once familiar in Tamil land. The introduction of English education in Madras Presidency encouraged a close link of the Tamils, the Malayalees and the Kannada-speaking people, which in turn donated to an arrangement of a cultural and Dravidian attraction. Thus, English language assisted to cut across the linguistic blockades by helping as the "lingua franca" for the bilingual people of South India. It also facilitated the leaders of South India to debate the common difficulties relating to the political growth, social liberation and consciousness among the rural people.

The educated socio-religious leaders at national and provincial level planned numerous associations and educated the people against the untouchability. They strained to destroy the existing social evils which hindered the progress of the untouchables. They intended at advance in the social status and civic place of the untouchables. The elimination of

untouchability and all its associated evils shaped an important thing in the agenda of all socio-religious reformers who functioned in India.

G.Subramaniya Aiyar, the courageous Brahmin who led the remarriage of the widowed daughter among strong resistance of his family members. Mahakavi Bharathiyar, the revolutionary poet, Ayothi Dasa Pandithar, the journalist of Oru Paisa Tamilan, Venkatarathnam Naidu, the great advocate, etc. acted as publicists of social renaissance. Muthukutti Swamigal of Swamithoppu, also calledas Vaikuntha Swamigal and Saint Ramalinga Adigal of Vadalur were the pioneers of social change in Tamil land.

6.3 Vaikunda Swamigal

His Early Life

Vaikuntha Swamigal was born in A.D 1808 in a nadar family at Sasthankoilvilai, the present Samithoppu of Kanniyakumari. He was the second son to his parents. Initially, he was called as Mudisoodum Perumal. The name Perumal was used by the caste - Hindus alone. So the caste - Hindus prompted that he might be a hazard to the power. They objected to call him as Perumal. Hence, he was renamed as Muthukutti. The superior and authoritarian Travancore government and the caste - Hindus injured the spirits of young Muthukutti.

Muthukutti was spent his childhood in the village Pial. As a young boy, he was specified some instruction in learning religious and moral texts. He learned the Puranas and Ihtihasas of the Hindu religion and also other literatures of various beliefs and moral works like Nalvazhi, Moodurai and Tirukkural. He well-read the Bible and assumed the core of Christianity. It was appealed by a church historian that he was a Christian. He was also a Vishnu believer like his parents. He was married Paradevathai at the age of seventeen, a native of Poovalur village near Thamaraikulam.

Religious Contribution of Vaikunda Swamigal

Muthukkutti went a pilgrimage with his parents to Lord Muruga Temple at Thiruchendur in 1833. Thirucendur was a famous Hindu pilgrim spot for a holy bath in the Bay of Bengal on the time of Masi festival (February and March). This created a turning point in his lifespan. While

taking the holy bath on the second day of the Masi festival, a wonder occurred in his life. Muthukutti was disappeared and he could not be found for three days. After three days he exposed himself and said to his mother, "since now I am not your son, but the son of Lord Narayana" and informed the people that Lord Vishnu had provided him a rebirth as Vaikuntha and delegated him to South India for the promotion and association of the depressed class people and also to launch the supremacy of dharma.

Vaikunda Swamigal also familiar in Hindu myths. He had his penance at Muttapathi and Ambalappathi and had spiritual understandings. He gained miraculous powers and claimed Ayyanvilai (Godly Attainments). Due to this, he acquired more number of disciples and supporters in to his fold. He acknowledged that he was born to rescue the Shanars and to launch rule of "Dharma". He assumed the title of "Sri Vaikunda Swamigal" and began campaigning the message of love, equality, oneness of god and universal brotherhood. He termed himself as the incarnation of Lord Vishnu.

Vaikuntha Swamigal acknowledged the position of Ayya to all his followers. His followers are generally named Ayya Vazhi Makkal ('those followers of Ayya') or Anbukodi Makkal after the name of the flag approved by Vaikuntha Swamigal for his movement. He highlighted the idea of "One God, One religion and One Caste". His religious preachings claim to eliminate rituals, music, music instruments and rage in religious practice and worship. Vaikunda Swamigal insists to use sandal, white sand and water for worship. He bans money gift (Kanikkai) in the name of God.

He managed a form of prayer. It was very simple and modest without a priest leading to meditation. He directed the common prayer. It was an ideal communal collective prayer. He stressed the religious equality in his teaching. He inculcated his followers to give up "devil" worship and idol worship. He also requested them not to sacrifices of goats, roosters and pigs to the gods. Not only the animal sacrifices, but no other contribution such as eggs, fried meat and local edibles like Pongal, Murukku, Paniyaram, Avalurundai and Kadaiapal was requested for by the gods. The teachings and the ritual practices articulated by him had two basic aspects. At one level, he strained to change the folk Hinduism of the

Shanars and make it bind with that of the upper castes. At another level, he challenged, the caste-based inequlaities hurt by the Shanars and promised to remove the present Kaliyuga and usher in a golden age of Dharma.

Social Contribution of Vaikunda Swamigal

He was the forerunner revolutionary in the 19th century to raise the voice of protest against the Brahminical-Nair manipulation, distortion and misunderstanding of Hinduism. Vaikunda Swamigal vigorously tried hard to eliminate the inequality centered on birth. So he want to establish a casteless society. He condemned those who separated the society into several groups and measured them as "Nisas" (heartless people). Vaikunda Swamigal organized the "Samathuva Samajam" in 1833 to unite the persons of all castes. This was the first opinion of an association to convey about universal brotherhood, casteless society, creed, religion, economic status, learning, occupation or social status. It just means an association of equality of all in each respect. In spite of caste, many people, including women, joined as members of this Organization. He presumed the status of Lord Krishna and preserved his five major followers as Pancha Pandavas. The five disciples were Sivanandi (Dharman) of Mylaudy, Pandaram (Bhiman) of Kailasapuram, Arjunan (Arjunan) of Pillaiyarkudyiruppu, Subbiah (Nakulan) of Colachel and Hari Gopalan (Sagadevan) of Thamaraikulam. Vaikunda Swamigal also had numerous female disciples. He inculcated his accomplished disciples to preach his ideologies of equality and fraternity to the people.

Vaikunda Swamigal introduced "Samapanthi Bojanam" to abolish the untouchability in the society. It was one of his effective reforms. The supporters of Vaikunda Swamigal from various group of castes, carried food materials. They took water in the Munthiri Kinaru. It was regarded as community well. They cooked food and shared with Vaikunda Swamigal. The people carry on the practice of inter-dinning in the Nizhalthankals till now. Vaikunda Swamigal guided his supporters to follow personal hygiene. The depressed calss people were not familiarized to regular bath and they hardly washed their clothes. The lower caste people were not allowed to draw water from the common ponds, rivers and reservoirs. He directed the lower caste people to break the taboos (offence) and rinse their clothes. The Vaikunda Swamigal also directed his supporters to practice

meditation at Muttapati, a seaside village near Kaniyakumari. He organized Thuvayal Pandhi. In the meditation, there were seven hundred families of different castes from different regions attended.Vaikunda Swamigal trained his followers to teach purity of thought and action through this association.

During his period the depressed community people were not allowed to build any stone houses in the road sides. Their houses were miserable huts. Vaikunda Swamigal desired to make his supporters to live in the cluster houses. Hence he requested their followers to build compound aired houses with sufficient and additional rooms, close to each other. He also instructed them to build their houses in a even order and to afford each house with doors on four ways.This was called as the Samathuva Kudiyiruppu .

He believed in self-respect. He aroused his people to fight against social disabilities and restrictions even on dressing. As a mark of their assertion of rights, he directed his followers to revolt against the caste Hindus. The lower caste people were not allowed to touch the Brahmins and it was considered as impurity. So Vaikuntha Swamigal used to put thiruman" (sacred soil) on the forehead of his followers. Now in Pathi or Nizhalthankal, the head places the thiruman on the forehead of the believers. It indicated that touching the head or any part of the body does not spoil a person. He prepared his supporters to wear head turban at the time of worship. It is believed that it will increase the confidence in the minds of the devotees. Turban is a symbol of self-respect and bravery. It indicated a mark of caste superiority. According to his advice, many Tamil people started to wear Turbans in their areas as the mark of royalty. Vaikunda Swamigal vehemently protested to Brahminism and Brahminical form of Hinduism. He thought that it was the major cause for the over-all decadence of the lower caste people. He believed that his followers are not slaves to any humans but only to the Almighty.

The Ayyavazhi was spread in many parts of the southern districts of Tamil Nadu and Kerala. He inscribed two important religious books, namely Akilathirattu and Arulnool. Both the books comprise his religious and social teachings. The life and mission of Sri Vaikunda Swamigal establish an important land mark in the history of social liberation of the depressed caste movement in Tamil Nadu.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. How will be called the followers of Vaikunda Swamigal?
2. Which year Samathuva Samajam was established?
3. What were the books written by Vaikunda Swamigal?

6.4 Vallalar

Saint Ramalingam was popularly known as Vallalar. He was born on the 5th October 1823 at Marudur a small hamlet near Chidambaram. His parents were Ramaiah Pillai and Chinnamai. In his Peruvinnappam (Grant appeal). He mentions how his soul took active part in getting the divine inner light of protection even when he was in his mother's womb. When he was an infant just five months old, his parents went to Chidambaram, taking him with them. They attended the 'puja' at the temple of Lord Nataraja. The screen in front of the deity was removed and all had 'darshan'. The little child also saw the Lord without winking his eyes and laughed somewhat loudly. Later when the saint again visited Chidambaram in his 34th year and lived there for a considerable time, he recollected this incident so vividly that he mentioned this in one of the poems addressed to Lord Nataraja with a note about his experience at the time. He addresses the Lord as his real relative who revealed to him alone the entire divine vision. This was the first mystic vision, among others, that the saint had.

On the death of his father, when Ramalinga was only just one year old, his family shifted to Ponneri, near Madras. Therefore he spent his childhood in his brother's house in Chennai. His brother was a good Tamil scholar but he fail to demonstrate him. So he sent Ramalingam to a savior Sabapathi Mudaliyar at Kancheepuram. The teacher detected that he recognized every thing by birth. Therefore he sent him back. In Chennai, he stated the temple of Kanthakottam in his poetic work. He wrote his first song at Kanthakottam before the statue of Muruga. Ramalingaswamy, as a boy, was not interested in the routine of learning. At the age of nine, he composed simple Tamil songs spontaneously. He married a girl but he revealed interest in a life of sanyasin. Emerging a deep interest in spiritual life, Ramalingaswamy shifted to Karunguli in 1858, a place near Vadalur where the saint later settled down. His great powers came to be renowned

at the early age of eleven. He visited the temples at Chidambaram, Sirkali, Vaideeswaran Koil, Nagapattinam and Madurai. It was at Karunguli that the Saint wrote the first four stanzas of his work Thiru Arutpa (Songs of Divine Grace) which altogether covers six. He stayed at Karunguli for nine years. He built a temple at Vadalur and he called it as Uttra Gana Chidambaram. He consumed most of his time in meditation and in devotion. So this period stretches a great transformation in his ideas.

Ramalinga Swamigal became a sanmargi after spending nine years of loneliness and meditation. He did not halt with that he desired to found a new social order on the basis of his understanding. He nominated Vadalur as the place to found a society based upon love and honesty. He remained for a period of four years from 1867 to 1870. He established the Sathya Dharumachalai in Vadalur 1867 for nurturing the poor and the hungry. This practice is continued till date at the place. He moved to Mettukuppam in 1870, a place three miles away from Vadalur. In Mettukuppam, he sang the sixth stanza of his work and began to build the Sathya Gnana Sabai in 1872. In Sathya Gnana Sabai, his followers worshipped Light.

Saint Ramalinga introduced the unique method of worship to his followers. He did not follow any caste distinction in his worship. The person who officiate the worship inside the sanctum was selected on basis of his pure life and not by his caste. After the four years of staying at Vadalur the Saint went back to Mettukuppam near Vadalur. He stayed the last part of his life in Chittivalaham. He gave series of lecturers at intervals during his lonesome hours. On January 30, 1874 he entered in his room at Chittivalaham and asked his followers to lock the door. He also instructed his disciples not to open it for some time. But when a year later the place was opened and examined there was nothing to be seen but a vacant room. There he attained the deathlessness.

Saint Ramalingam's understanding of Saivism showed that love is the fundamental philosophy of Saivism. He advocated that the religious practices are meaningless. His religious policy consists of all the good aspects of various religions of South India. His spiritual experience at Chidambaram Nataraja Temple has revealed to him that God is formless. His religious policy is the religion of humanism, love and grace. His love includes all living beings. Whenever there was a plant dried up for water

he should tear. He prohibited animal sacrifice. He advised that God is love and God is there in all living-beings.

Sanmarga Movement

Sanmargam means enquiry into truth, search after truth. Suddha sanmargam is a specific contribution of Saint Ramalinga to the south Indian philosophy.His philosophy purposes at exceeding all the philosophies and religions. He originated the Satya Gnana sabai in which there was no religious practice. The disciples are projected in meditate and focus on their own hearts. He understood that love is the basic for human life and all the religions and philosophies are constructed on love. He observed the disappointments and worries of all the living beings within himself. The life is assumed in order to support others and to part the sufferings of others. The Saint Ramalinga insisted the four divisions of disciplines. Saint Ramalinga also imparted the disciplines that man should monitor in his daily life. They are :

1. The discipline of the senses (Indirya Olukkam)
2. The discipline of the faculties (Karma Olukkam)
3. The discipline of the life (Jiva Olukkam) and
4. The discipline of the spirit (Anma Olukkam)

These four partitions are called as Sanmarga Olukkam. Saint Ramalinga stresses the significance of the self-controlled life in his Sanmarga Suddha Sanmargam.

The discipline of the senses (Indirya Olukkam)

It comprises of listening carefully to the sounds of songs of prayer and not other sounds. One should avoide the hearing harsh sounds, keeping away from dirtiness, barring forbidding sights, and not loving perfumes. The discipline of action of the senses also consists of the speaking kind words, not saying untruth, prevention by all means of brutality to living beings, going to wise-men, that is familiarizing.

The discipline of the faculties (Karma Olukkam)

This consists of the focusing one's attention upon the Hall of Wisdom, without being diverted by other deviances, not checking the faults of other people, disgarding egoism, and becoming one with the spirit of nature, not being annoyed with others.

The discipline of life (Jiva Olukkam)

This consists of the standing by oneself in relationship to others, with out the dissimilarities of caste, creed, community sect, custom, scripture, country, means feelings of superiority and inferiority, etc.

The discipline of the spirit (Anma Olukkam)

This consists of the showing kindness to the uncountable number of souls of the several species, and handling the soul as the Divine Hall and its Inner Light as the Lord, existing in supreme oneness and perfection. Saint Ramalinga described these principles in his address at Chitivalaham to his followers for accomplishing the supreme goal of the deathless life. One who follows these disciplines will achieve the goal of the deathless life.

His mission did not succeed as he expected. The main reason for this is that the members of the Sangam violated his principles. They began to worship him as God and began to eat meat. And there was no dynamic disciple like Vivekananda to Ramakrishna to carry his message far and wide. Vallalar realized the dangers of the caste system. The caste divides man from the rest of mankind. Love unites human beings. He attacked caste system more vehemently. Vallalar condemned the materialistic minded people for their treatment of poor and sufferings. His teachings through prose, poems and letters pointout the integration among the human beings and to promote the universal brotherhood. It laids to frame the universal religion, God and society.

The saint Ramalinga uses the term jeevakarunyam to denote compassion. Jeevakarunyam according to him is human sympathy. His contention is that all people whether good or evil kind or cruel, male or female whether belonging to this caste or that caste to one nation or to another do have this right to live and to let live. It could be stated that Vallalar's phiolosphy encompassed the welfare of all. His concept of transmulation had a subtle philosophy which could be propounded only by great mystics. No wonder, it failed to draw the attention of the common people for whom the concept of deathlessness was a highly sophisticated philosophy.

Check Your Progress Questions

4. Which year Sathiya Dharumachalai was established?
5. Howmany divisions Thiru Arutpa have?
6. When was the Sathaya Gnana Sabha established?

6.5 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. Ayya Vazhi
2. 1833
3. Akilathirattu and Arulnool.
4. 1867
5. 6
6. 1872

6.6 Summary

- The Indians came in contact with the western culture.
- The educated Indians revived the glory of their own culture and attempted to reform it.
- The Tamil intellectuals like Valalar, Vaikunda Swamigal and others may be the cause for the upliftment of the society and promotion of humanism.
- Vaikunda Swamigal was born in A.D 1808 at Sasthankoilvilai, the present Samithoppu in Kanyakumari.
- Vaikunda Swamigal assumed the status of Ayya to all his followers.
- His followers are generally called Ayya Vazhi Makkal.
- He led a form of prayer. It was very simple without a priest leading to meditation.
- He stressed the concept of "One God, One religion and One Caste". His religious preachings insist to remove rituals, music, music instruments and anger in religious practice and worship.
- Vaikundaa Swamigal tirelessly tried hard to remove the inequality based on birth and thereby to establish a casteless society.
- To unite the people of all castes, Vaikunda Swamigal established the Samathuva Samajam in 1833.
- Vaikunda Swamigal recommended his followers to observe personal hygiene.

- Saint Ramalingam was popularly known as Vallalar.
- He selected Vadalur as the place to found a society based upon love and honesty.
- After spending nine years in isolation and meditation he became a sanmargi.
- Vallalar established the Satya Dharmachalai in 1867 for nurturing the poor and the hungry.
- On January 30, 1874 he entered in his room at Chittivalaham.
- The method of worship laid down by St. Ramalingar was unique.
- No distinction based on caste is evinced in offering worship.
- Vallalar condemned the materialistic minded people for their treatment of poor and sufferings.
- He advised that God is love and God is there in all living-beings.
- The Saint Ramalingaswamigal taught the disciplines that man should follow in his daily life.
- He established the Satya Gnana sabai in which there was no religious practice.
- It could be stated that Vallalar's phiolosphy encompassed the welfare of all.

6.7 Key words

- Dharma – The meaning Dharma is that which sustains the people or that which is adopted by meritorious souls.
- Kaliyuga - In Hinduism, Kali Yuga is the last of the four stages, the world goes through as part of a cycle of yugas.

6.8 Self Assessment questions

Short Answer Questions

1. Write a note on "Ayya vazhi"
2. What do you know about about Sathiya Dharumachalai?

Long Answer Questions

1. Describe the social contribution of Vaikunda Swamigal.
2. Write an essay about the principles of Vallalar.

6.9 Further Readings

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Unit- VII Ayothidas Pandithar

7.0 Introduction

7.1 Objectives

7.2 Ayothidas Pandithar

7.3 Sahajananda

7.4 Muthulakshmi Reddy

7.5 Answers to check your progress questions

7.6 Summary

7.7 Key words

7.8 Self Assessment Questions

7.9 Further Readings

7.1 Introducation

Pandit Ayothidass was another great thinker, writer and fighter for the rights and dignity of human beings. He vehemently criticized the Brahmins and believed that the Brahmins were the real offenders behind the caste system and the practice of untouchability. He used religion for acquiring emancipation identity having socio-political and religeo-cultural bearings. He was not an orthodox rather a pragmatic Buddhist who attempted to radicalize the religion of the oppressed. He wanted Dalits to get away from the clutches of Hinduism. Like him, Swami Sahajananda was also tried to rise the living standards of untouchables at Chidambaram. He labelled for the educational uplift of the oppressed communities. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy, as member of Madras Legislative Council, she helped raise the minimum age for marriage for girls and pushed the Council to pass the Immoral Traffic Control Act, and the Devadasi system abolishment Bill.

7.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Explain the functions of Ayothidasar to uplift the dalits
- Understand the social thoughts of Swami Sahajananda
- Discuss the achievements of Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy.

7.2 Ayothidasa Pandithar

Pandit Ayothidass was was born on 20th May 1845 in Coimbatore, and later lived in Chennai. His actual name was Kathavarayan. Ayothidasar was the adopted name presumed in honour of his tutor. He was a Siddha doctor by job. He was expert in Pali, Sanskrit, and English and, of course in Tamil as well. He utilised all his abilities in criticizing caste and untouchability. He strongly condemned the Brahmins and believed that the Brahmins were the real offenders behind the caste system and for the practice of untouchability. Brahmins, in fact, disallowed caste flexibility and communal harmony.

His transformation into Buddhism directed to the establishment of South Indian Sakya Buddhist Sangha. It was his faith that his bloods incorporated Buddhism under Asoka's empire. In addition to inscriptions, statues and literary cursives that aid as obvious information, Ayothidasar also grabbed into consideration traditional folklore, festivals and theories. Modern history also admits that Buddhism was at one point in time extent across India. Existence of this well-known Buddhism was not only through statues, but persisted through some impenetrable forms and life practices among people, which are features of a definite culture.

Ayothidasar claimed that texts, statues and other visible evidence could have been demolished due to religious attacks, but, the life practices motivated by Buddhism continue as evidence. He also added that opponents of Buddhism, not able to fully eradicate the traces of this religion, either enforced newer forms or biased the existing framework. During the Brahmanical restoration, ancient Tamil Buddhist communities were compulsorily re-converted into Hinduism and thus lowered to the position of slavery. As a result of harassments and oppressions accomplished by the upper caste, these reconverted Buddhists persisted socially under privileged, economically weak and culturally deprieved. To improve their places and recall the lost glory, ayothidasar targeted at the reinforcement of Buddhism among the depressed classes of Tamil Nadu. He thus provoked a silent revolution leading his community followers from a present dependence to a future liberation.

Ayothidasar established the Advaitananda Sabha in 1870 in Ooty and also started the Dravida Mahajana Sabha in 1890. A conference of the Sabha was organized on December 1, 1891 at Ooty. In this conference, ten resolutions were passed and it demanded the civil rights, educational allowances, economic progresses of the depressed castes, due part in government services and access to public wells and ponds. These are as follows,

1. Branding the depressed communities as untouchables should be made illegal by the rigorous legislation.
2. For the campaign of education among the depressed people, every village should be donated with special schools and provided with half-fees reduction for the children of the underprivileged communities.
3. The lower community student scoring high amrks in matriculation, shoukd be provided opportunities and encouragements to follow higher studies atleast three candidates.
4. All the deprived community students clearing matriculation exam should be immersed government positions.
5. On the basis of merit and conduct, children of depressed classes should be given all chances in the government appointments and promotions.
6. Sufficient representation shall be provided to present the complaints of the depressed communities so as to confirm just aspirations of tax paying educated deprived students in matters of government jobs.
7. Rule No 464 from the prison manual should be reconstituted so as to emancipate the depressed caste from the duties of menial jobs inside the jail.
8. All restrictions imposed and obstacles produced on the movements of the depressed communities for the use of drinking water from the public wells and tanks be detached forthwith.
9. All existing discrimination experienced against the deprived communities prohibiting them from the use of chairs and other facilities in the offices where upper castes are worked and in the judicial premises be removed.

10. Candidates with the excellent characters among the depressed communities should be selected as village headman and accountants, whenever district officials visit rural areas, people of the ldepressed community should be provided opportunities to present their grievances and search for remedial measures from the officials.

As a Journalist

Ayothidass started a weekly magazine namely, Oru Paisa Tamilan in 1907, to reveal his concepts and thoughts. It was later renamed as Tamilan on August 26, 1908 under hefty force and advice. He called the journal so only to stimulate the minds of the affected and deal a setback to the vested interests of a few. It is a kind of wordplay or a ridicule the silliness of the Tamil society. The name Oru Paisa Tamilan means that the Tamilian is value one paisa, a mocking attack on the self-respect of every Tamilian. He do not hesitated in revealing social ills and evils without fear and favour. He circulated acts of omissions and commissions and actions of discriminations pampered by the public officials. One such letter eas printed against the Inspector General of Registration, the person known as Srinivasa Raghava Iyengar. Ayothidasar's "Tamilan" was dispersed far and wide covering far places such as Burma, Malaysia and South Africa. His publications are numerous in number. Among them, "History of the Real Brahmin", "History of the False Brahmin", "Siddhantha Thirumana Kathai" and so on. He appraised the distortions and fabrications in Tamil bhakti books like Sekkizhar's Periya Puranam, Harichandra Puranam and on the birth history of Thiruvalluvar. He was vigorously involved in constructing the structure for alternative history. Indra Desa Sarithram (1912) which was a sequences in his magazine Tamizhan and later published as a book, argued subaltern politics from the view of Dalits. His book Adhivedam (1912) discusses about the life history of Buddha.

Ayothidasar tried to re-establish ancient Tamil society initiated on the Sangam principles and exciting morals of Thiruvalluvar. He laid the fundamentals for the spirit of enquiry, enthrowment of the self respect and the liberation of intellect from irrational and outdated traditions and customs of the Brahmanical convention.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. Name the Tamil journal started by Ayothidasar.
2. Which year the Dravidian Mahajana Sabha was established?

7.3 Sahajananda

Sahajananda was born on 27th January, 1890 at Melpudhupakkam, a village near Kancheepuram in Tamil Nadu. His parents were Annamalai and Alamelu. They were from a deprived peasant laboring class. His real name was Munusamy. Even at a very small age, he has exposed great qualities of piety, honesty and simplicity.

He completed his elementary education at American Arcot Mission School, Pudupakkam, and secondary education at Tindivanam American Arcot Mission School in 1901. During his time, when the educational opportunities were not merely rebutted to the lower classes but even considered as unacceptable to the poorest among the untouchables. Even the teaching community could not digest the very sight of the poor and inferior untouchable children, rubbing shoulder with to shoulder with their rich higher caste classmates. He sustained his distinctions in studies at high school. As a result, his teachers altered his name into "Sigamani" exactly meaning the "top ranker". They also realized that his services to Christianity would be valuable and abundant. Thus, they tried to convert him as a Christian. But he omitted it with respect. In those days, it required a daring of conviction to discard such offer which released various opportunities to arise in life.

Sahajananda's family travelled to Kolar in search of a employment and he was fascinated to spiritualism there. Due to poverty, Sajajananda had to give up his studies and joined as a labour assistant to his parent. They were working at the Kolar Gold Fields. There, he not ever failed to appear Hindu religious speeches. Saint Pundarika's life motivated him and the saint became a model of his own livelihood.

As a Sanyasi

Sahajananda embraced Sanyasa in 1906, at the age of 16. He sustained his spiritual studies and preserved spiritual progress with the help

of numerous educated religious scholars. He maintained contact with lot of spiritual leaders, and one of them, Karapadi Swami of Vyasarpadi. He recommended him to work for the prosperity of Paraiyars in Chidambaram. It was he who called him Sahajananda. He sustained his legendary pursuits alongwith spiritual studies. Sahajananda traveled a number of places and met abundant intellectuals of the contemporary Tamil Nadu. He learned Thirukkural form V.O.Chidambaram Pillai and Tamil grammar with Thiru.Vi.Kalyana Sundaram at Chennai. He also studied Sanskrit with the assistance of Srinivasa Achariya at Srirangam. Thus, in a small period, he accustomed himself with numerous classical texts in Tamil as well as in Sanskrit.

His services

Sahajananda reached Chidambaram for his literary and spiritual accomplishments in 1910. He contributed in several literary and spiritual addresses in Chidambaram. He overwhelmed the learned scholars from all over Tamil Nadu. It was at this time, he was also engaged in printing journals and books. He published books like “Our origins”, “ The abolition of untouchability”, “ Commentary on Upanishads” , “ The secret of Chidambaram Nadarajar”, “ Untouchability is anti-spiritual”, “ Depressed Communities” and “ Labour protection laws and Government responsibilities”.

Sahajananda was utilised by Nagarathar people for the propagation of values of philosophies of Hinduism and Tamil culture all over the world. From 1914 to 1928, he journeyed to Burma, Malaysia, Singapore and Ceylon. etc. His services were greeted by the business communities of Tamil Nadu established in all these places stayed by him. He started a mutt and a trust in the name of Nandanar in Chidambaram in 1916. Nandanar was a medieval Paraiyar devotee and one of the sixty three Saivite saints. The Nandanar Mutt also identified as Nandanar Mahajana Sabha and popularly named as Nandanar Kalvi kazhagam. The Adi Dravida symposiums and seminars were held in 1919 and 1920 in this Nandanar Mutt, He was also performed as the President of Nandanar Mutt. He was popularly pronounced as “Modern Nandanar”. He also founded the Nandanar school at Chidambaram for the deprived class people in 1916.

Twenty-five students were acknowledged to his Nandanar School. The important task is 52 acres of waste land was given to him to build an educational institution. The district officials allowed the public land for the education purpose. He encouraged education for depressed class girls. Mahatma Gandhi visited the Nandanar School in 1926 and 1934. He honoured him for his deadly religious-cum-educational activities to the depressed classes. . He generated funds for the family of freedom fighter V.O. Chidambaram Pillai. Sahajananda found to his disappointment that his people were not allowed to enter into thr Chidambaram temple. So he erected a separate temple from public contribution at Thirupunkar. He fixed a statue of Lord Nataraja and organized a car festival in which Nataraja was drawn by Scheduled class people along the four streets. As a token of honour to his service, after his death in 1960, a statue was mounted by Government of Tamil Nadu.

Social reforms

Sahajananda debated that dalits were not depressed,not untouchables in each and every dalit meetings and religious conferences. He also condemned the practice of untouchability in the name of caste. Through this argument he strained his best to eliminate the untouchable humiliation among his class. In those days the Dalit people were full of superstitions. He attempted to remove such practices away from them. In 1917 Sahajananda presented a satyagraha to touch the water of the sacred tank of Omekalam, for which he was impeached. He participated the conference of the All India Depressed Classes Federation, convened at Nagpur in 1932. He got elected for three times to Chennai State Assembly. He was selected member of the Madras Legislative Council in 1926, and he continued as a member till 1945. Later he was again elected as a member of the Madras Legislative Assembly in 1947. He played active role in bringing laws to safeguard the Adi Dravidas. He published journals and distributed research articles, authorized some books on the evils of untouchability, renunciation of temple entry to the dalist etc. He tried hard for the spread of education, vocational training and equal opportunities for the depressed classes.

His generous and vigorous speeches in the Legislative Assembly attracted the attention of the entire house. He earned a popular title called" Father of the House". He continued in that office till his death in 1959.

Check Your Progress Questions

3. What is the real name of Sahajananda?
4. Where was he started the Nandanar Mutt?
5. From whom Sahajananda learned Thirukkural?

7.4 Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy

Dr. Muthulakshmi hailed from a socially handicapped environment in an era when girls were born only to be married. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy was a first woman in many respects. She was the first woman in the Rajah's College, Pudukkottai and first lady in medical graduate of Madras University in 1912 and became the first Indian woman member of a Legislative Council in 1927. She became the first woman house surgeon in the Government Maternity and Ophthalmic Hospital, Chennai. She was a forerunner in the contest for social and political progress of women in India. Particularly, she tried to abolish the notorious devadasi system that was broadly prevailing in all parts of Tamil Nadu and some parts of South India. She devoted her life to social service, particularly to the cause of women and children's prosperity. A crusader of women's rights, she disbursed her livelihood for the freedom of women.

Early life of Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy

Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy was born in Pudukkottaidistrict in Tamil Nadu on 30th July 1886. She was the eldest daughter of S.Narayanasamy Iyer and Chandrammal Narayanasamy. Dr.Muthulakshmi Redy was send to "Thinnai Palli" to learn his primary eduaction when she was four years old.. The purpose of her education was to having arithmetical necessary to know the milk and the laundry charges. In those days, girls never admitted into Maharaja College in all its history.

In 1903 Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy was joined as the first Girl student in Pudukkottai Maharajah's college with the special consent of the Maharaja. She was very genuine and hard working student. She accomplished her studies by state scholarship. She became master in the

workings of legends like Shakespeare, Tenneyson and Milton. Thus Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy showed her knowledge in English literature.

Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy joined Madras Medical College at the age of twenty.Sshe acquired close relationship with political leaders, social reformers and doctors. She mounted first and secured several gold medals and Honours, cerificates in medicine, surgery and midwifery. She progressed as the first Indian woman Doctor.Muthulakshmi Reddy married Dr. T. Sundara Reddi in April, 1914. He was also a famous doctor.

Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy was motivated by the leaders like Vivekananda and Mahatma Gandhi, Josephine Butler, Annie Besant and Maragaret Cousin. Her contact with Mrs. Standford, a theosophist from South Africa protected her in many ways. She was a follower of Gandhi and his ideologies. Muthulakshmi Reddy went to England In 1925, on a Government of India subsidy to concentrate in the disease of women and children. She was associated with the Women's Indian Association of Madras from1917. She was also one of the organizers of the Muslim Ladies' Society of the Indian ladies.

Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy was selected by the Nationalist Women's Organization of India to denote Indian women and provide suggestion at the Third Round Table Conference in England. She also represented World Women's Congress in Chicago. During this period, Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy was recommended by the Viceroy to work on the Sir Philip Hartog Education Commission. This commission was designed to evaluate educational assignments in India and Burma. She reconciled from the Legislative Council and the Deputy Presidentship during the time of Salt Sathyagraha Campaign.

Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy as a Legislator

Muthulakshmi Reddy functioned effectively Legislative Council between 1927 and 1930. She was designated as a member of the Madras Legislative Council in 1926. Thus she became the first women legislator. She was also unanimously elected as Deputy President of the council in 1928. But she resigned in 1930 to object the imprisonment of Gandhi in the salt sathyagraha. She tried to eradicate the social evils which were practiced in the society. The legislation to eradicate the immoral devadasi system that was commonly widespread in Tamil Nadu and also Karnataka

and Andhra Pradesh. She faced hard opposition from the Congress party especially by Satyamurthi Iyer. The Immoral Traffic Control Act, the Act to Prevent Cruelty to Children, rising the age of permission of girls for marriage and various other acts of social reform were passed into laws during this period, completely because of her efforts. As a legislator and hard worker for women's empowerment, she thought that 'laws and legislation are there only for permission. It is up to women to strengthen these and appliance them into action. She hosted necessary medical checkup to all school children. Child welfare centres were established in many places and separate women doctors of health were employed. Muthulakshmi Reddy also introduced and protected amenities for the advancement of girl's education. She functioned hard for the formation of many number of girl's schools. She also motivated to begin health centres for children, and extension of maternity and child welfare work in the Presidency.

Her Welfare Activities

Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy rendered somany welfare activities in Tamil Nadu. Her services included the organization of the first Vigilance Association in Madras and the formation of the first Rescue Home for Women. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy was the secretary of the Vigilance Association for extensive period. She was the life behind the Children Aid Society, a home for antisocial children. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy functioned against social discrimination. She felt that this was the fundamental cause of social deterioration. It was her ardent principle that no woman, should persist uneducated. Muthulakshmi Reddy was mentioned to as the great scholar 'Avvai', who imparted that men and women might go without food but never without education. She escaped from child marriage, and denied to give up her studies. With the assistance of Dr. Soundaram Ramachandran, the daughter of T.V. Sundaram Iyengar, she started "Gandhian Village" after getting an approval from Gandhi himself.

Birth of the Avvai Home, Orphanage and Schools

The only accommodation for Hindu girls in 1930, were two hostels in Madras, one for Brahmin and the other for non-Brahmin women, an intolerable division. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy's eradication of the devadasi

system freed the women from the evil chains of dedication at temples. One evening, somewhere in June of 1930, three young girls reached at her house, looking for shelter. They had nowhere to go; the relatives of those girls would not permit them in. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy mentioned them to the correspondent of the hostels, of which Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy herself was the Medical Consultant. They were exposed to the worst verbal abuse and returned the same night to Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy, anxious and weeping. This was certainly an emergency and required an immediate result. The girls had required shelter and security to lead a normal life. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy not only acknowledged the challenge but confirmed her total commitment to the cause of women. The Avvai Home was born in her own residence.

Avvai Home was shifted to a rented building in Mylapore and in 1936 moved to Adyar where it remains to function today. Even though it was originally set up for the safeguard and education of the liberated girls of the devadasi community, the Avvai Home converted into a refuge for all women and children who wanted protection and education. It was a home to afford protection, food and accommodation without social or caste blockades. It was almost an 'open house'. Dr. Muthulakshmi educated the girls and women of the home in the local schools. Later, the Avvai Home provided education to the under privileged people in large way. The basic education school at Avvai Home was opened in 1950. Numerous women were accomplished as nurses or teachers till they were economically feasible.

Various Positions

Dr. Muthulaksmi Reddy became the honorary secretary and organizer of the Madras Children's Aid Society and organized a Juvenile Court for Junior and senior certified schools. She became the president of the 5th All India Women's Conference held at Lahore. She was also the Chairman of the Asian Committee of the All Asian Conferences of women. In 1937, she became the first Alderwomen of the Madras Corporation for two years. During this period she worked to solve the beggar problem, child welfare and children's education. Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy was the active member of the Women's Indian Association since its inception in

1917. She became its vice-president and then its president after the death of Dr.Annie Besant in 1933.

Abolishing of Devadasi system

The Madras Devadasis (Prevention of Dedication) Act (also called the Tamil Nadu Devadasis (Prevention of Dedication) Act or the Madras Devadasi Act) is a law that was passed on 9 October 1947. The law was enacted in the Madras Presidency and provided devadasis the legal right to marry and announced it illegal to donate girls to Hindu temples. The bill that became this act was the Devadasi Abolition Bill. Before the bill developed law, devadasis were not allowed to marry and were connected to Prostitution and immoral professions by the society. Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy previously anticipated the devadasi aboliton bill to the Madras Legislative Council in 1930. During the period of the Non Co-operation movement, she directed the policy of All India Women's conference. She involved in the national movement.

Cancer Institute

To redress the suffering, she started the Anti-Cancer movement in 1936. It was again renewed in 1949. By her tireless efforts, the Cancer Institute came into existence in 1936 at Adayar, Madras.

After 82 years of service Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy respired her last on 22nd July, 1968. Due to her education, Muthulakshmi Reddy overcome great moral bravery and self confidence. Her mind was more ethical and her action were socially bent up. She was associated Brahmo Samaj, but she believed in equality of all relions. She regarded service to humanity as service to God. Such a great social worker was honoured with the title of Padma Bhusan by the Government of India as a recognition of her services for the women and children of India.

Check Your Progress Questions

6. When was Avvai Home established?
7. Wher did Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy started the cancer institute?

7.5 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. Oru Paisa Tamilan
2. 1890
3. Munusamy

4. Chidambaram
5. V.O.Chidambaram
6. 1930
7. Adayar

7.6 Summary

- Pandit Ayothidass was was born on May 20, 1845 in Coimbatore.
- His conversion into Buddhism led to the establishment of South Indian Sakkiya Buddhist Sangha.
- Ayothidasar founded the Advaitananda Sabha in 1870 in the Nilgris and the Dravida Mahajana Sabha in 1890.
- To express his ideas and thoughts Ayothidass started a weekly, magazine namely, Oru Paisa Tamilan in 1907, which was later renamed as Tamilan on August 26, 1908
- Ayothidasar attempted to re-establish ancient Tamil society founded on the Sangam ideals and inspiring ethics of Thiruvalluvar.
- Sahajananda was born on 27th January, 1890 at Melpudhupakkam, a village closer to Kancheepuram.
- In 1906, at the age of 16, Sahajananda accepted Sanyasa.
- He continued his spiritual studies and maintain spiritual progress with the help of several learned religious scholars.
- He took active part in bringing laws to protect Adi Dravidas.
- Sahajananda printed journals, distributed research articles authorized numerous books on the evils of untouchability, denial of temple entry to the dalist etc.
- He formed a mutt and a trust in the name of Nandanar, a medieval Paraiyar devotee and one of the 63 Saivite saints, in Chidambaram in 1916.
- Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy was the first woman medical graduate of Madras University in 1912 and became the first Indian woman member of a Legislative Council in 1927.
- In 1927, she became the first women legislator.
- Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy earlier proposed the devadasi aboliton bill to the Madras Legislative Council in 1930.

- Dr. Muthulaksmi Reddy became the honorary secretary and organizer of the Madras Children's Aid Society
- In 1930, she founded the Avvai Home at Adayar for the neglected women irrespective of caste and creed.
- The basic education school at Avvai Home was opened in 1950.
- Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy was the active member of the Women's Indian Association since its inception in 1917.
- Dr. Muthulakshmi Reddy previously anticipated the devadasi aboliton bill to the Madras Legislative Council in 1930.
- To restore the suffering, she started the Anti-Cancer movement in 1936.
- She involved in the national movement.
- She was honoured with the title of Padma Bhusan by the Government of India.

7.7 Key words

- Advaita - one of the two principal Vedantic schools, asserting the existence of Brahman alone.
- Mutt - A mutt is a term used for a Hindu monastic and or religious establishment with a lineage, which has rules and is hierarchical.

7.8 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. What are the services of Dravida Mahajana Sabha?
2. Write about the social work of Sahajananda.
3. Write a short note on Avvai Home.

Long Answer Questions

1. Assess the contribution of Ayothidasar to the depressed community.
2. Describe the services of Swami Sahajananda.
3. Evaluate the role of Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy to the upliftment of women.

7.9 Further Readings

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Unit VIII Bharathiyar- Bharathidasan

8.0 Introduction

8.1 Objectives

8.2 Bharathiyar

8.3 Role in Freedom Movement

8.4 Bharathidasan

8.5 Answers to check your progress questions

8.6 Summary

8.7 Key words

8.8 Self Assessment Questions

8.9 Further Readings

8.0 Introduction

The greatest Tamil poet of the twentieth century, Subramania Bharathi, as a great patriot and social reformer, envisages a new social order rid completely of all evils, social and economic which hitherto have been the basis of all social disorder. Before him, Tamil literature mostly was devoid of creativity owing to conventional approach and imagery which made it stagnant and devoid of spontaneous output common to earlier centuries. Like Bharathi, one of the outstanding revolutionary bards of the Tamil country, born in 1891 at Pondicherry. He pursued relentlessly for three decades and seven years, totally identified himself with the cause of the Tamils whose aspirations and frustrations, he exposed with all vehemence and realism in all his poems.

8.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Describe the works of subramania Bharathi to Tamil literature.
- Analyze the contribution of Bharathi to freedom movement
- Understand the rationalistic ideas of Bharathidasan and his literary works.

8.2 Bharathiyar

Subramania Bharathi was born on 11th, December, 1882 at Ettayapuram. His parents were Chinnasamy Aiyar and Lakshmi Ammal. Although Bharathi was a born poet and skilled with the potentials of a mastermind, he learnt the distinctions of Tamil language and poetry through his relationship with the Tamil scholars of the court of Ettayapuram. The title "Bharathi" was conferred upon him at the age of eleven in the court due to his ability to write poems.

He wrote poems at an early age. He admitted in the Anglo-vernacular school at Ettayapuram. His father wanted him to train Bharathi in Engineering. But Bharathi hated English and writing poetry in Tamil. Bharathi was mature in mind, talented in the language and had great talent for poetry. He was married at the age of fifteen to Chellammal. She was a source of inspiration for Bharathi later in life.

Bharathi studied in the Hindu College High School for three years, and continued his education in Varanasi, living with his aunt. He remained in Varanasi for three years. Benares had so fascinated Bharathi that he began dressing in the north Indian style, cutting his hair, growing a moustache, and wearing a huge turban. Thus, during the Benares interim, Bharathi advanced two important interests. The first one was affection for English poetry. Frequently with a book of English poems in hand he would walk along the panels of Ganga, dreaming and thinking. This widnessed the customary perception of poetry with which he had been previously familiar. Inspired greatly by the living past and traditions, he composed poems ignoring all the dead weight of conventionalism that had really retarded the real growth of Tamil literature.

Raja of Ettayapuram after participating Edward VII's darbar at Delhi in 1902 go to Benares. Some of the courtiers who noticed Bharathi suffering poverties requested the Raja to appoint Bharathi into his service. The Raja approved and Bharathi returned to Ettayapuram. During the next two years Bharathi managed relaxed life, reading the papers to the Raja and performing as sort of a poet mate to him. Bharathi was really irritated by the emptiness of court life and the conditions of disparity between persons. Bharathi departed from Ettayapuram to the nearby town of

Madurai. He was enthusiastic to explore things. The gates to liberty now raised wide open for him. He caught a job as a teacher of Tamil in Sethupathi High school on the first of August 1904 by the assistance of his friend M.Gopala Krishna Iyer. But this lasted till November 10, 1904. Then he satrted his career as a journalist in the Swadesamithran office in Madras.

Literary works of Bharathi

Bharathi offered the sub-editorship of Swadesamithran towards the end of November, 1904. This was the kind of work, Bharathi had always wanted to do; It was really suited to his character and it was the channel for his writing talent and a provision for the nation at the critical time in the nation's history. Bharathi Spent many years of his life in Journalism. Eventhough the job of sub-editor helped Bharathi to the conscious of the fertility of the Tamil language, Bharathi was not totally happy with it, since he was never permitted to write an editorial of the newspaper due to his anti British sentiment.

To begin with, his "Suthesa Keethangal" and and "Janma Bhoomi" exposed clearly what kind of man he was and his distinctive feelings that he had given a free vent. Such a man by fervour and ambition, Bharathi soon felt that he was a square peg in a round whole as he found Suthesamithran a moderate paper not a proper medium to put forth all his revolutionary views. Bharathi condemns those who perpetrate caste differences and curses them for their hideous crime. In a Pappapattu he clearly demonstrates that there are no castes and it is a sin to hold one class above the other to facilitate oppression. He visualizes in one of his poems India devoid of inferior and superior castes and men and women dominating and exploiting others.

He desires India a Commonwealth of all people in which the untouchables will be given a place of pride. He was for giving total liberation to the untouchables. To him the low-born Paraiah as our countryman has every right and privilege as the privileged are entitled. Bharathi's journalist activity extended to articles, poems, and stories to other journals such as Swadesamithran, Gnana Bhanu, Arya, a New India and Common wheel. Bharathi's effort at running magazines stopped before

the year 1910. The next five years were difficult years for the poet. He tried to publish his poems in book form. Most of the great works were written in 1912. The Tamil translation of the Bhagavad Gita, Kannan Pattu, Kuyil Pattu and Panchali Sabatham was published that year. He was against any kind of discrimination done to the women. Child marriage and ill-sorted marriage he was totally averse to. He supported enthusiastically widow remarriage. Equally he was against dowry that is claimed by the bridegroom as a price for the dowry system.

8.3 Role in Freedom Movement

An important event in the history of the Indian freedom movement was the conference of the congress in Surat. The extremists decided to take over the congress in this session. Bharathi supported the extremists, and planned to lead the extremist delegates from Madras. V.O.Chidambaram Pillai and Mandayam Srinivasachariyar came to his support and the young extremists travelled to Surat to participate in the congress. Bharathi was captivated by Tilak's appearance and expressiveness after attending the Surat Conference in 1907. He translated a lecture of Tilak authorized. He released a pamphlet of his own experiences in Surat Congress entitled "Our Congress Tour". When Bharathi was very much involved in politics his poetic talent developed as well. He published his "Suthesa Geethangal" and " Gnana Ratham" in 1908.

Bharathi found the life in exile intolerable and decided to leave Pondycherry with his family. After the First World War in November 1918, became out of Pondicherry. He was arrested bu the police in Cudallore. Chellamma and the family went back to Kadayam. After his release from prison Bharathi departed to Kadayam for about two years till the end of November 1920. A meeting between Bharathi and Mahathma Gandhi took place in March 1919 at Madras. When Gandhi came to Madras, Bharathi rewarded a poetical honor to Gandhi. In the last years of his life, Bharathi took a extreme interest in world politics, and he composed about it with a deep indulgent of political science and a extensive knowledge of the historical and cultural background of the countries of the world on whom he was composing. Bharathi was profoundly concerned with Indian freedom movement, as this was his

primary ideal. Subramanya Bharathi was the first in Tamil Nadu who freed the Tamil language and its literature from all its clutches and who paved a new approach for further progress.

According to Mu.Varadarajan "Bharathi is the father of the present era in Tamil, he rescued Tamil literature from the stagnation of the matalayams and petty courts of zamindars and brought it in to the main current of national life". In the words of C.N.annadurai" Bharathi is not merely a bard of nationalism. He was certainly the morning star of reformation".

He passed away on the night of September 11, 1921. For the poet, the inner life is more important than the external life. This inner life is communicated by a poet only in his poetry. We acquire a thorough picture of Bharathi through his poetry alone. Here and there, we find valuable historical information, particularly many facts concerning his inner life dispersed throughout his poetry.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. Under whose palace Bharathiyar worked?
2. Name the school Bharathiyar worked in Madurai.
3. Which year Bharathi became the sub-editor of Suthesamithran?

8.4 Bharathidasan

Among the architects of modern Tamil literature, Bharathidasan live in a important place. He is popularly known as Paventhar. It means king of poems. He was a romantic poet. His original name was Kanaga subbu rathinam. Due to his close association and respect of Bharathi, the Great poet he changed his name as Bharathidasan which means the dedicated disciple of Bharathi. He was born on 29th April 1891 in Pondicherry. His parents were Kanakasabhai Mudaliyar and Lakshmi Ammaiyar. He started his primary education under teacher Tiruppulisamy. He learned Tamil literature under P.A.Periyasamy and Bangaru Pattar. He ranked first in the Pulavar examination in the state at the young age of seventeen. He began his career as a Tamil teacher in the French India. Although Bharathi was his guru Bharathidasan established his own style of writing to spot his individuality and originality. Even during his young age

he prepared himself with knowledge in the Tamil classics. In his formative period he composed many devotional songs and poems on national themes. In later years he wrote many ballads, narratives and epics. They are covered with all aspects of literary brilliance. Bharathidasan is rightly acclaimed as the Wordsworth of Tamil literature. During the National Movement he had a very close connection with the nationalistic leaders like V.O.Chidambaram Pillai, Subramaniya Bharathi, V.V.S.Iyer, Sri Aurobindo and Subramania Siva. This relationship of national leaders stimulated Bharathidasan to write patriotic songs and contributed to the nation's freedom movement.

His Poetic works

Even when very young, he showed perfectly his talents in composing poems under the pennames, kirukkan, kintalkaran and kanteluthuvon which received him the name of Vithantavathi. To begin with, like his master, Bharathiyar, he too praised God, Hinduism and the liberation of his country and befriended with the great freedom fighters like Bharathiyar, V.V.S.Aiyar, Dr. Varatharajulu Naidu and Aurobindo to whom he gave food and shelter even without the knowledge of his parents out of extreme regard and respect for their nationalist sentiment.

He also had contributed his poems and articles to Desabhakthan, Puduvai Kalai Magal, Desopakari, Ananthabodhini and Suthesamithran exposing the cause of national liberation. During his time, it was a custom that a Tamil poet was expected to compose poems in praise of a local god or a popular chieftain or a philanthropist. The pious natured poet subburathinam composed lyrics on Muruga, the presiding god of Mayllam. These devotional songs were later published under the title Sri Mayllam Subramaniyar Thuthi Amuthu. This work is an best example for his mastery over the execution of the musical poems Kirthanas and Chinthu. These poems are the model to his followers. There is a song in this work seeking the grace of Muruga for the liberation of India. From 1929 onwards he had been contributing regularly to Kudiarasu and Pakutharivu highlighting the significance of rationalaism. In order to awake the people and drive them towards the freedom struggle Bharathidasan composed many national songs under the storng influence of Subramania Bharathi.

He traveled on the wave he composed many songs on the national themes. All his songs were published in small book forms.

His social thoughts

In 1928, he joined the camp of Periyar E.V.Ramasamy and became an uncompromising activist against all social evils and injustices, particularly the caste system. He was against all social ceremonies and practices that dishonored Tamils and even avoided the practice of tying 'thali' even in all his family marriages as a true self-rspector as it symbolizes a kind of servitude of women to men. He, in many of his poems not only denounced caste system but its total abolition. As a way to achieve that loftly concept, he advocated fearlessly supremacy of reasoning over faith and inspired many to inquire critically in to the old social traditions and practices. He mercilessly condemned the tyranny of caste hierarchy, challenged with the great conviction the established varna hierarchy and rejected the domination of higher castes to which caste system was an instrument to subjucate the unprivileged whose ignorance and poverty they exploited to their own advantage. He is for blowing off all evils and is for creating a new world where his cardinal principle of self-respect will be in full force.

His persistent efforts for the removal of untouchability and the social regeneration of the untouchables gave a strength to the Dravidian movement which thanks to his poems had instilled self-confidence in the Tamils especially untouchables. He whole-heartedly supports the cause of remarriage of widows. Like Karl Marx he truly praises labour and common efforts of men to win their bread. He is for nationalization of property and there by to bring "wonderous blis to all". The young dynamic poet Bharathidasan thought the economic and social freedom of Tamils rather than to work for the liberation of India. He worked hard for the cause of the Self-respect Movement.

Under the efforts of C.N.Annadurai considerable amount of money was collected and presented to Bharathidasan. On 8th November 1946 he retired from his teaching service. In 1955 he was elected to the Pondycherry Assembly and assumed the seat of speaker. He became the member of Tamil Poet's Association and brought his periodical Kuil. In

1961 he migrated to Chennai there he prepared to make his epic Pandiyan Parisu as a film. He passed away in April 21, 1964 at Chennai. His writings are published in number of volumes, Kudumba Vilakku, Tamil Mullaikadu, Thenamuthu, Bharathidasan Kavithaigal, Stories of Bharathidasan etc. are very notable works. Some of his poems are translated in English.

Bharathidasan was conferred with the title of "Puratchi Kavingar" by C.N.Annathurai. He won the Golden Parrot Prize in 1946 for his play Amaithi-Oomai (Peace and Dumbness). He was given the Sahitya Academy award posthumously in 1970 for his play Pisiranthaiyar. On 9 October 2001, a commemorative stamp of Bharathidasan was released by the Postal Department in Chennai.

Check Your Progress Questions

4. What is the real name of Bharathidasan?
5. Which year Bharathidasan was electrd to Pondicherry Assembly?

8.5 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. Raja of Ettayapuram
2. Sethupathi High School
3. 1904
4. Kanaga Subburathibam
5. 1955

8.6 Summary

- Subramania Bharathi was born on 11 December, 1882 at Ettayapuram.
- The title “Bharathi” was conferred upon him at the age of eleven by the court, in approval of his ability to compose poems.
- He got a job as a teacher of Tamil in Sethupathi High school on the first of August 1904. This lasted till November 10 , 1904.
- Bharathi assumed the sub-editorship of Swadesamithran towards the end of November, 1904.
- He visualizes in one of his poems India devoid of inferior and superior castes and men and women dominating and exploiting others.

- He published his “Suthesa Geethangal” and “ Gnana Ratham” in 1908.
- Bharathidasan’s original name is Kanaka Subburathinam. He was born on 29th April 1891 in Pondicherry.
- He is popularly known as Paventhar means king of poems.
- He is rightly praised as the Wordsworth of Tamil literature.
- The association of national leaders encouraged Bharathidasan to write patriotic songs and contributed to the nation’s freedom movement.
- He composed many songs on the national themes.
- All his songs were published in small book forms.
- In 1928, he joined the camp of Periyar E.V.Ramasamy.
- He mercilessly condemned the tyranny of caste hierarchy.
- He was against all social ceremonies and practices that degraded Tamils.
- In 1955 he was elected to the Pondycherry Assembly and assumed the seat of speaker.
- Due to his reformist ideas he earned the title Puratchi kavingar.
- He was given the Sahitya Academy award posthumously in 1970 for his play Pisiranthaiyar.
- He passed away in April 21, 1964 at Chennai.

8.7 Key words

- Suthesi- a movement for national independence in India boycotting foreign goods and encouraging the use of domestic products.
- Puratchi Kavingar-It means the "Revolutionary Poet. This title is given by Annathurai to Bharathidasan.
- Pavendhar- Paventhar means king of poems.

8.8 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. What is the contribution of Bharathiyar as a journalist?
2. Mention the role of Bharathi in Freedom Movement.
3. Write a note on the literaru works of Bharathidasan.

Long Answer Questions

1. Discuss-“ Bharathi is a National Poet”
2. Explain the social thoughts of Bharathidasan.

8.9 Further Readings

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BLOCK III : RELIGIOUS SAINTS AND ITS IMPORTANCE

Unit- IX Religious Saints and their Intellectual contribution

9.0 Introduction
9.1 Objectives
9.2 Religious Saints and their Intellectual contribution
9.3 Alwars
9.4 Nalayira Divya Prapantham
9.5 Nayanmars
9.6 Answers to check your progress questions
9.7 Summary
9.8 Key words
9.9 Self Assessment Questions
9.10 Further Readings

9.0 Introduction

In the history of Bhakti cult South India occupies a unique place. Bhakti cult was revealed in the form of Saivisim and Vaishnavism. Between the 7th and the 9th centuries, there was beginning of new religious movements led by Nayanars (saints dedicated to Shiva) and Alwars (saints dedicated to Vishnu), who arose from all castes, including those measured 'untouchables', such as the Pulaiyar and the Panars. They hated Buddhists and Jains and discoursed that love for Shiva and Vishnu was the route to salvation. They believed in the principles of love and heroism from the Sangam literature and mixed them with ethics of bhakti. Nayanars and Alvars walked from place to place and composed exceptional poems and music in praise of their deities. Between the tenth and the twelfth centuries, the Chola and Pandya kings constructed impressive temples around the shrines visited by these saint-poets. Their poems were assembled and their religious biographies were composed, and even today, they are evidences of history for contemporary researchers. Alwars and Nayanmars reflected God in the form of love and yoga, Gnana, comradeship and service as means to reach Him. They chanted devotional

songs in the language of the people and conceded on a statewide movement called the Bhakti movement.

9.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Understand the works of religious saints of Saivism and Vaishnavism
- Describe the intellectual contribution of the religious saints
- Discuss the role of Alwars in promoting Vaishnavism
- Explain the role of Nayanmars in promoting the Saivism

9.2 Religious Saints and their Intellectual contribution

The bhakti saints belonged to various sections of society. Around two third of the saints were brahmanas. However, there were also people from other social backgrounds which comprised a washerman, cowherd, weaver, potter, hunter, fisherman and robber. It appears that saints from lower castes had effectively shaped a prominent position in the movement. The bhakti saints can be broadly categorized into two streams the Alwars and Nayanmars.The Alwars were the devotees of Vishnu and the Nayanmars articulated their devotion to Siva. The bhakti movement led by the Alwars in the Tamil country directed to the overthrow of the Jain and Buddhist faiths and the establishment of the supremacy of brahmanical worship.

A major role in this movement was played by the Nayanmar saints like Appar and Sambandar. They vigorously asked the authority of the Jaina and Buddhist faiths by engaging in discussions and performing miracles. Other Nayanmar saints like Sundarar and later Manikkavasakar sustained their aggression and opposition towards the untraditional sects. On the other hand, the Alwar saints silently promulgated the path of Vishnu bhakti and chanted the praises of their lord. Their devotional rigour and continuous appreciation is reflected in the four thousand devotional rhymes that they composed. In south India, a group of saints who converted the religious environment were not only men. Andal was the only woman Alwar saint whereas Karaikal Ammaiyar, Mangaiyarkkarasiyar, and Isainaniyar were Nayanmars saints. The Nayanmars of Saivism spread their principles to the people. The Alwars of

Vaishanvism spread their own doctrines about Lord Vishnu. These two religious are accountable for the decline of the deviating religions of Jainism and Buddhism in this part of the country, which similarly affected other areas.

9.3 Alwars

The term 'Alwar' means 'those who are absorbed in the divine'. There are twelve Vaishnava saints. Vishnu temples generally comprise separate shrines with stone or bronze figures of the twelve Alwars. The Alwar philosophy is severely obliged to the Vedic and Puranic scriptures. The Alwars were also familiar with the agamas which provided them with the actual worship of the icons. Like the Saiva Nayanmars who preached the greatness of Lord Siva, the Alwars, followed by acharyas propogated by the Vaishnavite faith. They have surrendered to the Lotus feet of Lord Vishnu. The devotees of Lord Vishnu or Narayana are identified as Vaishnavas and are extent over time and place in the subcontinent over the centuries, before and after the Common Era. They have submerged themselves in the elegance and glory of Vishnu. They have visited the Vaishnava temples all over the country and composed songs in praise of Vishnu. They contributed much for the spread of Vaishnava religious thinking.

There are only few mentions to Lord Vishnu in the Rig Veda. The first reference in Tamil literature is to be originate in the Paripadal, one of the ten long poems of the Tamil Sangam literature. Lord Vishnu is denoted to as Mayavan accompanied by two other Tamil Gods, Murugan and Kotravai. In the later Upanishadic periods, Lord Krishna is raised to a Godhead in the Bhagavad Gita. In the fourth chapter, He Himself declares– "Whenever righteousness (dharma) fails and unrighteousness raises its head, I come to birth on earth." The Bhakti movement, for the first time in the history of the subcontinent, bounded from the Tamil country during the 7th and 9th centuries. The Alwars were the famous authors of the great and well-known collection of the Nalayirappirabandam or Divyappirabandam.

The early Alwars

The early Alwars were three in number. The first three Alwars were known as Poykai, Butham and Pey. They moved from one shrine to another in search of god. The first Alwar Poykai perceived god's presence

through his supreme knowledge. All of them hailed from Pallava country. According to legend Poykaiyalvar was born on a golden lotus in a Kanchi tank. Bhutathalvar was born on a Madhavi flower in Mahabalipuram. Peyalvar was born in a crimson lilly in Triplicane. The songs of these early Alwars are the early poems of Vaishnavism. The experience of divine grace by the Alwars reflected through their songs. According to the belief of the orthodoxVaishnavites, the Alwars were the incarnation of the sacred weapons and vehicles of Lord Vishnu.

Thirumalisai Alwar

Thirumalisai Alwar was the first non-Brahmin Alwar in the Vaishnava school, beleonged to the Pirampar caste and was called Thiruvalan. He was born at Thirumalisai. He has composed two poems. One is Nan Mukhan Thiru Anthathi of 100 venbas. In this work he spits his bitterness against the Saivits, Jains and Buddhists. The other work describes his birth as the son of rishi and his growth under the care of a hunter. He has mastery over the Tamil and Sanskrit. He remained at Kumakonam in his final days.

Nammalvar

Nammalvar is considered as the greatest of the Alwars and his contributions to the Dhivya Prabandham is more than a section of the complete text. Nammalwar composed four poems called Thiruvirutham, Thirivasiriyam, Periya Thiruvandathi and Thiruvaymoli which were designated as four vedas by the Sri-Vaishnava. They are rich sources of theology practiced by the great leaders, and Nammalvar is regarded as one of the greatest Indian spiritualists, the others being, Manickavasagar, the Saiva saint and Kabir, spiritual poet of the Bhakti movement. His cantos are full of Vedic and Upanishadic teachings and measured as “Tamil Vedas.”

Kulasekara Alwar

Other significant Alwar is Kulashekhara. He was a Chera prince visited Srirangam, Kanchi and Thiruvenkadam and accomplished Mukthi at Mannarkoil. He is exclusive amongst the Alwars in many ways. He had mastery over the Tamil and Sanskrit languages. He composed “Perumal Tirumoli” which have ten poems with 105 verses. Mukundamalai was his first work in Sanskrit. Kulasekara Alwar held the Bhagavatars (devotees of

Lord Vishnu) in a high respect. Once, it is said, his ministers, who were depressed with his devotion to the Bhagavatars, hidden a valuable pearl necklace which he used to beautify Lord Vishnu's statue during prayer. They then accused the Bhagavatars who were staying the king at the time. The king was furious with this. He ordered to get a clay pot with a cobra in it and retained his hand inside it, saying that if it was correct that the Bhagavatars had stolen the jewel, the snake will bite him. The cobra did not bite him and thus the Bhagavatars were defensible of this accusation.

Kulasekara Alwar was very excited to Lord Vishnu in his incarnation of Rama. Due to this, consequent saints of the Vaishnavite institution of the Tamil land named him "Kulasekara Perumal." He was loving of listening to the telling of Ramayana in the Royal Court. Once when a religious scholar was describing the difficulty met by Lord Rama in fighting the Ravana, Kulasekara Alwar got so disturbed that he immediately ordered his army general to guide troops to the aid of Rama at once because of his devotion to the God Rama. Instantly, the scholar consoled the king that there was no need for such action as Rama had conquered in the war.His poems are supremely lyrical in quality with lot of emotional content.

Periyalvar

Periyalvar was a Brahmin of Srivilliputhur. His other names are Vishnu Chittan and Pattar piran. He composed his songs on the life and journey of Lord Krishna. He is said to have astonishingly oppressed spiritual controversialities in the Pandya court and conveyed the Pandya king within the domain of Vaishnavism. He was at the end of the eighth century. He was also a contemporary of the Pandya king Srimara Srivallaba. His adopted daughter was the famous Andal.

Madurakavi Alwar

Madurakavialvar was born in Thirukkalur in Tuticorin district. He became a fervent follower of Nammalvar. When Nammalvar chanted in praise of Narayana, Madurakavi took down the cantos. Madurakavi Alwar decisively thought that salvation could be accomplished only through Vaishnava acharyas. Nammalvar answerd suitably to his theoretical question. Hereafter Madurakavi considered him as his master and Gnana guru. He recorded Nammalvar's Thiruvaymoli poems in palm leaves for

his master. Madurakavi Alwar used to say that he knows no other God rather than Nammalvar, his spiritual Guru.

Thondaradipodi Alwar

Thondaradipodi Alwar was a native of Thirumandangudi. His other name was Vippira Narayanar. He lived in the Chola country in the later part of the 8th century A.D. He was wel versed in Vedas. Thondaradipodi Alwar means one who has cleaned himself with the dirt of the feet of the devotees. It demonstrates how an abandoned offender could acquire the highest salvation through the Lord's elegance. He wrote two poems, Thirumalai that comprises of forty five songs and Thiruppalli Eluchi which has ten songs. He built a outer wall at Srirangam temple. Kulasekara Alwar in his "Perumal Thirimoli" highlights the importance of Thondaradippodi.

Thirumangai Alwar

Thirumangai Alwar was a kallar chief of Mangai near Sirkali. His father was a kallar general under the Chola kingdom. His marriage with Kumudavalli was a milestone in his life. At her request he provided food to the thousands of Bhagavatas daily. He traveled the entire Tamil Nadu visiting Vaishnava temples. He composed totally 1253 verses in praise of Vishnu. His poems directed his level of scholarship. The Prabandam includes six poems composed by him. Thirumangai Alwar visited 88 out of 108 Vishnu temples. He constructed the third prakaram at Srirangam at greater cost. For it expenses, he demolished the golden image of Byddha at Nagapattinam. He never hesitated to plunder the wealth of Saivites Also.

Andal

Andal was the adopted daughter of Periyalvar. He found Andal in his flower garden. Though Periyalvar was a bachelor he brought up this girl as his daughter.The only woman among the twelve Alwars was Andal. Her name literally interprets as "the one who rules The Lord.". Her father gathered her once wearing a garland meant only for the Lord and he chastised her for doing so. That night Lord Vishnu seemed in his dream and told him that He chosen the garlands Andal had worn as she was His bride. She rejected to consider of a human being as her groom. She imagined herself as the bride of Sri Ranganatha. She even put on the garlands prepared for the Lord on her. As a young woman she fell in love with the Lord Himself and eventually married Him. Legend energies that

when she was around 16 she amalgamated with her Lord at the Srirangam Temple. Since then, she has existed as myth and deity. Her two poetic works are "Thiruppaavai" and "Naacchiyaar Thirumozhi", which are portion of the Naalaayira Dhivya Prabandham. Andal's Thiruppavai comprises of 30 songs. In it Andal calls upon her friends to wake up and go with her to chant songs in tribute of Lord Krishna.

It was supposed that this prayer .during the Tamil month of Margali would afford them good life, good husband and finally permanent place under the care of God. In her Thirumozhi, Andal describes her dream wedding with Lord Krishna. It was one of the best work and the most lyrical of all her poems. It reports the details of marriage ceremony. It was engaged in to the ceremonials of vaishnavites.

9.4 Nalayira Divya Prapantham

The twelve Alwars lived during 5th to 9th century A.D. contributed for the Vaishnava principle. Their songs are composed together by saint Nathamuni, numbering four thousand and termed as Nalayira Divya Prapantham. It was divided in to four sub-divisons of about a thousand cantos each. The subdivisions were termed as mudal ayiram (first thousand), Periya Thirumozhi, Iyarpa and Thiruvaimozhi. Among the Alwars, the songs of Thirumangai Alwar and Nammalvar covers over a thousand verses. Henceforth their works have been gathered into two separate books, Periya Thirumozhi of Thirumangai Alwar and Thiruvoymozhi of Nammalvar. Of the remaining songs, musical pieces are grouped as the first book named Mudal Ayiram. The non-musical songs are gathered in a book called Iyalpa. This sacred work is regarded by Vaishnavites as the second Veda. It was collected and organized by saint Nathamuni. Of the 4000 poems making up the Nalayira Divya Prapantham. The first thousand is known as Thirumozhi. It comprises the hymns of Periyalvar. Andal, Kulasekara, Thirumalisai, Thondaradippodi, Thiruppan and Mathurakavi. The second thousand humns known as Periyathirumozhi was entirely the work of Thirumangaiyalvar. The third thousand hymns were the composition by the first thre Alwars, namely Thirumalisai, Nammalvar and Thirumangai Alwar. It was called Iyalpa. The fourth thousand called Thiruvaymoli was entirely composed by Nammalvar.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. Howmany Alwars in number?
2. Who composed Thiruvaymoli?
3. Who compiled the Nalayira Divya Prapantham?

9.5 Nayanmars

The Saivites were termed as Nayanmars.Nayanmar means a faithful devotee of God. They called themselves "thondar" (one who assists), or "adiyar (the slave of God), or "adiyarkkum adiyar" (the servants of the great servant). The Nayanmars had two goals in their life. The first was to curtail the fame of Jainism and Buddhism among the people. The second was to transform the Kapalika, Kalamuka and Pasupatha who had strong belief in ferocious superstitions. The Nayanmar preserved traditional piousness and devotion. They also discoursed equality and unity of mankind. Among the sixty three Nayanmars, Thirunavukkarasar (Appar), Sundarar, Thiruganana Sambandar and Manikkavasakar were the noticeable four. They denoted the four main tracks of Saivism. The four important paths were Dasa marga (the path of the servant), Satpura marga (the path of the son), Saha marga (the path of the friend) and Sat marga (the good path).The poems of sixty three Nayanmars form the Saiva principle. It is named as Thirumurai or sacred principle. Among the sixty three Nayanmars there were eleven kings, twelve brahmins, thirteen vellalas, five merchants, four Adi Saivas, two yadavas, one saliyar, one cantor, one kuyavar, one panar, one chekkai, one vedar and five with caste unknown. These abundant spiritual saints traveled the whole Tamil Nadu and dedicate the temples by their sweet songs. They engaged the people as well as the elite towards a higher way of life in praise of God

The Saivite religious works can be broadly divided into twelve Thirumurai or Panniru thirumuraikal. Nambi Andar Nambi prepared exceptional service in this regard. Namabi Andar Nambi was a Brahmin priest from Thirunarayur. Due to his tireless effort, the hymns of Saiva devotees were collected and categorized into eleven Thirumurais. The first seven were by Thirugnana Sambandar, Appar and Sundarar and were known as the Devaram. These Devaram songs sung by the Othuvars in the

Siva temples till now.The eighth Thirumurai is Thiruvasakam. The four authors of these eight collections are termed as the great Saiva samaya Kuravas. Thirugnana Sambandar was contemporary to Thirunavukkarasar. Manikkavasakar stands apart. The ninth Thirumurai was named as Thiru Isaippa comprises of the hymns of nine other minor authors. They are Thirumaligaithevar, Senthanar Karuvurthevar, Poonthuruthi, Nambi Andar Nambi, Kandarathithar, Venattadigal, Thiruvali Amudanar, Purudothama Nambi and Sethirayar. Thirumular's spiritual songs designed as the tenth Thirumurai. In the eleventh Thirumurai several poets from Nakkirar to Nambi Andar Nambi contributed their work. Karaikal Ammaiyar, one of the earliest Nayanmar contributed four books. She renounced the world at an early age and visited several temples singing songs. The twelfth Thirumurai is Periyapuranam written by Sekkizhar around 12th century A.D. with the royal support of Rajaraja Chola.

Appar (Thirunavukkarasar)

Saint Appar also known as Tirunavukkarasar Nayanar was one among the sixty three nayanmars. His birth name was Marulneekkiyar. He was regarded to be the "father" for the complete "Universe" henceforth he was affectionately called as "Appar". He had contributed a share of his writings in the renowned writing Thiruthondar thogai. All the contributions of Appar, Sundarar and Thirugnana Sambandar are collectively called as Devaram. They had contributed a major role in encouraging the Saivism Group among the people.

Thirunavukkarasar was born in Tiruvamur, Tamil Nadu in 7th century. His sister Thilagavathiyar subsisted a saintly life and took care of him appropriately. He lived up to a ripe old age and has sung 3066 verses. At his younger age, Appar was desperately fascinated to Jainism and converted to Jainism and remained in the Jain Temple and was identified as Darmasena. Once he was affected from severe stomach pain, and after praying to Lord Shiva, he recoverd from it. So he was again converted to Saivism from Jainism. Due to the influence of his sister Thilagavathy, he got converted to Saivism. He also converted the Pallava king, Mahendravarman to Saivism.

Thirunavukkarasar met Thirugnana Sambandar at Sirkali and both of them toured together by singing devotional songs on Lord Shiva. Appar

is believed to have travelled to most of the Siva temples in Tamil Nadu, and preached the importance of Saivism among the people. He accomplished salvation at Tiru Pukalur Siva temple at the age of 81. Appar's Devaram is very popular even in today's world, particularly among the Saivites. His work was centered on the northern part of the Tamil country and he visited at least one hundred and twenty six temples.

He not only sang songs in praise of Lord Siva but also cleaned the temple locations. Appar is well-known as the master of Thiru thandakam. It is a method of verse with eight feet to the line with mellowed thoughts and expression. His language is at all times direct, simple and with out any imaginative combination. It brought out the emotion of his devotion and a sense of submission to God in simple style. His Thiru Angamalai is a short poem in which he devotes every organ of his body to the provision of God. He was a spiritual, singing about the Siva as his lover. He is said to have collected 49,000 chants of which there are only 3,110 poems at present. They are full of perception and devotion. He composed the fourth, fifth and sixth Thirumurais. His approach to God is known as Charya marga where the relationship between God and His follower is that of a master and a slave. Thirunavukkarasar's poems are perfect of information on the history and progress of the Tamils. He was a social reformer and paid no attention to caste structure. He was also a religious reformer who needed no priest intermediary between God and himself.

Thirugnana Sambanthar

Thirugnana Sambanthar also known as Sambanthar was a great Saivite saint of Tamil Nadu. Sambanthar lived in 7th century AD. He is one among the sixty three nayanmars. He also contributed some portions of verses in the Panniru thirumurai. Thirugnana Sambanthar was a contemporary of Paranjothi and Kun Pandya and it is supposed to have been born about 639 A.D. at Seerkali. According to legends, he got the Gnanapal (divine milk) at the age of three.

When he was three years old his father took him to the temple tank, retained him on the bank and left for a bath. The child started to cry. Lord Siva and Uma appeared before Sambandar, consold him and nurtured with her milk with Siva Gnanam (divine wisdom). When his parent saw him thus drinking milk out of a golden bowl and asked the child as to who

offered it to him, the boy pointed to the Siva temple. Hence he was named Tirugnana Sambandar, which means related through wisdom. From this moment onwards Thirugnana Sambandar visited the nearby temples with the help of his father and composed many songs. "Thodudaiya Ceviyan", the first letter itself -being the spiritual pranava. In every verse he provided each and every details of the Lord and guaranteed his father that it was He who had raided his heart. He started singing hymns from that tender age due to divine grace.

Sambandar then traveled many a place of Pilgrimage and established his character by wonders. Sambanthar's period perceived the great struggle between Hinduism, Jainism and Buddhism. Sambandar received an invitation from the Queen of Pandya kingdom. Sambanthar, Queen Mankayrakarasi and the Pandya king Kunpandiyan were responsible for the disappearness of Jainism from the Pandya country. Thirugnana Sambanthar met Appar at Thirupuhalur and both visited many temples in north Tamil Nadu. The power of the Jains was in famous in those times, particularly in the Pandya country and the King Nedumaran was also a Jain. The queen Mangayarkkarasi and Minister Kulachchirai, were truthful to Saivism. So they invited Sambandar to Madurai to restore the Saiva faith.

At Madurai, Sambanthar made miraculous achievements and converted the Jain King Kun Pandya to Saivism. Sambanthar defeated the Jains of Madurai in Anal vadham and Punal vadham. Thousands of Jains were entered by the Pandya ruler. Thus Sambanthar was the first who was engaged in the laborious task of protecting Tamil Nadu from the influence of Budhhism and Jainism. Saint Arunagirinathar, considered Sambanthar as an incarnation of Lord Subramnya. Sambanthar's approach to Lord Siva is viewed as the relation between a son and father. Though he lived for sixteen years his service to Saivism was great.

After re-establishing Saivism in the Pandya country, Sambanthar reverted to the Chola country from where he instigated a northern tour. His hymns are believed to have numbered over 10,000 of which we have only 3840 padigams. He composed the first, second and third Thirumurais. His songs strike a happy and cheerful note throughout. His prayers were only for the welfare of society. His love for nature was reflected through his

hymns. In a sense, he is believed foremost among all the four Saiva saints. Nambi Andar Nambi called him Tamilakaran.

Sundarar

Sundarar was born in Tirunavalur to the Adisaiva Brahmin Sadayanar. He was a son of Salaiyanar and IsaiGnaniar of Brahmin extraction. His real name was Nambi-arura, but later he came to be more commonly known as "Sundarar'. The indigenous chieftain Narasimha Munaiyraiyar, took a decorative to the child and took care of bringing up the child. When on attaining manhood, his wedding was about to take place, an ascetic seemed and appealed Sundarar as his slave and claimed that he be sent with him according to the bond accomplished by the boy's grandfather and that he therefore objected to the marriage. When the ascetic was asked to show his identity, he requested the bridegroom and others who challenged his claim to shadow him. Sundarar went with the old man who entered into the temple and quickly disappeared providing to all that he was no other than the Lord preserved in the temple. Thus did Siva pursue after Sundarar to have him as His devotee. There were other instances as well of Siva in show of some kind giving proof that He sought him to His follower. Sundarar felt glad beyond measure and from that day he became an enthusiastic devotee of the Siva Cult andtraveled from place to.place.

Later he married a girl named Paravai, who was brought up in a dancing girl's house. Then he went on to a number of other places sacred to Siva, working miracles here and there. One such place was Tiruvorriyur where he saw Sangiliyar, whom also he married after promising to live with her for a fixed period. But as he left her before this period he lost his eye sight, however, he regained through the grace of Lord Siva. Sundarar's devotion to Siva was that of an intimate friend. Lord Shiva acted as a messenger when his wife quarreled with him. His preference of non-Brahmin girls shows the social custom of the day. Inter marriage was based on the social position and not restricted on the caste system based on birth. He composed 38,000 hymns, of which only a hundred are now available. He was the poet of seventh Thirumurai. Many of his songs expose a sense of freedom and intimacy in relation to God and are often enhanced with humour.

Sundarar was a friend of the Chera King Cheraman Perumal Nayanar, who requested him to his place and duly honoured him. With Cheraman, Sundarar traveled many temples in the Southern part of Tamilnadu. Sundarar attributed the very few miracles including the transformation of bricks into gold plates and bringing back the life of a Brahmin boy swallowed by an alligator. On several occasions Lord Siva worked miracles to release the suffering of Sundarar.

Sundarar dedicated his life and poetical talent to the service of Siva, The temples he visited and the inspiration provoked by them have been preserved in beautiful poetry. These hymns besides expressing his respect to Siva, are a record of his personal religious life. He revolved to God at all times. Sundarar commended God in delight; in sorrowfulness, he prayed to Him; and in difficulties, turned to him for solution and Lord Siva was ready to help with the monotonous problems.

Manikkavasakar

Manikkavasakar, who was born of Brahmin parents in the village of Thiruvadavur near Madurai. He was a contemporary of Sundarar and the Varaguna Pandya of Madurai. Sundarar's Thiruthondarpuranam mentioned the name of Manikkavasagar. He worked as a minister under Varaguna Pandya. One day the king assigned Manikkavasagar to purchase horses for his cavalry. On the way at Tirupperunthurai Manikkavsagar met a Saiva saint, the Lord Siva himself with his followers and forgetting his royal mission he persisted there as his disciple and expended the money in the service of the Lord Shiva.

On hearing this the king ordered him to return to the court immediately. He prayed to Siva, who asked him to go back to Madurai promising him that the horses would reach the capital on the Avani mulam day. Manikkavasagar went to the king and informed him that the horses would follow soon. Lord Siva changed the jackals of the forest into horses and drove them to Madurai and the king was highly satisfied. But at night the horses all turned into jackals and ran away. This extremely infuriated the king and Manikkavasagar was tortured. In order to punish the king, Siva made the waters of the river Vaigai to overflow the city. The king ordered all the citizens to embank the river. As the old lady Vanti was too aged, Siva took the form of a labourer and guaranteed the lady to do her

job but fell asleep without doing his duty. The king who was personally administering the work beaten the labourer for indifferences. The cane-stroke fell not only on the labourer but on all the existences including the king. The king and the citizens realised that the Lord Himself has come down to point out the greatness of Manikkavasagar and understood the sainthood of the Minister. Then he started his pilgrimage and finally reached Chidambaram. Manikkavasakar clashed with the Buddhists of Ceylon at Chidambaram regarding their religion.In the debate, by the power of miracle he made them to accept their defeat. He entered into the temple and fell into a dream forgetting the world. When he came out of the trance he chanted numerous songs and finally accomplished to the feet of the Lord with his physical form. His life exposes that he has true knowledge of God's real nature. His chief works the Tiruvasagam and the Tirukkovai forms the eighth Tirumurai.

Thiruvasagam is a gemstone of sacred literature. The principle of Siva's faith found in Vedic tradition is given as core. Thiruvasagam is absolute poetry, of a high order. To estimate the author's own words, it is bone-melting poetry. His connection with God is purely personal. He offered his soul at the feet of Lord Nataraja. After varied experience he got the final realization in Chidambaram. Like a little child's complete trust on its mother he trust Lord Siva. Although he employs the love theme or aham, the note is subordinated to the praise of God.

Namabi Andar Nambi collected the songs sung by these four saints during the days of Emperor Rajaraja Chola. He assembled them into different books. These books have been actually shaping the thoughts and actions of the followers of Saivism for more than a thousand years. The Saiva community's life and cultural base was controlled by the essence of these great works. G.U.Pope translated the works of Manikkavasakar into English.

Check Your Progress Questions

4. Who collected the songs of four nayanmars?
5. Manikkavasagar served under whom ?
6. Where was Thirugnana Sambanthar born?

9.6 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. 12
2. Nammalvar
3. Nathamuni
4. Nambi Andar Nambi
5. Vargauna Pandya
6. Sirkali

9.7 Summary

- The bhakti saints can be broadly classified into two streams the Alwars and Nayanmars.
- The Alwars were the followers of Vishnu and the Nayanmars expressed their devotion to Siva.
- The bhakti movement led by the Alwars in the Tamil country led to the overthrow of the Jain and Buddhist faiths.
- The term 'Alwar' means 'those who are absorbed in the divine'. There are twelve Vaishnava saints.
- The first three Alwars are known as Poykai, Putam and Pey. They wandered from one shrine to another in search of god.
- Thirumalisai Alwar, the first non-Brahmin saint in the Vaishnava school.
- Nammalvar is considered as the greatest of the Alwars and his contributions to the Dhivya Prabandham is more than a quarter of the complete text.
- Andal is the only woman among the twelve Alwars.
- Songs of Alwars are collected together by saint Nathamuni, numbering four thousand and termed as Nalayira Divya Prapantham.
- Nayanmar means a faithful devotee of God. It is an honorific title affixed to the Saiva devotee.
- Among the 63 Nayanmars, Thirunavukkarasar (Appar), Sundarar, Sambandar and Manikkavasakar were the prominent four.
- About the 11th century A.D., the hymns of Saiva devotes were collected and classified into eleven Thirumurais.
- Manikkavasagar's chief work was Tiruvasagam.
- He offered his soul at the feet of Lord Nataraja.

- The twelfth Thirumurai is Periyapuranam written by Sekkizhar around 12th century A.D. with the royal patronage of Rajaraja Apaya Kulasekhara Chola.
- Namabi Andar Nambi collected the songs sung by these four saints during the days of Emperor Rajaraja Chola.
- These books have been actually shaping the thoughts and actions of the followers of Saivism.
- The Saiva community's life and cultural base was controlled by the essence of these great works.
- G.U.Pope translated the works of Manikkavasakar into English.

9.8 Key words

- Bhakti - loving devotion to a deity leading to salvation and nirvana; open to all persons independent of caste or sex.
- Virutham - A virutham (Tamil) is a Hindu devotional verse sung in Carnatic music concerts.
- Gnanapal- divine milk

9.9 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. Write note on Nalayira Divya Prapantham
2. What do you know about Panniru Thirumuaraikal?
3. Define the works of Andal.

Long Answer Questions

1. Describe the role of Alwars for the growth of Vaishnavism.
2. Analyze the contribution of Nayanmars to Saivism.

9.10 Further Readings

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Unit X Thirumular - Ramanuja - Veeramamunivar

10.0 Introduction

10.1 Objectives

10.2 Thirumular

10.3 Ramanuja

10.4 Veeramamunivar

10.5 Answers to check your progress questions

10.6 Summary

10.7 Key words

10.8 Self Assessment Questions

10.9 Further Readings

10.0 Introduction

The word Siddha denotes to a realized soul. Through yoga and penance they realized the meaning of life. They have abandoned the world and have no affection towards worldly pleasure. They harassed the non-permanent nature of human life. They are against the ritualism of Aryan culture. Basically they were Saivites. Their intelligence assisted the Tamil society to lead a good life. With their supreme knowledge the siddhars evolved methods to diagnose the disease. The popular siddhars are Thirumular, Karur siddhar, Pulippani siddhar, Pambatti siddhar. Thirumoolar is considered to have lived about 2,500 years before, in the sixth century B.C. Thirumanthiram is a religious book in Tamil literature. The mythical writer Thirumular wrote this book.The teachings of Thirumular is identified as Thirumandiram and is estimated as the tenth of the 12 Tirumurais of Saivism. In Thirumantiram all yogas like Hada Yoga, Raja Yoga, Karma Yoga, Tantra Yoga, Mantra Yoga and Daya Yoga are explained. Thirmular's Saiva devotional works are grounded on devotion or bakthy while the philosophical works are based on knowledge or gnanam. Thirumanthiram book contains many Saiva Siddhantha views. It is the first Tamil work to convey the phrase Saiva Siddhantham. It begins with innovation to God, as its preface or Payiram, which speaks of vethas, agamas etc.

10.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Explain the contribution of Thirumular to Saiva Siddhanda and Tamil literature
- Discuss the ideas and principles of Ramanuja
- Understand the importance of the literary works of Veeramamunivar.

10.2 Thirumular

Tirumular was a renowned Siddha, an ascetic and theorist. Like all other Siddhas, dating the period of Tirumular is also challenging as well as some of the sources claim that he was a contemporary of Agastya. Like Agastya exercised himself in spreading the worship of Siva amongst the Tamils. The exact period of the author is a matter of dispute. Since Thirumantiram was written earlier than Thirugnana Sambandar. Some scholars discoursed that Tirumular lived around 5th century A.D. and some of them placed him in the 6th or 7th century. R.Venkataraman mentioned that the authentic development of the Tamil Siddha cult initiates with Tirumular's Tirumantiram. The Thirutondar Puraṇam comments him as one of the sixtythree Nayaṇmars. Since he is acknowledged in the list of sixty-three Nayaṇmars, Tirumular is also named as Tirumula Nayaṇar.

It is supposed that Tirumular was a cow-herd at Sattanur, previous to his assuming the ascetic life, and founding himself in the Saiva devotee at Tiruvavaduturai. His medical discourse is identified as Thirumular Vaidya Vagadam. But Thirumular is most famous for his Thirumantiram, a ample work comprising an exposition of the doctrines of the Saiva religion, specifically with reference to the four different methods of worship, as instructed in the Agamas. To the conventional supporters of Tamil Saiva Siddhanta, he is a semi-divine founder-figure, and also is admired as one of the sixty three nayanmars or the Tamil Saiva saints. In addition, he is an expert on tantric concept and practice. It is giving additional thorough description of the astanga yoga than Patanjali. Finally, he is considered as the first of the Tamil Siddhas. His magnum opus, Thirumantiram, a work of three thousand stanzas, accepted as one of the Agamas in Tamil culture. According to another institution, Thirumular's actual name was

Sundaranar.Tthe name "Mulan" was gained as by an accident of history. Numerous stories were accessible on the life of Thirumular. It was supposed that he enters into the dead body of cowherd was Mulan and hereafter he was called as Thirumular. It was understood that in his 3,000 years penance, he woke up once in a year and wrote a poem every year. Sundaranar was one of the former students involved in the active practice of the Siddhayoga under the course of the Lord Siva, and under the direction of Nandi. It was Nandi that conferred on him the title "Nathan" and from now was known as Sundara Nathan. It is as Sundara Nathan that he first traveled south India and reached at Chidambaram. Again for a second time to visit the great guru and sage Agastya at his select dwelling in the Podigai hills. Therefore most of the scholars completely take the legend that Tirumular has left Mount Kailas, of the far North and established in the South.

Based on the evidence originate in the text of Thirumantiram, V.R. Dikshitar dated Thirumular, after the period of Devaram viz., Sambandar, Appar and Sundarar. Most of the particulars found in this legend are showed by the internal evidence of the text. That he accomplished Samadhi under the Bodhi tree, he was a skillful in Agama Sastras, and he had seven followers, like Malangan and others. It seems that these seven disciples devotedly conceded the torch of the teacher's message and established in their turn seven Mutts to promulgate the Sivayoga as such. Kalangi Nathar is measured to be one of his seven followers, and Bogar of Palani is considered as a pupil of Kalangi Nathar. The Kongu Mandala Sathakam describes that Kanjamalai Siddhar as another follower of Thirumular.

The Siddha elements in Thirumantiram

Tirumular was the first and supreme of the Tamil Siddhars. He is regarded to be the Father of Tamil Siddhars. Tirumular's proclamation, "There is one God and one community", had played a important role in the field of social reform in the Tamil Country. It marked the beginning of the Siddha marga in Tamil Nadu. The idea of one caste and one God exposes universalism and equality. It also archives the dissatisfaction of the fight for supremacy among the religions that prevailed during Tirumular's time. Caste system and dicrimination based on race do not find support in

Tirumular's songs. He openly condemned Brahmins and priesthood. He even examined the caste marks of the Brahmins.

In Thirumantiram the nature of the Siddhar was elucidated. They have abandoned everything and symbolizes truth. They have experienced the presence of Lord Siva and have the quality of Sadhasivam. They were experts in right type of Siddhas. The Thirumantiram consist of two words thiru, an honorific, and mantiram, the Tamil for mantram which literally means 'the Sacred Sound. It is a massive gathering of philosophy, morality, Tantrism, siddha principles and the greatest treatment of yoga in Tamil literature, which comprises a collection of more than 3000 hymns organized in nine tantras in the kali virutam meter, divided into four parts viz., Cariyai, Kriyai, Yogam and Gnanam and replicates the doctrine of the Tamil Agamas. Further it is separated into nine broad divisions called tantras.

The first tantra deals with upadesa, the temporary nature of wealth, physical body, and the prominence of non-violence, renouncing from drinking intoxicants, etc. The second tantra provides the mysterious meanings of some of the appearances of Siva, such as Asta-Viratta, Lingapuraṇa, Pancakritya and so on. The third tantra deals with astanga-yoga and aṣta-siddhi. The fourth tantra deals with Sakta traditions and several kinds of chakras. The fifth tantra deals with Cariya, Kriya, Yoga and Gnana. The sixth tantra deals with Tapovesa, Gnanavesa and Guru Darsana. The seventh tantra deals with the topics like six adharas, Sivapuja, etc. The eighth tantra deals with renunciation, removal of desires, greatness of bhakti, etc. Lastly the ninth chapter deals with the Pancaksara and Siva darsana in a comprehensive method. Fascinatingly, the above said all are highly unusual to the Tamil Siddhas and these characteristic features of the Siddhas are decoratively anticipated in Thirumantiram.

The significant feature in Thirumantiram is the narrative of 'Kalachakra', a late Buddhist idea that is said to have adopted from central Asia to India. Sekkilar also in his Thirutthoṇdar puranam precisely revealed that Thirumantiram has 3000 stanzas in it. It displays that the Thirumantiram goes to a period after the 10th century, but before the 12th century A.D. In this work, Tirumular also denotes some of the practices which are more conversant among the Siddhas for instance kaya- siddhi,

prana-siddhi and yoga-siddhi. He hated worldly matter and presented his idea in a forceful manner. His directness and poetic expression enhances the quality of the work. He stressed the truth that God is one. He never regarded the mortal body as a hindrance to attain salvation. Instead, through the proper maintenance of body as a hindrance to attain salvation. Thirumular believed that God lives in the body. Hence the body must be nourished to reach salvation. He suggests many practical ways to lead a good life. His ethical guidelines are simple for even the ordinary mortals. He says that if it is not possible to offer a flower, offer a bit of leaf to God, a handful of grass to the cow, a morsel of food to the needy when you take your food and say a kind word to every one. Thirumular also enlightened in his songs about the method of burying the body of a Yogi. The Thirumantiram speaks about the 72,000 nadis in the human body, with certain musical sounds, that a Siddha is said to get in the course of his yogic preparation.Thirumular advocates his followers to surrender all supplements and turn the minds towards God. Besides, in his work, he praises the potentialities of the human body and confirms the truth of life and the world. He does not believe that the human body is an evil:

"If body is destroyed, soul is destroyed;

And one will not attain true powerful knowledge.

Having acquired the skill to foster the body,

I cherished the body, and I fostered the soul."

. In another verse, Thirumular speaks that he once measured the human body as aversion. Then he identified the heavenly in his body in which the god is dwelling. Therefore he conserved his physical body. Hence, he pronounces that if body is destroyed, soul or life is destroyed. So it is compulsory to safeguard and appreciate the body. Likewise, his idea of maintaining the human body differs from the later Siddhars and put him under the ordering of Kaya Siddhas. Thirumular enlightens us that God more voluntarily admits any submission made to this temple than the gifts made to the stones in the stone temples. Human love is representative of divine love. All love is in fact a shadow of the great love.

He believed that through the service of mankind one could receive the blesings of God. Like the teachings of Gautama Buddha, he also

stressed the evil nature of desire. Only those who come out of desire would get the bliss and real happiness. Thirumular also stressed the need to control the five senses for eternal bliss. Among the twelve books of the Saiva canon, it must be noted, that Thirumantiram is the only sastra or scripture. In other words it is the only work dedicated to philosophy. The other words are basically devotional songs. Thirumular as a mystic presented his devotional understandings in all his stanzas. His language denotes both the classical nature as well as that of a common man. In the mood of a Siddha's delighted expressions one can experience the rare intelligence and flash of thoughts. Thirumular is a glorified saint.

Thus, Thirumantiram residues as a warehouse of Saiva Siddhanta, although Vedantic and Tantric beliefs are also preserved in it. Being a Siddha, he has demarcated the qualities and characteristics of a perfect Siddha in various poems. It comprises very many features which are typical for Siddha writings. So, Thirumantiram is a great example for the literatures on Siddha tradition. Like Thiruvalluvar who dealt with all kinds of human life in his Tirukkural, Thirumular also left no stone unturned in learning and describing all aspects of the Tantric Siddha cult.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. Howmany verses in Thirumantiram?
2. Which is the number of Thirumantiram in Thirumurais?

10.3 Ramanuja

Ramanuja was born in Sriperumpudur near Chennai, in the eleventh century. He was a popular Vaishnava Acharya. According to legend he was born in 1017 and survived for 120years. He died in 1137A.D. Ramanuja was well versed in Tamil and Vaishnava ideologies. He was born in an orthodox Vadama Brahmin family assumed to Vedic studies. Ramanuja's father was Asuri Somayaji Kesava Dikshitar and his name proposes the Vedic background of his tribe.

His mother was Ganthimathi. He lost his father when he was young. His Guru was Thirukkachinambi, belonged to the lower strata of society. He educated the scriptures while in earnest individual service of his guru.

Alavandar was the famous head of the mutt at Srirangam. He was impressed by Ramanuja's learning and thought proposing apostolic seat at Srirangam. During the final days of Alavandar, the devotees sent Peria Nambi to bring him Ramanuja. By the time he reached, the master was no more, and the tradition relates that when Ramanuja come near the body, he saw three out of the five fingers of the right hand folded. His disciples described that Alavandar had three unfulfilled wishes, the chief of which was writing an easy interpretation on Brahmasutra. Ramanuja returned to Kanchipuram and sustained with his pious responsibilities.

Ramanuja met Periyanambi at Madhuranthakam and got commenced by him into the anonymities of Vedanta. Great people are regularly not capable to find a woman appropriate for themselves and Ramanuja too was not blessed with a wife who would struggle to support his principles and thus increase his powers. When he became a sanyasin, he raised very popular and the flattering world called him "prince of ascetics". Ramanuja settled in Srirangam and acquired complete knowledge of the Thiruvaymoli. He even viewed the temple administration at Srirangam. Ramanujar naturally believed that the elevation of the society is more significant than the upliftment of the individual. There were efforts to eradicate Ramanujar. But he effectively evaded struggle with those who planned against him. When his wife treated others on the basis of caste dissimilarities, he renounced his life and converted into a sanyasin.

Ramanuja's disciples

Ramanuja's followers came to him on their own and merged him as his students. Kuresa became a staunch follower, a friend and a disciple of Ramanuja. Mudaliyandan, Ramanuja's own sister's son, was another disciple of Ramanuja and persisted him forever after. Other religious persons like Advaitins and Jains became his followers, and monitored his teachings. Ramanuja acknowledged disciples from all the castes.

Ramanuja's teachings

Ramanuja presented special importance to selfless submission to God, which he named prapathi. He said that one should give up affections to material substances, surrender his ego and absolutely submit to God. Only through this submission can man accomplish salvation. He

understood that God is omnipotent and omnipresent and the monarch of the Universe. He only is the Divine personality and greater to all other living and non-living beings. Ramanuja also supposed that cheerfulness as a idea was more of an impression, a maya and one should struggle not just for happiness but to receive the elegance of the Lord, who is our everything like the mother, father, friend, philosopher and guide. Ramanuja was of the judgment that a true disciple is one who passes his time, energy and money in the detection of grasping God. As sustained by Ramanuja, God showers his Supreme Divine pleasure upon all those who request for pardon in a modest manner.

His social reforms

Ramanuja's two important disciples were Dasarathy alias Muthaliyandan and Thirumarban alias Kurathalwar. Ramanuja spread Vaishnavism with the assistance of these two disciples and indroduced social reforms. With much effort he learned the basic Vaishnava manthras and its secreat meanings from Thirukkottiyur Nambi. Ramanuja promised that he wouldnot reveal the secrets of the mantra preached by the Thirukkottiyur Nambi. So, with this promise, Nambi pronounced the manthras to Ramanujar. Thirukkottiyur Nambi advised him that if he breaks his promise he would go to hell as a punishment. But Ramanuja violated his promise. After leraning from Nambi he preached the manthra "Om namo Narayana" to all the people from the top of the temple gopura. He claimed that he not liked the idea that he only can go to heaven while all others are exposed to hell. Instead he decide to go to hell for breaking his promise while others who acquire the manthra can go to paradise. In those days the temple entry was not possible for the lower caste people. He prepared all the arrangements for their temple entry in Srirangam. It was a great social service considering the strictness and conventional nature of the period. He survived a full life of 120 years and served the people and God like.

His Literary works

Ramanuja composed numerous works, which contains Vedantha Deepam, Vedantha Saram, Vedantha Sangraham and Geeta Bashyam. His works are, "Vedhartha Sangraham" means summary of the meaning of the Vedas, "Vedanta Saram" means essence of the Vedas, "Sri Bhashya"

means Commentary on Brahma Sutra, "Vedanta Deepam" means Light of the Vedanta, "Geeta Bhashyam" means Commentary on Bhagwad Gita, "Gadya Traya" means Prose Poem of Surrender, Sharanagathy Gadya, Sri Ranga Gadya, Vaikunta Gadya, and Nitya. Ramanujar highlighted the significance of Alwar's lyrics and made required preparations for its recitation in the Vishnu temples. He spread the Vaishnavism in north India also. Ramanuja built a few more Vishnu temples in and about Mysore, set up a strong Vaishnavite community and place them in charge of his followers to carry on his work and spread the Visishtadvaita philosophy and Vishnu devotion throughout the king's regions. So Ramanuja sustained his labours here for nearly twenty years and his followers numbered several thousands.His religious thoughts were named as Visishtadvaita philosophy. Ramanujar's instructions are based on the three doctrines of God, soul and world. He established a Vaishnava mutt at Thirunarayanapuram. The Hoysala ruler, due to his teachings, was transformed from Jainism to Vaishnavism. He ensured great service to the people and to his belief. He denied to admit the Advaita philosophy of Sankarar. From Ramanuja's position Sankarar's philosophy has not afford space for the development of Bhakti.

Check Your Progress Questions

3. What was the philosophy of Ramanuja?
4. Who taught the manthra to Ramanuja?

10.4 Veeramamunivar

Father Joseph Beschi alias Veeramamunivar was a significant member of Jesuit Missionary. He came India to carry on the works of Robert De Nobili and John De Britto. Joseph Beschi was also the most renowned among the Jesuits for knowledge and intelligence. He was born at Castiglione delle Stoviere in the province of Venice, Italy on 8th, November 1680. He come into the novitiate of the Jesuits at Novellaria in October 1698 after the completion of his literary educations and one year of Philosophy. He imparted the lowest grammar class at Racenna. From 1701 to1710 was the epoch of intellectual training according to the Jesuit organization. Joseph Beschi completed the course in Philosophy in 1701.

From 1703-1705, he educated the middle and highest grammar classes and the Humanities. In 1706, he experienced a course of Theology and was intended as a priest in 1709. After concluding the fourth year of Theology in 1710, he equipped himself to go abroad and work for the religion of Christ. After becoming a Jesuit in 1698, he demanded, and attained, from Superior General Michelangelo Tamburini consent to be sent to the Madurai mission in South India. Joseph Beschi touched Goa in October 1710, from where he progressed straightaway to South India.

The political condition was not in a settled position in the Tamil Country when Joseph Beschi reached Madura Mission in 1711. The Maratta Prince Shahji oppressed the Christians at Tanjore. So he was termed as the "Nero of Tanjore". Vijaya Ranga Chokkanataha was the grandson of Queen Mangammal ascended the throne in 1706 at Madurai. He spent his time in corruption and exaggerated amusements. Vijaya Ragunatha Sethupathy (1711- 1725) was the ruler of Marava country. He was unfriendly to Christian community. Further, the Missionaries had to meet the difficult produced by the other native princes and the Moors.

Veeramamunivar started his missionary work in Tirunelveli district. He learned Tamil under Supratheepa Kavirayar at Madurai. Other churches constructed by him are Vyagula Matha Church at Thanjavur and one more church at Palliyeri Village near Thanjavur. Also Veeramamnivar visited several important centres such as Tirunelveli, Ramanathapuram,Thanjavur and of course Madurai, to study the Tamil language. He also learned some Indian languages. He functioned in the Tamil country for 30 years. He anticipated the practices of Hindu saints in dress and in style. In 1724, his great work Thembavani was appeared. It was a work of considerable skill and merit. The work Thembavani earned him the title Veeramamunivar from the people of Madurai.

Literary works

Veeramamunivar was known for his expertise in Tamil. He wrote in 1727, the book entitled Vedavilakkam. He also wrote a commentary on the Thirukkuural in Tamil. His major work was a Tamil-Latin Dictionary composed in 1726. Veeramamunivar's another reputed work was the Thembavani which dealt with St.Joseph. Thembavani was separated into 3 sections and 6 sub divisions. It comprises the historical and traditional

incidents associated with the old and new Testaments. In sweep of imagination and in strength of religious faith this work was matched with the Ramayana. His other prose works containing Vediyar Ozhukkam were written after 1727. A commentary was written on Vethiyar Ozhukkam in 1729 when he stayed at Avur. Vethiyar Ozhukkam was followed by some important works in this connection was Sathura Akarathi. It was virtually the first of the Tamil dictionaries after the English dictionary model. In Latin he wrote "Sen Tamil" and "Kodun Tamil" grammars. In 1738 he brought out Thonnul Vilakkam, handling the five parts of Tamil grammar thoroughly. His works later motivated Caldwell and G.U.Pope for the service of Tamil language.

Veeramammunivar's irony on the Indian guru is a prose entitled "Aviviveka Purna Guru Kathai". It amusingly elucidated the foolish deeds of a guru and his disciples. It was translated in numerous languages all over the world. He also worked under the Chanda Sahib as Diwan and had a grant of four villages in Trichy District. But when the Marathas besieged Trichy in 1740 he escaped Ramnad. Veeramamunivar also composed several other Tamil work such as Thirukkavalur Kalambakam, Veda Vilakkam and Adaikala Malai.

Veeramamunivar was also known as Thairya natha Swami and Ismathi Saniyasi. He went to Manappadu in Tirunelveli district from Ramnad and died there in 1740. He was a great linguist donated much for the development of Tamil literature. Among all the Jesuit Fathers, who came to India, Veeramamunivar was probably the most outstanding for knowledge and intellect. His knowledge of Tamil was philosophical. He was equally familiar with there high and low vernaculars. Veeramamunivar did not use Sanskrit words in his Tamil works; and rather aimed at acquiring a perfectly pure and idiomatic style. His book was read with delight by all sections of the Tamils, Christians and non-Christians alike. He also translated Thirukkurai in Latin. By his service and contributions, Veeramamunivar earned a permanent place in the history of Tamil literature.

Check Your Progress Questions

5. What was the real name of Veeramamunivar?
6. When did he write the book Veda vilakkam?

10.5 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. 3000
2. 10
3. Visishtadvaita philosophy
4. Thirukkottiyur Nambi
5. Joesph Beschi
6. 1727

10.6 Summary

- Tirumular was a celebrated Siddha, an ascetic and philosopher.
- Some scholars opined that Tirumular lived around 5th century C.E. and some of them placed him in the 6th or 7th century.
- The Thirutondar Puraṇam mentions him as one of the sixtythree Nayaṇmars.
- He is considered to be the Father of Tamil Siddhars.
- His proclamation: There is one God and one community had played a vital role in the field of social reform in the Tamil Country.
- In Thirumantiram the nature of the Siddhar was explained.
- He suggests many practical ways to lead a good life. His ethical guidelines a Caste system and difference based on race do not find support in Tirumular's songs.
- He openly denounced Brahmins and priesthood re simple for even the ordinary mortals.
- Thirumantiram is a great specimen for the literatures on Siddha cult
- Ramanuja was born in Sriperumpudur near Chennai, in the eleventh century.
- He was a popular Vaishnava Acharya. He was well versed in Tamil and Vaishnava principles.
- Ramanuja composed several works, which includes Vedantha Deepam, Vedantha Saram, Vedantha Sangraham.
- His religious ideas were termed as Visishtadvaita philosophy.

- When temple entry was not possible for the low caste people, he made all the arrangements for their temple entry in Srirangam.
- Ramanujar highlighted the importance of Alwar's lyrics and made necessary arrangements for its recital in the Vishnu temples.
- Father Joseph Beschi alias Veeramamunivar an important member of Jesuit Missionary who came to India.
- He reached Goa in October 1710, from where he proceeded immediately to South India.
- He arrived in Madurai in May 1711.
- He served the Tamil country for 30 years. He assumed the practices of Hindu saints in dress and in style.
- His largest work was a Tamil-Latin Dictionary composed in 1726.
- Fr.Beschi"s another reputed work was the Thembavani which dealt with St.Joseph.
- Beschi also wrote several other Tamil works such as Thirukkavalur Kalambakam, Veda Vilakkam and Adaikala Malai.
- Veeramamunivar was also known as Thairya natha Swami and Ismathi Saniyasi.
- Beschi did not use Sanskrit words in his Tamil works.
- Among all the Jesuit Fathers, who came to India, Beschi was probably the most outstanding for learning and intellect.

10.7 Key words

- Manthram - a word or sound that is believed to have a special spiritual power.
- Monastery - The definition of a monastery is the building where a group of religious people such as monks or nuns live together.

10.8 Self Assesment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. Write a note on Thirumantiram.
2. What were the social reforms of Ramanuja?
3. Mention the works of Veeramamunivar.

Long Answer Questions

1. Write an account of the ideas of Thirumular.
2. Bring out the contribution of Ramanuja to Vaishnavism.
3. Analyse the role of Veeramamunivar to Tamil literature.

10.9 Further Readings

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Unit XI Caldwell- G.U.Pope- Robrt De-Nobili

11.0 Introduction

11.1 Objectives

11.2 Caldwell

11.3 G.U.Pope

11.4 Robert-De-Nobili

11.5 Answers to check your progress questions

11.6 Summary

11.7 Key words

11.8 Self Assessment Questions

11.9 Further Readings

11.0 Introduction

The Christian missionaries through their service to the local people in Tamil Nadu find a place for themselves. They tried to reach the people by extending service in the ignored field. Particularly in health and education they rendered extraordinary service. The missionaries understood the inevitability of directly communicating with the local people in their mother tongue. So they learned the Tamil language. They have started translating the Tamil classics in their language. It spread the admiration of the Tamil language in other European countries. They have also composed numerous Tamil works to propagate their religious beliefs among the people.

According to Nee. Kandasamy Pillai "Of all the western scholars, who contributed to the Tamil language, the foremost among them in many was Bishop Dr. Robert Caldwell". Caldwell was one of the well-known scholar an archaeologist Christian Missionaries of South India. He was not only a religious priest, but also a multilinguist, historian, and a architect of a model village at Idaiyangudi. Caldwell distinguished eighteen languages including Greek, Latin, Hebrew, English Irish, Scottish, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada and Sanskrit and even some Malayalam. In his own words "I was born in Ireland, educated in Scotland, enlisted myself in London Mission

Society. However lived in India for a pretty long time and indulged in Indian life style, and became one among the Indians".

11.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- List out the missionary and literary work of Robert Caldwell in Tamil Nadu.
- Understand the contribution of G.U.Pope for the growth of Tamil language.
- Analyze the religious duties of Robert-De-Nobili in India.
- Explain the contributions of Caldwell to the Tamil society

11.2 Caldwell

Caldwell was born on the 7th, May 1814, in North of Ireland. His parents and all his ancestors were belonged to Scotcland. He returned with his parents to Scotland about his tenth year. His family on returning to Scotland took up their residence in Glasgow, where he persisted till his sixteenth year. Hence Caldwell was lucky enough to get education in the University of Glasgow. His associate with the priests made him think of God and thereby he dedicated himself to the Lord in 1830 at the blossoming age of sixteen. He dedicated himself to the congregational church of London Mission Society. The society decided to send him for higher studies in Glasgow as well as in the introductory classes of Cecil at Turvey in Bedfordshire. He received his Bachelor of Arts degree from Glasgow University in 1837. The London Mission Society ordered him as a clergy and sent him to Madras in 1837.

On reaching Chennai, Caldwell remained for three years since 1838 and prepared himself for the work he had chosen to do. In those days, Caldwell had famous Tamil scholars, renowned educationalists, missionaries and intellectual Government servants as his friends. Caldwell had a mastery over almost 18 languages. This assisted him to write the Comparative Grammar, his standard production of enormous and lasting value. When Caldwell stayed in Chennai, he learned the traditional Tamil learning method and the modern learning method, and the kind of the need of the people to deliver education for their children. The nature of Tamil

and Tamil people were identified to Caldwell through printed books and his communication with scholars.

His Social Service

As a priest he not only spread Christianity, but also played the role of a doctor, patron, and a magistrate. He realized that it was his duty and loving service to found more and more schools to train and civilize not only Christians but also other groups of the community and empower them to increase their status in the society. He started to teach the illiterates and the unconscious heathens. His wife struggled to make women as earning members of the family by teaching crafts to them. During his period, the southern part of Tirunelveli was severely affected by Cholera. The people of Tirunelveli supposed in the effectiveness of Mantras. When Caldwell came to that village and prayed for the peoples for their recovery from the disease, so the deadly cholera stopped. Seeing that the Hindus also asked him to pray for them. Tirunelveli was affected by a flood in 1869,it never known before, Caldwell and his wife went from village to village and saw the people. They shared their miseries and consoled them. In this stage, he established the hospital at Idaiyangudi in 1870 with the help of Lord Napier, the then Governor of Madras. Tirunelveli also faced severe famine and outbreak of Cholera in 1877-78. Caldwell committed himself to relief work for the whole community irrespective of caste and creed. This made for him the affection and respect of all and accounted for as many as 24,000 Hindus and Muslims accepting Christianity.

As a humanitarian he was stimulated by the pitiable condition of the Shanars and wanted to do good to their community in and around Idaiyangudi to restore their sorrow. He pleasingly and faithfully revealed the life, ceremonies, the sufferings, poverty and hunger of Shanars. Moreover, the dishonor accumulated upon them. They were suffering under the high caste people. He wrote all those in a small book, “The Tinnevelly Shanars”, in 1849. It exposed the miserable condition of the Shanars. The aim of this book was to show the poorest and pathetic condition of Shanars to the attention of his friends and the people of England. This facilitated him to educate the Shanars and elevation and reduce their sufferings. But it was misunderstood and misguided by the

Shanar Community itself. He received their ill-will and enmity. It made him regret and withdrew that book (1881) with heavy heart.

His literary works

Caldwell desired to provide shape to his assimilated knowledge about Tamil grammar, which he acquired from native scholars, pandits and European scholars. On his way from Chennai to Thiruvelly, he crossed many places of dialectical differences like Puducherry, Kumbakonam, Thanjavur, Trichinopoly, Coimbatore, Metupalayam, Nilgris, Kodaikanal, Madurai which places he wanted to provide shape and form. His precarious and absorbing mind always, believed of doing a classical work on Tamil language, which he succeeded in 1856.

Robert Caldwell in his work A Comparative Grammar of Dravidian Languages (1856), not only analysed linguistic affinities of the Dravidian languages but also formulated the origin and nature of the Dravidian culture from the forst century A.D. He refuted the stand that the Dravidian languages were derived from Sanskrit. He provided a formidable evidence to establish the antiquity, purity, primacy and sophistication of Tamil and denied the position claimed for Sanskrit. His findings led to the polarity between Brahmins and non-Brahmins, between northern Sanskrit and southern Tamil and identified the Aryan-Dravidian divide. It familiarized a new scholarly area to the Tamil society. It has its own inspiration on the history and study of Tamil grammar. This works associates the South Indin languages such as Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam and Tulu. Caldwel debated that all these languages belonged to a particular family. He recognized the relationship among these languages through the basic words used.

History of Tinneveli, Tamarai Thadakam, Parathakanda Puranam and Gnanakkovil were some of the works of Caldwell. Caldwell manipulated all the time to identify about the general history of the country where he is doing his religious service. But, Caldwell could not find a thorough work on Tinnevelly. He felt unhappy that there were very few historians in Tinnevelly. From the very beginning of his appearance, he started reading the history of Tinnevelly, from various sources.

Most of the information on ancient India was, at that time, available in German which was learnt by Caldwell for that purpose. The collected resources for the History of Tinnevelly was issued in 1881 with the support of the Government of Madras. Its history covering over 2000 years was reviewed by him for the common understanding. His affection for Tinnevelly is visible in every page.

Caldwell also wrote the Records of the Early History of the Tinnvelly, Mission of the Society for Promoting Christian knowledge and the Society of the Propagation of the Gospel in Foreign Parts. He played a important role in the translation work of The Bible and translated many stanzas and also a prayer book. Caldwell also found time for abundant brochures, the best known of which are those connecting to demon worship in Tinnevelly. Caldwell was also a research scholar of Archaeology. He desired to excavate atleast one place mentioned by the Greek geographers. He wanted to select Korkai and Kayal and ensured a bit of digging. Since the lack of sufficient amenities he could not do well in these efforts. Caldwell undertook Archaeological excavations in Korkai. He was the forerunner to expose that i) Korkai was a harbour ii) Trade was carried out and iii) Buddhism was predominant there. By writing the history of Tinnevelly, Caldwell is being placed among the men topping the list of great men.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. What was the grammar book written by Caldwell?
2. Name the history book written by Caldwell.

11.3 G.U.Pope

G. U. Pope was born on 24th April, 1820. He contributed much for the Tamil language. He came to Tamil Nadu as a Christian missionary in 1839. G.U.Pope was greatly influenced by the brilliance of the Tamil language. His first task was to create the Christian town of Sawyerpuram near Tuticorin. G.U.Pope was worked with a group of converts of the Christian Missionary. He established a secondary school, a divinity college, and also a church. Pope built numerous schools and imparted Latin, English, Hebrew, Mathematics and Philosophy. He left

Sawyerpuram in 1849 never to return. G.U.Pope expended forty two years in his life in South India.

G.U.Pope found his true calling running schools, and bringing organized teaching methods to both local and colonial residents. His supreme achievement as educator and designer was Bishop Cotton School, Bangalore. Till it was functioning as one of the finest Indian independent schools. After his return to England in 1882 he turn into a professor of Tamil and Telugu at Balliol College, Oxford.

Literary Works

Generally Caldwell's theory was supplemented by G.U.Pope. His most valuable and interesting work was the translation of Tiuruvasakam which formed a part of the canonical product of Saivism. G.U.Pope accomplished his translation of Tirukkural on September 1, 1886. His "Sacred Kural" (Thirukkural) comprises introduction, grammar, translation, notes, lexicon and concordance. In his Introduction to the English Publication of Thirukkural, G.U.Pope marked on the superiority of Tamil: "Tamil is a sophisticated unique language, with a rich vocabulary. It is the mother of all South Indian languages, Tamil literature was designed to create high moral standards, ethical codes and Thirukkural is a great example of that". It also includes the English translation of F.W.Ellis and the Latin Translation of Fr. Beschi. It is a volume of 436 pages. G.U.Pope was also translated Naaladiyaar in 1893.

G.U.Pope's persistent work made the British to realize the significance of Tamil language and literature. G.U.Pope's works opened up their eyes on the level of Tamil civilization two thousand years ago and its greater philosophy and faith. He frequently contributed his articles on Tamil literature in the Royal Asiatic Quarterly, the Indian Antiquary, and in the Indian Magazine and Review. His works were valuable accompaniments for the strengthening of a History of Tamil literature. He translated the complete work of Manimekalai in English prose. His Elementary Tamil Grammar at elementary level proved his efficiency in language.G.U.Pope had equipped Dr. Winslow's Tamil-English Dictionary with a number of additions of words. He found numerous schools and religious institutions in various parts of Tamil Nadu. While serving at Oxford University as a Tamil professor he promulgated the potentials of

Tamil language and its fruitfulness to the European students. He also published numorous great works as Tholkapiyam and Nannool. He made classical Tamil easier to English students, while Tamil students could afford means for a more widespread and fruitful study of the classics.

His important contributions on Tamil language covers various names comprising the "Poets of the Tamil lands", "The Lives of Tamil Saints" and "Extracts from Purananuru and Purapporul Venba Malai", etc. He familiarized various western themes to the Tamil people. Starting from western psychology, philosophy, and mathematics. G.U.Pope taught several such subject to the Tamils. G.U.Pope received the popular Gold Medal given once in three years for meritorious service and to mark the Diamond Jubilee of Queen Victoria in 1906 by the Royal Asiatic society. He passed away on 12 February 1908.

Check Your Progress Questions

3. Which year G.U.Pope translated the Thirukkural?
4. Which year Naladiyar was translated by G.U.Pope?
5. Who awarded gold medal to G.U.Pope?

11.4 Robert-De-Nobili

Robert de Nobili was an Italian by birth. Robert de Nobili was born at Rome in September 1577. Robert joined the Society of Jesus at the age of twenty. He left Portugal in 1604 and reached Goa. After his arrival in Goa, he visited Tamil Nadu in 1606. In January 1606, Nobili went to Cochin and from there to the Pearl Fishery Coast, where he continued for six months. Robert De Nobili settled down at Madurai as an Indian Sanyasi. He came to Madurai on 15th November 1606 accompanied by Fr. Albert Laerzio. Robert De Nobili established a mission at Madurai and discoursed Christianity for closely for fifty years.

Robert De Nobili implemented the customs and practices of the Brahmins to adapt high caste Hindus. He started wearing ochre-robes, wooden shoes; gave up meat and supported stick and kamandalam (water jug) like a Hindu hermit. Robert De Nobili started applying Sandal paste and shaved his head. But he was carefullu obtained prior consent from Arch bishop positioned at Crangnoor. He appointed a Brahmin cook and he

ate only rice and vegetables and he also started sleeping on the ground like a sage. He utilised his time in studying Sanskrit and holy books besides writing Christian psalms and prayers in Tamil. Robert De Nobili opened a school of catechism and gradually started familiarizing Christian theology. He converted an "Iyer" to local people who started worshipping him for his ascetic life, kind manners and remedial powers which he had acquired humbly. He also presumed the name Tathuva Bodha Swami and converted almost one lakh individuals to Christianity. He became as a master in Tamil. He abandoned his European style of living and changed instead those of the Brahmins.

There was lots of opposition among Christians about the method of living and preaching style of Robert De Nobili. So the opponents complained to papal authority regarding the life style of Robert De nobili. Secret enquiry was conducted by the church. But Robert De Nobili had converted a good number of people to Christianity because of his simple and Hindu model life style. He had constructed a church modeled on a Hindu temple and had very good following among natives. He inscribed psalms on palm leaves like a Brahmin pandit. Robert De Nobili also studied Sanskrit from the Telugu Brahmin Shivadharma.They spent hours and days for teaching Robert, the Hindu philosophy and mythology. Finally Shivadharma himself got changed into Christianity. He was permitted to wear sacred thread with cross and continue with cluster. This encouraged others who desired to retain the behaviors of their earlier faith to become Christians, drawn to the teachings of Christ, and saintly living and guiding by Robert.

Gregory XV was the Pope at the time of Robert's missionary works. He had chosen a tribunal to deal with the objections acknowledged against Robert De Nobili as well as his letters. There was a very learned member of the Tribunal, Peter Lombard by name who considered comprehensively all the letters, cases and arguments put forth by Robert De Nobili and influenced other members that here was a novel way of bringing more following to church. After a struggle of thirteen years, the Vatican Church agreed to adoption of several modes of preaching in Eastern and African countries. This assisted Robert De Nobili a good deal in his mission.

Robert De Nobili laid the foundation of a honestly Indian Church during 1607 to 1612. This directed to the establishment of the Madurai Mission.The jurisdiction of Madurai Mission was too wide in the early years.It covered the districts of Trichinopoly, Tanjore, Madurai and Tinnevelly. During his halt in Madurai, Robert de Nobili lived on firm vegetarian diet. Robert was impressed by this vegetarian diet because of the Brahmin Scholars surrounded him. The reputation of Robert De Nobili soon spread far and wide. The natives were surprised at the purity of his Tamil and fascinated by his oriental learning and adaptable intelligence.

His literary Works

Robert de Nobili composed numerous prose works such as Manthiramalai, Gnanaobathesa Kandam, Athma Nirnayam, Yesunatha charitram, Gnanadeepikai, etc., in Tamil. But some works were vanished in course of time since he failed to copy them. While serving the spread of Christianity, Robert De Nobili was also aided for the promotion of Tamil language. Robert De Nobili had a flair for Indian languages especially Tamil and Sanskrit. Nobili is reflected to be the first oriental scholar in the modern sense of the word. He continued his learning Sanskrit till his death in 1656. Due to his interest that he composed numerous books, and wrote hymns and prayer songs in Sanskrit. Robert De Nobili's important work was "Information". It is a Sanskrit work and it is sufficient to demonstrate his wisdom in Sanskrit.

The Life of Our Lady was wrote in Sanskrit in poetry form. His books are generally Philosophical and Theological such as Gnanopadesa Kandam or Spiritual Teaching, the Athma Nirnayam, Yesunatha charitram, Gnana deepikai. Disquision on the soul, the Divya Madirigai,Divine Mood ,Tushana Tikkaram, Rufutation of Blasphemy, Punerjenma Chapam, Refutation of Rebirth and Gnana Sanchivi . Robert De Nobili wrote the Athma Nirnayam and Akkiana Nivaranam in prison.

Fr. Sauliere was able to translate the works of Nobili into English due to the knowledge of French, Latin, Portuguese, Spanish and Tamil, Robert De Nobili discharged from the Mission in 1648 due to old age and loss of sight. It is said that he had immersed about 100000 Tamilians to

Christianity. It was supposed wise to post him to Ceylon as Superior of the Mission to that island.

Due to deterioration in his health, Robert De Nobili was transferred from there to Mylapore in Madras. At this point he constructed himself a small cottage and spent his last days in the company of his first converts and old friends.Robert De Nobili divided his time into literary composition, prayer and observation. Nobili died on 16th January 1695. He was beyond doubt the greatest of the Missionaries sent out to India by the Society of Jesus. In short, he was the real founder of the Madura Mission.

Check Your Progress Questions

6. Which year Robert de Nobili came to India?
7. What was name assumed by De Nobili?

11.5 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. A Comparative Grammar of Dravidian or Family of South Indian Languages
2. History of Tinnevelly
3. 1886
4. 1893
5. Royal Asiatic society
6. 1606
7. Tathuva Bodha Swami

11.6 Summary

- Dr. Robert Caldwell was one of the well-known scholar and an archaeologist Christian Missionaries of South India.
- As a rector he not only spread Christianity, but also played the role of a doctor, philanthropist, and a magistrate.
- Caldwell had a mastery over nearly 18 languages.
- This helped him write the Comparative Grammar, his classic production of immense and lasting value.
- Robert Caldwell's famous work was A Comparative Grammar of Dravidian Languages (1856).

- This work not only analysed linguistic affinities of the Dravidian languages but also formulated the origin and nature of the Dravidian culture from the forst century A.D.
- History of Tinneveli, Tamarai Thadakam, Parathakanda Puranam and Gnanakkovil were some of the important works of Caldwell.
- The collected materials for the History of Tinnevelly was published in 1881 with the support of the Government of Madras.
- Caldwell was also a research scholar of Archaeology.
- G. U. Pope was born on 24-4-1820 in a hamlet in Edwards Island in the Canadian neighborhood.
- He came to Tamil Nadu as a Christian missionary in 1839,
- He completed his translation of Tirukkural on September 1, 1886.
- G.U.Pope's untiring work made the British to understood the importance of Tamil language and literature.
- Generally Caldwell's theory was supplemented by G.U.Pope.
- His most valuable and interesting work was the translation of Tiuruvasakam
- His important works on Tamil language covers various titles including the "Poets of the Tamil lands", "The Lives of Tamil Saints" and "Extracts from Purananuru and Purapporul Venba Malai", etc.
- He published such great works as Tholkapiyam. Nannool, and made classical Tamil easier to English students.
- Robert de Nobili was an Italian by birth.
- Robert de Nobili was born at Rome in September 1577.
- He established a mission at Madurai and preached Christianity for nearly 50 years.
- He adopted the customs and practices of the Brahmins to change high caste Hindus
- He spent time studying Sanskrit and holy books besides writing Christian psalms and prayers in Tamil.
- He also assumed the name Tathuva Bodha Swami and converted nearly one lakh persons to Christianity.
- He kept on learning Sanskrit till his death in 1656

- His "Information", a Sanskrit work itself is enough to prove his depth in Sanskrit.
- Robert de Nobili composed several prose works such as Manthiramalai, Gnanaobathesa Kandam, Athma Nirnayam, Yesunatha charitram, Gnanadeepikai, etc., in Tamil.
- Robert De Nobili had a flair for Indian languages especially Tamil and Sanskrit.
- Nobili discharged from the Mission in 1648 due to old age and blindness. He died on 16th January 1695.
- He was beyond doubt the greatest of the Missionaries sent out to India by the Society of Jesus.

11.7 Key words

- Thathuvam – Philosophy
- Korkai - Korkai was the principal center of trade and important port of the Early Pandyan Kingdom.
- Shanars- The Shanars also known as Nadars were a community of toddy tappers.
- Venba- Venpa is a form of classical Tamil poetry.It has been classified based upon the rules of metric prosody. Every venba consists of between two and twelve lines.

11.8 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. List out the social services of Caldwell.
2. Write a short note on " History of Tinnevely".
3. Write briefly about the literary works of G.U.Pope.
4. What are the works of Robert de Nobili?

Long Answer Questions

1. Describe the contribution of Caldwell to the history of Tirunelveli.
2. Evaluate the role of G.U.Pope to the growth of Tamil literature.
3. Assess the functions of Robert de Nobili in Tamil Nadu.

11.9 Further Readings

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BLOCK IV : NON- BRAHMIN MOVEMENT AND LEADERS PARTICIPATION

Unit XII Non-Brahmin movement

12.0 Introduction

12.1 Objectives

12.2 Non-Brahmin movement

12.3 Causes

12.4 Justice Party

12.5 Dravidian movement

12.6 Answers to check your progress questions

12.7 Summary

12.8 Key words

12.9 Self Assessment Questions

12.10 Further Readings

12.0 Introduction

The Tamil society is generally divided into several groups such as Brahmins, non-Brahmins, Backward classes, Depressed class people, Muslims and Christians. Non-Brahmins constitute a heterogeneous group including Depressed class and backward classes. The term non-Brahmins was not meant everyone who was not a Brahmin, but only the non-Brahmin caste Hindus, so that the division of the local society into Brahmins. The higher caste non-Brahmins drawn from numerous regional caste groups frequently worked in local and provincial structure with Brahmins. Eventhough they worked with the Brahmins, they were observed inferior to them in the ritual and social status. In the case of Harijans, though they were treated under Sudra category along with the other castes of non-Brahmins. The Sudra category was regarded inferior to other non-Brahmins. The social reform movements including the general or voluntary associations, caste reform associations which were mostly planned by upper castes initiated programme of education and other welfare measures for the backward classes. But, the concept of

Brahmanism was the root cause for the evolution of numerous caste associations in the Madras Presidency. By the end of 19th century these caste associations struggled for the prosperity of their own communities and claimed regularly the educational opportunities for their community. There was a new awakening arose among the non-Brahmins in between 1908 to 1915 in Tamil Nadu.

12.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Understand the emergence of Non-Brahmin movement in Tamil Nadu.
- Describe the causes for the origin of Non-Brahmin movement.
- Explain the genesis of Justice party and its achievements.
- Discus the growth of Dravidian movement in Tamil Nadu and its impact in the society.

12.2 Non-Brahmin movement

The Non-Brahmin manifesto was published on 20th December, 1916 in The Hindu which mainly posed the question of devastating majority of Brahmins in all ranges of Political, Social, Economic and Religious life of of the community. It went on to claim that the Non-Brahmins constituted forty million out of forty and half million population of the Madras Presidency. They were the bulk of the tax payers including a large majority of zamindars, agriculturists and land holders. They had little or no power to influence the masses for general political advancement of the country. It verifies with required statistics that the Brahmins with a small fraction of population in the Madras presidency was well ahead of other communities in the ground of education, Government services, Legislative councils and municipal and other services. They enjoyed highest status in the society, tied down with old established customs. The other communities were struggling to arise in the society in spite of various obstacles in their path. The non-Brahmins had little or no power to influence the masses for general political advancement of the country. The non-Brahmins had no political organization or spokesment or a press tp protect their common interest. The Brahmins formed “a small rigidly

exclusive caste. The Brahmins monopolized all Government services and this led to the practical exclusion of the non-Brahmin classes.

This manifesto also proposed some important procedures to be implemented to equalize all the communities on a level. It mentioned that future Indian constitution should be widen and expanded so that representatives of every class, caste and community should be given economic freedom and legislative independence affecting domestic strategy and economic position of India. At the end of manifesto fascinated to the leades of the the Non-Brahmin commuities to generate strong public opinion regarding the existing pitiable conditions and deliver educational facilities and also sponsor a well accompanied news paper as their bulletin and contribute in the "national building on the ground of self-respect and perfect equality."

12.3 Causes

In the social system of India the Brahmins has been one of the eldest social institutions in the historical India, demanding a certain primary in the society. The Brahmins were usually a literate community naturally gifted with residence in their social performance and quite adoptable to changing times. So, the Brahmins started to occupy all the important government jobs in 19th century. At same time at the lowest level the mechanical and menial jobs were left to uneducated among the native communities. There were three major non-Brahmins groups in Tamil Nadu, namely non Brahmin caste Hindus, the Muslims and the Indian Christians; besides there were the untouchables who were formally termed the Adi-Dravidars. The non–Brahmin community is a cultural contrast which united diverse cases within an encompassing political identity. The theory of non-Brahmin was the consequence of the westernization instead of politicalisation of the communities other than the Brahmins.

The majority of the non-Brahmins felt that opportunity for government service were improperly deceived to them and to the same extent, unduly great opportunity were given to the Brahmins. In the Madras Provincial Civil services, held between 1892 and 1904, out of sixteen successful candidates, fifteen were Brahmins giving a ratio of ninety four percent Brahmin success. In the competition for the

appointment of Asistant Engineers, during the same period, seventeen Brahmins and four non-Brahmins were selected as successful candidates. Similarly in the competitive examination held for the Account Departments, out of 140 Deputy Collectors in Madras at that time, seventy seven were Brahmins, thirty non-Brahmins and the rest others. In the Subordinate Judicial Service, the major portion of the appointments were in the hands of Brahmins. Again in 1913, out of 128 permanent District Munsiffs, ninety three were Brahmins, twenty five non-Brahmins and the rest others. The Brahmins monopolized all Government services and this led to the practical exclusion of the non-Brahmin classes.

Again out of the Indian judges of the High court, four of them were Brahmins. Similarly when fifteen persons were elected from the Presidency to represent all India Congress Committee, with the exception of one, all were Brahmins. They enjoyed practical monopoly of political power and high government appointments. Brahmins occupied all government appointments, great or small and high or low. This helped them to adapt themselves easily to the new condition under the British rule. The English education gave them a social status and steady economic development. Hence, the need of the time was a non-Brahmin movement which would give expression to the non-Brahmin feelings, long smelting as a protest against Brahmin leadership.

The non-Brahmin movement was not a phenomena, unusual to Madras presidency alone. It found model in various provinces. The Hindu social set up mostly in peninsular India gave the Brahmins almost a dominant position. The non-Brahmin movement was not communal in its attitude. In this respect, V.R. Kothari wrote. ‘‘The aim of the movement was the socio educational uplift of the Non–Brahmins and the downtrodden. But our opponents used to accuse us as haters of Brahmins.” The non-Brahmins realized that because of Brahmanism, they remained backward illiterate and fatalist. Everybody has now realized that the Brahmanism has harmed the country. The merits and monopoly of Brahmins were disturbed and that added strength to the Non- Brahmin Movement.

Satya Shadhak Samaj

The first non-Brahmin movement against the domination of the upper caste was organized by Jothirao Phule. He was the founder of Satya Shadhak Samaj in 1873. It means "Truth Seeking Society". It intended at liberating the lower caste people from the clutches of the upper divison. Jothirao Phule was hailed as Mahatma; may be due to the fact he sought the truth and insisted on equality of all the people.The democratization of civil society to enable the maximum number of people to enter the new political community was the basic thrust of the Phule and Satya shodak movement. The programme of the Society comprised womens liberation, education and economic betterment. Its non-Aryan theory and ideology of the cultuiral devote proceded the development of a smaller emphasise on Dravidian identity in ther Madras non-Brahmin movements.

Non-Brahmin movement in Kolhapur

Kolhapur was a princely state. It was one of the centres of non-Brahmin movement in Maharashtra. Chatrapathi Shahu maharaja of Kolhapur undertook the mission of uplifting the non-brahmins and the depressed classes after Jyotiba Phule. He confronted the Brahmin convention soon after he ascended the throne. Chatrapati Shahu Maharaja revived Satya Shodak samaja in 1911 and its activities in his state. He tried to decrease the Brahmin authority in all fields. He made the Non-Brahmins aware of the need of political power. The Chatrapati turned out to be a radical and issued an order in 1902 reserving fifty percent of the vacancies in his administration for the members of the backward communities. It was during his reign [1894-1922] that the Satyashodak Movement deteriorated into the Non-Brahmin movement. With August declaration of 1917, Shahu Maharaja, encouraged, Political ambitions among Non-Brahmins, he also awakened them about the desirability of getting political rights.

Non-Brahmin movement in Tiruvancore

The non-Brahmin movement in Tiruvancore was mainly a revolt against the monopoly that the Tamil Brahmins enjoyed in the administrative service of the state. The Tamil Brahmins who were famously known as Pattar Brahmins were regarded by the Malayali

soeaking natives of the state as "foreigners", thought they were residents there for centuries. Their origin is obscure. Nothing is known as to when they came and settled in the southern part of Kerala. The Nambudiris who were at the top of the social hierarchy claimed a higher status than the Pattar Brahmins. But the Pattar Brahmins who had acquired a knowledge of Vedas occupied a very important position in the social set up of these states. They despised the Nairs and treated them as inferior. The Nairs and Syrian Christians despite their Engluish education, were also given unfair treatment.The judicial and revenue hands of the administration were mostly in the hands of foreign Brahmin graduates. A vast number of the Brahmins were free from taxation. Their excessive predominance and monopoly in the administration of the state produced a feeling of bitterness rather than jealousy among the non-Brahmin communities. The hostility and protest of the non-Brahmins were revealed through a weighty memorial, prepared by K.P.Sankara Menon, a vakil of High Court of Madras in 1891, and signed by more than ten thousand people of different castes, creeds and calling.

Non-Brahmin movement in Mysore

The dominance of Brahmins in various circles of public life in Mysore and elsewhere in Southern states of India created a feeling of obstruction and resentment among the elite non-Brahmins. As a result, the leading non-Brahmin castes such as Vokkalyas and Lingayats established caste associations to further the interests of their own cates in the race for urban development. By 1917, Reddy a Cambridge Scholar noted for his erudition and scholarship, offered to give shape and form to the Anti-Brahmin feelings with the help of two prominent citizens of Mysore namely Me.Basavaiah and H.Channiaah and also a few Muslim leaders. Eventually an organization called Praja Mithra Mandali was born with a new creed which advocated equal opportunities and adequate representation in public services for all communities.

Madras Non-Brahmin Association

The Madras Non-Brahmin Association was established in 1909 by the leading advocates namely P.Subramaniyam and M.Purushotam Naidu. By about 1912, an organization namely Madras United League was formed

by non-Brahmin officials of the Revenue Board under the leadership of Dr.C.Natesa Mudaiar. In November 1912 its name was changed into Madras Dravidian Association. The Dravidian Association helped the non-Brahmins to unite themselves under one political platform.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. Which year Non-Brahmin manifesto was published?
2. How many non-Brahmin groups were in Tamil Nadu?
3. What is the meaning of Satya Shadhak Samaj?
4. Who awakened the non-Brahmins in Kolhapur?
5. Name the two non-Brahmin leaders of Mysore.

12.4 Justice Party

The Justice party played an important role in the history of Tamil Nadu from 1920 to 1935. According to Dr.S.Saraswathi, "The Justice Party was a political party with moderate political ambitions, with realistic vision on socio-political conditions and a party with a definite political programme to carry on the Government of the provinces in co-operation with the British rulers". Taking advantage of the illiteracy and ignorance of the people of Tamil land the Brahmins obtained political supremacy and kept Hinduism under their control. Obtaining the favour of the ruling people, they lived separately in Agraharams and Chadurvedimangalams.

They enjoyed, all political and social privileges. Using their influence in society they encouraged the people towards some outdated and bad traditions. One of the cruel evils encouraged by the Brahmins was sati. To get rid of the social evils that existed among the unprivileged so called untouchables; Nadars, Kuravars, Paravar,etc.and to reduce the supremacy of the Brahmins in Tamil land several organisations especially " South Indian Liberal Federation was started in Tamil Nadu in 1916. This organization vehemently opposed the Aryan influence and marked the gradual emergence of the Dravidians. It glorified the Tamil culture and opposed the Brahmin domination. It also created a sense of anti-Brahmin feeling among non-Brahmins.

South Indian Liberal Federation

The origin of the Justice Party can be traced to the beginning of a social organization called "The Madras United League". A few distressed non-Brahmin officials of the Revenue Board and other Government institutions who suffered from the partiality and unfair practices oftheir Brahmin superiority, formed this association solely for the purpose of ventilating their grievances in respect of their prospects in their official career. Though the initiative was taken by a group of government officials, the leadership and guidance came from Dr. C.Natesa mudaliar a non-official, service minded and popular doctor of Triplicane, Madras.

Attempts were made to organize to bring all the disunited non-Brahmins to a common platform to fight against injustice. It was pioneered by Dr.C.Natesa mudaiyar. For this purpose, he started an organization called "Madras Dravidian Association" in 1912. He acted as the secretary of that organization for a long time. He stressed the necessity of regular hostels for the non-Brahmin students so that they might have quality education. Hence he started a hostel in 1919 known to be "Dravidian Society Hostel". This happened to be the first organization for the benefit of the non-Brahmins. Books were also published to bring to light the social status of the backward. Dr. Natesa Mudaliyar tried to bring about the co-operation among the leaders who cared for the uplift of the people in Madras state politics and social changes. Dr.T.M.Nair expressed the necessity of the co-operation of all non-Brahmins forgetting their differences of opinions.

As a result of this P.Thiyagaraya chettiyar organized "South Indian Liberal Federation" with thirty non-Brahmins at the Victoria hall in Madras on November 26, 1916. The aim of the organization was to promote the political interest of non-Brahmin caste Hindus. This organization passed innumerable resolution for the benefit of the backward people. It resolved to publish thre dailies, Dravidian in Tamil, Andhra Prakasika in Telugu and Justice in English under the registration" South India People's society Limited".

T.M.Nair served as the editor of the political news paper "Justice". This news paper became very popular among the people. Hence the organization South Indian Liberal Federation was renamed after this news

paper as Justice party. This party worked hard for the freedom, equal justice and equal opportunities for all the non-Brahmins.

The activities of Justice Party

The Justice party which worked for the uplift of the down trodden people forwarded a series of demands to the government stressing the importance of education towards social welfare. So it requested the government to offer equal chance of education to all people and to reform Hinduism, reducing the highhandedness of the Brahmins. More over, it criticized the voting right on the basis of education and property and requested the government to offer voting right based on community.

The leaders of this party tried without a break to spread their doctrines among the people and collected party fund of lakhs of rupees within a year. They conducted conferences in all the important parts of the state and started branches of the party in all the palces. Hence, within very short period the Justice party became popular obtaining the support of the large number of people.

Justice Party in Administration

With a view to remove the supremacy of the Brahmins and obtain necessary concessions from the government the Justice party decided to give co-operation to the English and contested in the election of 1920. Gaining victory in 63 seats out of 98 seats, the Justice party formed the government. Lord Wellington appointed Subbarayulu Reddiyar as the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu in December 1920. The government was the first one formed on the basis of diarchy.

The next election to the Legislative Council was conducted after three years. In 1923, in the council election, Swaraj party of Congress, contested the election and Justice Party won only forty four seats, out of ninety eight elected seats in the council. As the Britishers were the supporters of Justice Party, they nominated seventeen additional Justice members which helped the Justice party to maintain its strength and get majority. A Telugu Zamindar Raja of Panagal formed the ministry.

The third election held in 1926, the Justice party faced severe opposition from the Congress party. It met utter failure due to the internal conflict of the party and the withdrawal of the support of Adidravidas and Muslims. The Swaraj party was outstandingly successful in the Legislative

council election in 1926. But the Swaraj party did not come forward to form the ministry. Instead they supported the ministry of independent candidate A.Subbarayan. In 1930, Justice Party contested the election. As their main opposition party, the Congress and the Swarajists refused to contest the election. The depressed communities extended support to the Justice party and it won the majority in the council. The fourth Justcie ministry was formed with Munusamy Naidu as the chief minister. However, due to internal conflicts in the party, Munusamy Naidu ministry resigned. In 1932, Raja of Bobbili became the chief minister of the presidency.

In 1934 election, Justice Party faced severe setback and was defeated in the poll. Internal party conflicts and the dissatisfaction of the people were the reasons for this failure. The Congress, once again refused to form the government. Consequently the Justice party was invited to form the ministry. The Raja of Bobbili formed his second ministry which continued to rull till it lost the election of 1937. But in 1937 on the basis of the assurance given by the British Government, Congress party constituted the ministry with C.Rajagopalachari as the chief minister. The Justice party which met with severe criticism of the people became inactive after 1937.

Achievements of the Justice Party

The Justice party during its thirteen years of rule in Tamil land had achieved several things. Trying to establish justice in the society, the party was able to reduce the supremacy of the Brahmins socially, politically and economically. To uplift the status of the non-Brahmins, the preference given to Brahmins in the public sector was reduced and employment opportunities on the basis of percentage were increased to ordinary people. The Employments Election Committee constituted by the ministry of Subbarayalu Reddiyar in 1924 was converted into the government Employment Selection Committee. Until the advent of the of Justice Party, the Munsiffs of the District Courts were appointed by the high courts and most of them were Brahmins. But in the ruling of Justice Party, the government itself appointed the Munsiffs in the District, thereby giving chance to non-Brahmins to become judges.

Another major social reform of Justice Ministry was the abolition of Devadasi system. The party extended the right of women to vote and

contest in the election. Accordingly Muthulakshmi Reddy was elected as a memver of the Legislative Council in 1926 and she became its Vice-president. She took the initiative to abolish the Devadasi system. The non-Brahmin Justice party was deeply committed to the abolition of untouchability. In 1925, a Bill was introduced in the Madras Legislative Council which had thrown open all pucads, streets or pay giving access to any public office, well, tank or place of public resorts to all classes of people. They also contributedmuch to the progress of higher education. During the ministry, two universities were established, one for Telugus and the other one for Tamils. Justice ministry took active measures for the welfare of the depressed communities. They assigned Government waste lands to the deprived communities. In 1931 the Government assigned 22,700 acres of lands for the provision of 1973 house sites free of cost. In 1934, Raja of Bobbili introduced the Madras Tenants Land Reform Act which protected the tenants from the exploitation of landlords and prevented unnecessary eviction from their lands.

Causes for the decline of Justice Party

The Justice party declined gradually after the elections of 1937. When all the parties were against the English rule, the Justice party came forward to function in co-operation with the English government. To get support to their schemes they were forced to forget their original principles. This attitude was severely criticized by the followers of the party and other opposition parties. The popularity of the Justice party was greatly eroded due to the progress of national movement under the Congress. Internal conflicts, regional, linguistic and communal divisions seriously affected the unity of the party. The leaders of this party showed much interest in gaining power and not in strengthening the party. Though the Justice party declined on its ruin emerged the Dravida Kazhagam. In 1944, in the conference held at Salem, Periyar E.V.Ramasamy, the president of the Justice party reorganized the Justice party into Dravida kazhagam.

Check Your Progress Questions

6. Which year Madras Dravidian Asociation was formed?
7. Who started the Dravidian Society Hostel?
8. Name the Tamil Daily started by the South Indian Welfare Association.

12.5 Dravidian Movement

The Dravidian movement owes its origin to the Christian missionaries for recovering the cultural heritage. The revival of Tamil language and culture in the nineteenth and early twentieth century was mainly due to the works of the Christian missionaries who acted as a catalyst for the Tamil renaissance and the conception of Dravidian ideology. The missionaries, Caldwell and G.u.Pope ranked first among all Tamil scholars who pioneered the study of Dravidian history and culture. They laid the foundation for the remarkable renaissance of Tamil language, literature and history. Dravidian culture always upheld the primary of Dravidian languages and literature.

The history of communal situation in Tamil Nadu is associated with its policies. On the eve of Indian Independence, E.V.Ramasamy Naicker, leader of the newly formed Dravida Kazhagam , in Madras, asked the Dravidian people of South India" to safeguard against a transfer of power from the British to the Aryans". Fearing Brahmin domination under Aryan imperialism E.V.R.Ramasamy mh h Naicker called for the formation of a separate South Indian State "Dravida Nadu" instructing his followers to sign a pledge of support for thorough separation from the Indian Union. The major division of India is between the Aryan North and the Dravidian South. The Dravidian people today characterized linquistically, dominate South India, an area corresponding to the present states of Madras, Kerala, Mysore and Andhra Pradesh. The dissimilarities between the North and South are real. Yet much of the opposition which has ascended between the two regions is more the product of historical much than of reality.

The origin of the Dravidian people lies in question. It has been suggested that they are the descendents of the last tribes of Israel that they came to South India through migrations by sea from North Africa and

West Asia. More credible is the view that the Dravidians entrance into India was through the Northwest, predating the Aryan "invasions" by as much as 1500 years.

As the Aryans pushed down into India, beginning about 2000 B.C. Dravidians moved South. mixing with the dark proto-Australized peoples, who evidence a human antiquity in India dating back about 500,000 years and exist today as the tribal people of South India.

The method of Ariyanization started and Sanskritic elements were introduced into the Tamil languae. Local customs were integrated into the formation of a new social order and the Dravidian deities were given Sanskritic labels and were placed in the elastic partheon of Brahminical religion. Dravidian Social Organisation was divided into seven principal classes, but caste was unknown until the advent of Aryanization. The process was slow and not altogether effective. The ruling kings were admitted into the Kshatriya caste and in some instances, certain princes were integrated into the Brahmin community itself. Though the occupational "super guild" system of caste brought other groups into the hierarchy, the vast majority of the people remained outside the pale of caste.

These "social jealousies" came to manifest themselves primarily in the relationship between the Brahmins and the non-Brahmins in the South. The Brahmins of South India, often socially and psychologically distant has reserved and superiority of caste orthodoxy often combining economic power derived from land ownership with religious authority the Brahmin further separated himself from the lower castes and increased his control over them. The position of the Brahmin encouraged distrust. Without education, economic power of political influence, the non-Brahmins of Tamil Nadu felt the yoke of oppression and exploitation. Among the Urban non-Brahmin classes, however, the non-Brahmins of Madras Presidency sought to ally with the colonial regime, believing that foreign rule would protect their position and in some way neutralize power differences within the population.

Jothirao Phule was the founder of Satya Shadhak Samaj in 1873. It was the first non-Brahmin movement against the domination of the upper caste. The organization never gained power or success, but, it was the

beginning of a series of similar movements throughout South India. Dr.C.Natesa Mudaliyar was the founder of the "Dravidian Home, a hostel for Non-Brahmin students. He had found the non-Brahmins were unable to find hostel accomodations in Madras because of caste barriers. The Home functioned for only two years, but during that time Natesa Mudaliar began, the Dravidian Association with the purpose of advancing non-Brahmin political power through "Dravidian Uplift".

The real impetus to the Dravidian movement did not come until the formation of the South Indian Liberal Federation popularly known as the Justice party. Dravidian Association had not effectively gained the loyalty of non-Brahmin politicians the two most prominent of whom were Dr.T.M.Nair and Sir.P.Thiyagaraya Chetty. Nadesa Mudaiar attempted to bring about a reapproachment between the two leaders and November 1916, Chetty and Nair came together with other leaders of the non-Brahmin community to consider what measures might be adopted to check increasing political power of the Brahmin caste. It was resolved that an association of non-Brahmin Hindus be formed under the name of the South Indian People Asociation.

After the formation of the Association, it issued the Non-Brahmin Manifesto" in 1916. It was surveying the conditions of the non-Brahmin community and pointing out directions for advancement. The Brahmins, however, because of education, religion, suthority, economic power, political influence and social prestige stood as exclusice elite in contrast to the illiterate masses which constituted more than 95 percent of the society. The Manifesto voiced alarm at the growing Brahmin agitation for Home rule. With the proclamation of the non-Brahmin manifesto, it was decided that an association for the political advancement of the nen-Brahmin community should be formed to function alongside the South Indian People's Association. In August, 1917, the South Indian Liberal Federation came into existence.

Check Your Progress Questions

9. Who called for the formation of "Dravida Nadu"?
10. Who established the South Indial Liberal Federation?

12.6 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. 1916
2. Three
3. Truth Seeking Society
4. Chatrapati Shahu maharaja of Kolhapur
5. Me.Basavaiah and H.Channiaah
6. 1912
7. Dr. Natesa Mudaliyar
8. Dravidian
9. Periyar E.V.Ramasamy
10. Dr. Natesa Mudaliyar, T.M.Nair and P.Thyagaraja chettiyar

12.7 Summary

- The Non-Brahmin manifesto was published in 1916.
- There were three major non-Brahmins groups in Tamil Nadu, namely Non Brahmin caste Hindus, the Muslims and the Indian Christians
- The Brahmins instigated to occupy all the important government jobs.
- They enjoyed practical monopoly of political power and high government appointments.
- The aim of the non-Brahmin movement was the socio educational uplift of the Non–Brahmins and the downtrodden.
- The first non-Brahmin movement against the domination of the upper caste was organized by Jothirao Phule.
- He was the founder of Satya Shadhak Samaj in 1873.
- Kolhapur, a princely state, was one of the centres of non-Brahmin movement in Maharashtra.
- The Justice party played an role in the history of Tamil Nadu from 1920 to 1935.
- To get rid of the social evils that existed among the unprivileged and to reduce the supremacy of the Brahmins in Tamil land " South Indian Liberal Federation was started in Tamil Nadu in 1916.

- It was pioneered by Dr.C.Natesa mudaiyar. For this purpose, he started an organization called "Madras Dravidian Association" in 1912.
- The Justice party which worked for the uplift of the down trodden people.
- Lord Wellington appointed Subbarayulu Reddiyar as the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu in December 1920..
- The Justice party during its thirteen years of rule in Tamil land had achieved several things.
- The Justice party was able to reduce the supremacy of the Brahmins socially, politically and economically.
- Another major social reform of Justice ministry was the abolition of Devadasi system.
- Justice ministry took active measures for the welfare of the Depressed communities.
- They assigned Government waste lands to the deprived communities.
- They also contributedmuch to the progress of higher education. During the ministry, two universities were established.
- The Justice party declined gradually after the elections of 1937.
- The popularity of the Justice party was greatly eroded due to the progress of national movement under the Congress.
- E.V.Ramasamy Naicker, called upon the Dravidian people of South India" to guard against a transfer of power from the British to the Aryans".
- The process of Ariyanization began and Sanskritic elements were introduced into the Tamil languae.
- Natesa Mudaliar began the Dravidian Association .
- The real impetus to the Dravidian movement did not come until the formation of the South Indian Liberal Federation popularly known as the Justice party.

12.8 Key words

- **Dravidam:** Dravidam is used to denote south Indians who lives in peninsula

- **Munshiff:** A public officer who is invested with authority to hear and determine litigated causes, and to administer justice between parties in courts held for that purpose.

12.9 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. What are the causes for the genesis of non-Brahmin movement?
2. Write a note on South Indian Liberal Federation.
3. What are the causes for the downfall of Justice Party?

Long Answer Questions

1. Assess the significance of non-Brahmin movement .
2. What are the achievements of Justice Party?
3. Write an essay about the formation of Dravidian movement.

12.10 Further Readings

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Unit- XIII T.M.Nair-C.Natesa Mudaliar- P.Thiagaraya Chetti

13.0 Introduction

13.1 Objectives

13.2 T.M.Nair

13.3 C.Natesa Mudaliar

13.4 P.Thiyagaraya Chetti

13.5 Periyar E.V.R.

13.6 A.T.Panneerselvam

13.7 Answers to check your progress questions

13.8 Summary

13.9 Key words

13.10 Self Assessment Questions

13.11 Further Readings

13.0 Introduction

Dr. T.M. Nair (Taravath Madhavan Nair) was one of the ablest surgeons in India who commanded extensive practice. He was the editor of the Medical journal Antiseptic which is said to have been the first of its kind in Madras Presidency. He was a member of the City Council for 12 years from 1904. He represented Triplicane consisting of educated class of a large percentage being Brahmins and made a great contribution to the improvement of the working of the corporation.

Dr. T.M. Nair joined the Indian National Congress and ardently worked for it at the earlier stage of its growth. He was one of the most respected figures in public life in the presidency. He attended Congress sessions from 1890 and took an active part. In 1916 he expected to be elected by the Madras Legislative Council to the Imperial Legislative Council in Delhi, but in the end two Brahmins, B.N. Sarma and V.S. Srinivasa Sastrl were elected. He and his supporters felt that the Brahmins exclusiveness had led them to break what amounted to a tacit promise to vote for him. This made him leave the Congress and take a leading part in organising the Non-Brahmin Movement.

13.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Explain the role of T.M.Nair in the emergence of the Justice Party
- Describe the works of C.Natesa Mudaliar and P.Thiyagaraya chetti for the upliftment of non-Brahmins.
- Understand the contribution of Periyar E.V.Ramasamy in eradicating the social evils from Tamil Nadu.
- Assess the role of A.T.Pannerselvam to the Tamil Society.

13.2 T.M.Nair

Dr.T.M.Nair was the first national leader of the Justice party. He inculcated a fighting spirit in every non-Brahmin. As a radical, he popularized the ethnic concept of Dravidian origin of non-Brahmins. His intellect and powers of expression were equally uncommon. By profession Dr.T.M.Nair was a physician. Perhaps his close observation of English political life during his student days in the University of Edinburgh made him take a lively and consistent interest in the policies of Madras Presidency.

Dr.T.M.Nair was noted for fireless and ceaseless work though he did not enjoy good health. He offered himself to be the honorary editor. His bold venture saved his Journal "Justice" from being strangled at its inception wihout an editor. He used the columns of his Journal "Justice" both for constructive and destructive purposes. He turned out to be an inveterate enemy of Mrs. Annie Besant, perhaps due to personal prejudices. He was keen on disclosing the defects of the Theosophical Society. He therefore wrote in free style many controversial articles on Mrs. Annie Besant reaching her antecedents in the columns of his paper.

The year 1917 formed a landmark in the history of the Justice party. It witnessed not only the birth of three journals started solely for advocating the cause of the Party but also a series of public meetings, conferences, lecturers and pamphlets both in English and vernacluars in order to wider the basis of the non-Brahmin movement. According to Dr.T.M.Nair, the non-Brahmins were entirely against the movement started by Mrs. Annie Besant for Home Rule obviously because they were not

ready for it. Dr.T.M.Nair came out with a great accusation against the Home Rulers. His personal life was a marvelous example of perfect social equality of all classes. He employed Panchamas to work in his house, and moved with them in a spirit of brotherhood and equality. Even before the Congres leaders like Gandhi spoke of the uplift of the depressed classes, Dr.T.M.Nair organized a forum for them and voiced their grievances. He firmly believed that without the Panchamas "taking their proper and right share in the governance of the country and in every sphere of national activity, the future of Indian was indeed gloomy. The same principle became one of the Justice party were criticized in bitting language by Desabhaktan, the organ of the Madras Presidency Association, which observed "those non-brahmin members are now deceiving the people by holding small conferences here and there under the presidency of a new zamindars who have no experience whatever of political work and passing certain resolutions".

The long waited mission of Montague representation came to Madrasin 1917. Montague found a very strange and unhappy situation in Madras. Though the non-Brahmin leaders of Madras Presidency met Montague in large numbers and submitted memoranda insisting on the necessity of granting communal representation to the non-Brahmins, they did not impress much. The only non-Brahmin leader who made a very strong impression on Montague was Dr.T.M.Nair. He made a forceful plea for communal representation arguing that it was indispensable for at least sometime till the preponderance of the Brahmins both in the field of politics and public services was removed. He cited his own case as an example of how he was defeated in the elections due to effective canvassing by the Brahmin officials including a High Court Judge against them.

The era of Dr.T.M.Nair which witnessed a steady and unstinted growth and development of the Justice party, forms a significant chapter in the history of non-Brahmin movement. Dr.Nair carried the banner of non-Brahmins far and wide. Under his able guidance and leadership the Justice party made rapid steps. Its ideology captured the imagination of even mute millions.

13.3 C.Natesa Mudaliar

C.Natesa Mudaliar was one of the founding fathers of South Indian Liberal Federation. Even before, he started the Dravidain Association in Madras. He was the man who first used the term Dravidian. The word Dravidian includes the people of Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam and Kannadam. He graduated in Telugu from the University of Madras. He was interested to become a Doctor. So he succefully completed his task.

In the British rule, only the higher caste people got the job opportunities in the Government sectors. Especilally the important positions were occupied by them. They equally enjoyed the rights with the British people. C.Natesa Mudaliar wanted to support the depressed community people. So he started the "Dravidian Association of Madras" in 1912 to promote the lower caste people.

His association was purely a service oriented one. Due to this he got the introduction of Tamil scholar Thiru.Vi.Kalyana Sundaram. There were regular meetings in the Dravidian Association of Madras. This association led to the establishment of Justice Party later. Dr. Natesa Mudaliar was also built a hostel namely "Dravidian Society Hostel" where he offered free board and lodging for the lower caste people. He was supported by othe non-Brahmin leaders P.Thiyagaraya Chetti and T.M.Nair. Due to his effort only the Justice party was emerged. He convened a large number of meetings for non-Brahmins. He spent his own money to arrange thiese meetings. After the death of P.Thiyagaraya Chetti and T.M.Nair, he successfully conducted the Justice party in an efficient manner.

In the 1920 Madras province elections, Dr.C.Natesa Mudaliar got the majority votes. Among the candidates of Madras Province, he received the largest votes. He became the member of Legislative Assembly for 1920-1925 and 1935-1937. He was the member of the Legislative Assembly till his death. He frequently raised questions for the welfare of the non-Brahmins in the Legislative Assembly. He debated in somany Bills of the Madars Legislative Assembly. They are, Indain Stamp Act, Bill for Temple Administration, Bill on Malabar Tenants Act. He was died on 8th February 1935. He worked hard for the downtrodden people throughout his life.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. Who was the editor of the "Justice"?
2. Which election Natesa Mudaliar got majority votes?

13.4 P.Thiyagaraya Chetti

Sir P.Thiyagaraya Chetti was born on April 27, 1852. He studied B.A. Degree in Presidency College. He became the leader of the Justice Party and he was the first non-official President of the Madras Corporation. In 1909 the title of Rao Bahadur was conferred to him. In January 1919, he had the title of "Diwan Bahadur". P.Thiyagaraya Chetti was a councilor of the Corporation for over forty years. When Justice Party came to power he was sixty eight years old. When in December 1920 the first Indian Ministry was formed out of the majority, H.E.Lord Willingdon under the powers of the Government of India Act of 1919 desired to nominate Sir P.Thiyagaraya Chetti as the Chief Minister. But he humbly declined to accept the honour, due to his old age, but suggested three names from among his party for His Excellency's consideration. As a result, A. Subbarayalu Reddiar was appointed Chief Minister. However P.Thiyagaraya Chetti influenced both the members of the legislature and the party. He selected the ministers for their party's Government. He directed the ministers in the important issues. He strongly fought for the disparities against the non-Brahmins.

Sir P.Thiyagaraya Chetti decisively believed that education is the remedy to eradicate the all social evils in the society. He founded an educational institution in Washermenpet in 1897 along with her elder brother. After passing through many fluctuations the institutions has now developed a first Grade College as a result of the support of the public. He also served as a member of the Board of Trustees of the Pachaiyappa's Charities for nearly half a century. He served actively to the cause of higher education. His portrait was exposed in the Pachaiyappa's College hall by the Governor of Madras to appreciate his service.

He played vital role in establishing the Justice Party. Dr. Natesa Mudaiar tried to bring out co-operation among the leaders who cared for the uplift of the prople in Madras state politics and social changes.

Dr.T.M.Nair expressed the necessity of the co-operation of all non-Brahmins forgetting their differences of opinion. P.Thiyagaraya Chetti , leading figure among non- Brahmins discussed with many influential non-Brahmin leaders for the establishment of a association for non-Brahmins. As a result of this P.Thiyagaraya Chetti organized South Indian Liberal Federation with thirty non-Brahmins at the Victoria hall in Madras on November 26, 1916. The aim of the organization was to promote the political interest on non-Brahmin cates Hindus. As the father of the Non-Brahmin Movement, his status had not only spread throughout India but also reached England.

As a President of the Reception Committee of the first non-Brahmin Confederation, P.Thiyagaraya Chetti addressed, "Towards the Brahmins, we cherish no feelings of bitterness. If we have to fight them we do so in the interests of truth and justice, and we shall be prepared to extend to them too the right hand of fellowship, when they shall see the wrongs inflicted upon us and repent. Ours is essentially a movement of love and not of hate, or love based upon a sense of what is due to the various classes which constitute the population of this vast and ancient land".

The non-Brahmin leaders were also formed the South Indian Peoples' Assoication. Sir P.Thiagaraya Chettiar was the first secretary of this association. Thiagaraya Chetty was elected the first President of the Justice Party and served as President until his death in 1925. Sir Thiyagaraya Chetti was died on 28th April in the year 1925 at the age of 73. In regonition of his meritorious service to the city for nearly forty years, the people of Madras in grateful memory created his statue near the main entrance to the Ripon building which is the house of Corporation of Madars.

Check Your Progress Questions

3. Which year Thiyagaraya Chetti earned the title Tiwan Bagadur?
4. Who was the first President of the Justice Party?
5. Where was Thiyagaraya founded an educational institution?

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13.5 Periyar E.V.R.

E.V.Ramasamy Naicker the founder of Self -Respect Movement. He was one of the great social reformers of the twentieth century. He fought against the caste discriminations, cultural domination of Brahmins, the enslavement of women and fought against superstitious beliefs. He advocated violent and radical change in all walks of life of the people.

E.V.Ramasamay Naicker was born on 17th September 1879 in Erode. His parents were Venkatappar and Chinnathai Ammal. He belomged to the Kannada Baliga Naidu caste and his parents are pious and orthodox. He gave up his studies at the age of ten and helped his father in business. He married at the age of nineteen. But he left his family life after six years. After renouncing his family life he went to Kasi, there he witnessed the ill-treatment of non-Brahmin by Brahmin. His faith in Hinduism was shaken when he found immoral acts of the Brahmin priests. As a result, he decided to devote himself to social reforms. He decided to free the Tamil society from the clutches of Brahmins.

His role in Congress

E.V.Ramasamy Naicker was attracted by Gandhian ideologies in his early life. He was elected to the Municipal Council of Erode and he became its Chairman. But he resigned his Chairmanship, in protest against the Jallian walabag Massacre in 1919. He gave his support to Magathma Gandhi and acted as a pioneer by cutting the Coconut trees in his garden. He led the Non Co-operation Movement successfully. He became the secretary of Madras Congress in 1921. Rajaji was attracted by the activities of E.V.Ramasamy. In 1922, he became the President of Madras Congress Committee. Though he was associated with Congress party he also opposed the domination of Brahmins in the party.

Hero of Vaikom

In Vaikom of Travancore state, the Scheduled castes people were not allowed to enter into the particular street. The regional leaders like, T.K.Maharan, George Joseph and K.P. Kesava Menon empathized with them and committed to fight for their rights. So a Sathyagraha was organized under the chairmanship of E.V.Ramasamy in 1924. He was arrested and released after six months. But the state of Travancore opened the street for the downtrodden people in Vaikom. So after this Vaikom

Sathyagraha, E.V. Ramasamy Naicker earned the title Vaikom Veerar or Hero of Vaikom.

In 1922, there was a Gurukulam started by V.V.S.Iyer in Cheranmadevi. It was functioned by the Madras Congress Committee. There were complaints against the Cheranmadevi Gurukulam because of the separate dining and separate water popts for the non-Brahmin students. E.V.Ramasamy strongly condemned this caste discrimination among the students and stopped fund from Congress to the Gurukulam. Gandhiji interfered in this issue but he couldnot solve this issue. In the Congress session of Kanchipuram, E.V.Ramasamy tried to bring a resolution for communal representation in the government services. The resolution was defeated due to lack of consensus. So E.V. Ramasamy left the Congress party and launched the Self - Respect Movement in 1925.

Self-Respect Movement of E.V.Ramasamy

The aim of Self-Respect Movement was to restore the non-Brahmins. It aimed to achieve the communal representation for the non-Brahmins in the State Legislature and Government services. This movement preached the pride of Dravidian past and vehemently opposed the Brahminical domination. It acted as non-political organization initially. He started a Tamil newspaper Kudi Arasu and Pakutharivu to spread his ideas and ideologies. He accused the Brahmins for creating a complicated social system and prevailing the untouchability. His movement aimed at creating equality between Brahmins and non-Brahmins and establishing a casteless society.

In 1934 E.V.Ramasamy presented a “Fourteen point programme” in a Justice party meeting, in which the communal representation was stressed on the basis of population and political aspirations of each community to secure the Government posts. The worthy call “Tamil Nadu for the Tamils” was first time voiced in 1937 by E.V.Ramasamy. It was an another landmark in the power struggle against the Brahmins.

Dravida Kazhagam

E.V.Ramasamy became a leader of Justice Party in 1937 and the activities of Self-Respect Movement was associated with it. The 16th confederation of the Justice Party was held on August 1944 at Salem. In this confederation, a resolution was passed to rename the Justice Party into

the Dravidar Kazhagam. Periyar E.V.Ramasamy announce August 15 1947 as a mourning day. C.N.Annadurai opposed his declaration. In 1949, a section of party men under the leadership of C.N.Annadurai, left the party due to the marriage of Periyar E.V.R with the young Maniammai after the death of his first wife.

His ideology

Periyar E.V.Ramasamy wrote many satirical essays in his journals like Kudiyarasu, Puratchi, Pakutharivu and Viduthalai. These journals carried the revolutionary articles of Periyar. He attacked the unnecessary rituals of Hinduism and the puranic literatures. He also opposed the Varnashrama theory on the ground that it reduced the caste Hindus to the position of the Sudras.

He spread the ideology for emancipation of women. Worked for the empowerment and securing their rights. Periyar E.V.Ramasamy created awareness in the Tamil society for equal educational and employment opportunities for women and worked for the equality of women with men. He vehemently condemned the practice of Devadasi system. He also condemned the practice of child marriage and advocated the widow remarriage. When Sarada Act was passed in the Central Legislature, he welcomed it as a right step for the liberation of women. He also stressed the need for property rights for women on par with men. In order to prevent the spread of Aryan culture, he organized Self -Respect marriages without the mangala suthra or tali. The Self -Respect marriages included the inter-caste marriage and widow remarriage.

Due to the untiring efforts of Periyar E.V.Ramasamy through his Sel-Respect Movement and Dravida Kazhagam the backward class people attained high position.

Check Your Progress Question

6. When did Periyar become the President of Madras Congress Committee?
7. Which year Vaikom Sathyagraha was held?
8. Who started the Cheranmadevi Gurukulam?

13.6 A.T.Panneerselvam

A.T.Panneerselvam was born on June 1st, 1888 at Selvapuram in Thanjavur District. He completed his B.A. Degree at St.Joseph College in Trichy. He also obtained Law Degree at Cambridge University, London and became a Barrister. He practiced at Gray's Inn in England. He returned from England to India in 1912. From the 1912 to 1913 he practiced Law at Madras. In 1913 he returned to Thanjavur due to his illness. He was the first Barrister in Thanjavur District. He had close relationship with the non-Brahmin leaders like sir. P.Thiyagaraya Chetti and Panagal Raja and others. He joined the Justice Party in 1912 and gradually he started his work for the welfare of the non-Brahmins.

He became the Chairman of Thanjavur Municipality from 1918 to 1920 for two terms. Due to his effort the financial position was increased lot. He worked hard for the improvement in education and sanitation in Thanjavur. He became a President of the District Educational Council till 1924. He took efforts to get education for the lower strata of the society and especially the non-Brahmins. For the first time in the history of Thanjavur Districtthe free education system was introduced by the District Educational Council from 1924 to 1930.

His service to non-Brahmins

A.T.Panneerselvam introduced many reforms in the educational system of Thanjavur district. In 1924 he introduced the compulsory elementary education in many areas of Thanjavur. In 1924 the schools and hostels were ocuupied by the Brahmin students. But A.T.Panneerselvam changed this condition and provided opportunities to the non-Brahmin and downdrodden people. He had taken able steps to open new hospitals in many places. He also took several measures for flood relief during his period. In 1927 Simon commission came to Thanjavur to attend the Thanjavur District Board meeting.They appreciated the services rendered by A.T.Panneerselvam to the district.so the British Government of India conferred the title of Rao Bahadur to A.T.Panneerselvam on 4th June 1928.

A.T.Panneerselvam had participated the Round Table conferences in London as representatives of Indian Christians. He advocated for the rights of minorities and the policies of the Justice Party. He compelled the British Government to introduce the Communal Award. According to this

Communal Award, representation was made to Muslims, Europeans, Sikhs, Indian Christians and Depressed Class people. In 1929 he contested the in the election gor Madras Legislative Council as the Justice Party candidate. He defeated the Congress candidate and functioned as a member of the Councill till 1934. He also served as a non-official member from 1934 to 1937. He always worked for the welfare of the non-Brahmins, Indian Christians and other depressed class people.

He encouraged the rural education, upliftment of the poor and equality of opportunity for the minorities. In the Madars Legislative Council, his role was an important one. In the interim ministry formed by the Justice Party, A.T.Panneerselvam was the minister of Home Affairs. But it concluded within six months. He sevearly opposed the compulsory Hindi policy introduced by the Rajaji Government. He highly condemned the Criminal Amendment Act introduced by the Rajaji. He also opposed the North Indian domination over the South. His works as a Local Administrator, Legislator, Home Minister, Opposition Party Leader had been recognized both by the public and as well as by the British Government of India.

Check Your Progress Questions

9. Which title was conferred to A.T.Pannerselvam?
10. Which year Panneerselvam became the member of Madras Legislative Council?

13.7 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. 1920
2. 1920 Madras Province Election
3. 1919
4. P.Thiyagaraya Chetti
5. Washermenpet
6. 1922
7. 1924
8. V.V.S.Iyer
9. Rao Bahadur
10. 1929

13.8 Summary

- Dr. T.M. Nair joined the Indian National Congress and ardently worked for it at the earlier stage of its growth.
- He palyed the leading part in organising the Non-Brahmin Movement.
- Dr.T.M.Nair organized a forum for the depressed classes and voiced their grievances.
- The only non-Brahmin leader who made a very strong impression on Montague was Dr.T.M.Nair.
- Dr.Nair carried the banner of non-Brahmins far and wide.
- C.Natesa Mudaliar was one of the founding fathers of South Indian Liberal Federation.
- C.Natesa Mudaliar wanted to support the depressed community people.
- So he started the "Dravidian Association of Madras" in 1912 to promote the lower caste people.
- He became the member of Legislative Assembly for 1920-1925 and 1935-1937.
- Sir P.Thiyagaraya Chetti was born on April 27, 1852.
- He became the leader of the Justice Party and he was the first non-official President of the Madras Corporation.
- Sir P.Thiyagaraya Chetti decisively believed that education is the remedy to eradicate the all social evils in the society.
- Thiagaraya Chetty was elected the first President of the Justice Party and served as President until his death in 1925.
- E.V.Ramasamy Naicker the founder of Self -Respect Movement.
- He was one of the great social reformers of the twentieth century.
- E.V.Ramasamay Naicker was born on 17th September 1879 in Erode.
- E.V.Ramasamy Naicker was attracted by Gandhian ideologies in his early life.
- The aim of Self-Respect Movement was to restore the non-Brahmins.

- It aimed to achieve the communal representation for the non-Brahmins in the State Legislature and Government services.
- E.V.Ramasamy became a leader of Justice Party in 1937 and the activities of Self-Respect Movement was associated with it
- E.V.Ramasamy strongly condemned this caste discrimination among the students and stopped fund from Congress to the Cheranmadevi Gurukulam.
- E.V. Ramasamy Naicker earned the title Vaikom Veerar or Hero of Vaikom in 1924.
- Periyar E.V.Ramasamy wrote many satirical essays in his journals like Kudiyarasu, Puratchi, Pakutharivu and Viduthalai.
- A.T.Panneerselvam was born on June 1st, 1888 at Selvapuram in Thanjavur District.
- He encouraged the rural education, upliftment of the poor and equality of opportunity for the minorities.
- A.T.Panneerselvam had participated the Round Table conferences in London as representatives of Indian Christians.
- He was functioned as a member of the Madras Legislative Councill till 1934.

13.9 Key words

- Gurukulam - A gurukula or gurukulam was a type of education system in ancient India with students living near or with the guru, in the same house.
- Puratchi- Revolution
- Pakutharivu- Rational thinking

13.10 Self Assessment Questions

Short answer Questions

1. What do you know about the role of T.M.Nair in Justice Party?
2. What are the works of C.Natesa Mudaliar?
3. Wirte a note on Self-Respect Movement.
4. Discuss the services of A.T.Pannerselvam to non-Brahmins.

Lomg Answer Questions

1. Describe the contribution of P.Thiyagaraya Chetti to Tamil society.
2. Analyze the contribution of Periyar E.V.Ramasamy in awakening the Tamil people.

13.11 Further Readings

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Unit XIV Ramasami Mudaliar- Raja of Bobbili

14.0 Introduction
14.1 Objectives
14.2 Ramasamy Mudaliar
14.3 Raja of Bobbili
14.4 Raja of Panagal
14.5 Soundara Pandian
14.6 Annamalai Chettiar
14.7 Answers to check your progress questions
14.8 Summary
14.9 Key words
14.10 Self Assessment Questions
14.11 Further Readings

14.0 Introduction

Sir A.Ramasamy Mudaliar was a notable person in politics and also a great administrator. He served actively as a secretary in the Justice Party. He was the key person in the justice Party. He framed the principles of the party along with the other non-Brahmin leaders. For this reason he had been described as the "brain of the Justice party". Like him, Raja of Bobbili was also an important leader of Justice Party. Raja of Bobbili became the Chief Minister of Madras Presidency in 1932. Raja of Panagal or P.Ramarayaningar was also one of the prominent leaders of Justice Party. The British officials praised many times because of the administration of Raja of Panagal.

14.1 Objectives

After going through this unit, you will be able to:

- Learn the part of Ramasamy Mudaliar in the Justice Party
- Describe the services of Raja of Bobbili and Panagal
- Explain the works of Soundara Pandian
- Understand the role of Annamalai Chettiyar to education and Tamil isai.

14.2 Ramasamy Mudaliyar

Ramasamy Mudaliar was born on 14th October 1887 at Arcot. He was graduated from is the Christian College, Chennai and also got his Law at Madras Law College. He became a secretary of the Justice Party. Ramasamy Mudaliar worked hard for the rapid growth of the party. He was an authoritative spokes person of the party. So he theorized every aspect of the non-Brahmin ideology. Ramasamy Mudaliar organized the first All Indian Non-Brahmin Congress in 1924. He added new dimensions to his party. When the party after its setback in 1926 elections was desperately in search of an editor for its organ Justice, Ramasamy Mudaliar came forward to shoulder the burden of running that democratic daily. After his charge as an editorship of the daily, its popularity rose high and the circulation of the paper also increased.

He performed as an editor over ten years. His satirical writings made him as the pillar of his party. Bramins were his main attack in his writings. He secured as a Parliamentary secretary for the provincial education minister between 1921 and 1923. He had been elected to the Upper House of the State Legislature during 1923 to 1926. He was the Mayor of Madras for three years from 1928 to 1930. He played vital role in preparing the report to be submitted to the Simon Commission by the South Indian Welfare Society. Ramasamy Mudaliar became a member of Rajya Sabha in 1930 and in 1931 he became a member of Delhi Central Assembly.

He attended the Round Table Conference at London as a representative of Justice Party. He delivered the key note address in the Self-Respect Movement conference held at Chengalpat in 1929. He opened the Portrait of Raja of Panagal in this conference. He served as a member in so many committees during the British rule. He was appreciated for his efficiency in all his duties. Later he was incharge for led the participants to the British Common Wealth Relation Committee conference held at England. He was also appointed as a member in the war committee by Wiston Churchil during the time of Second World War. He served as the Vice- Chancellor of the Trivancore and Kerala Universities. From 1946 to 1949 he was a Diwan of Mysore province.

In 1945, he had the Indian delegates to the U.N.Conference at San Francisco. He was one of the notable learned who framed the U.N. princilpes. Many Indian Universities and some of the foreign Universities were honoured him and awarded Honorary Doctorate Degrees.

14.3 Raja of Bobbili

Raja of Bobbili was the important leader of the Justice Party. Raja of Bobbili was the president of the Twelfth Annual Confederation of the Justice Party in 1932. There was a difference of opinion with Munusamy Naidu and Raja of Bobbili in this group. Naidu resigned his Chiefministership and it was accepted by the Governor on 5 November 1932. The Raja of Bobbili was appointed as Chief Minister. The ascendancy of the Raja of Bobbili to the position of the chief Ministership stunned his political opponents who went on issuning to press statements everyday in critical tone in order to dull the name of the party and its leader. He had tough time to bring round the various factions of the party.

Under his leadership, the party organization had not made any progress but disappeared still further. It had only risky survival. The party, which had been rocked by internal wrangles lost its image. His aristocratic posture was often mistaken as autocratic one. Though efficient administration he was inaccessible to his party men. He was the last of the Romans short underwhose leadership the Justice Party hastened to a fall.

During his period, the Madras Estates Land (Amendment) Act, also known as Inams Act was enacted in 1934. This Act provided the right of kudivaram on Inam tenants. Kudivaram means the share of the tenant. There were five million of tenants in five thousand Inam villages through out the Presidency. The Madras Elementary Education Act was revised two times during his period as Chief Minister. The first amendment was made in in 1934. It was made to enhance the source of elementary education fund. The second amendment was made in 1935 and it declared the elementary education was compulsory for boys and girls of particular age. Raja of Bobbili followed the all kinds of unethical practices to remain in his position and fortify his followers. He eliminated some temple committees. The Chief Minister appointed commissioners, who were unfriendly to the Congress in their municipalities. He abolished certain

Municipalities when he lost all faiths to increase control over them. The Raja of Bobbili also implemented all types of wrong methods.

Madras Legislative Assembly elections were held in 1937. Justice Party won 21 seats out of 215 assembly seats. The Congress secured the159 seats among the 215. Raja of Bobbili was defeated in this election and his hold over Justice Party untied. Finally he discharged from politics.

The aristocratic attitude of the Raja dictaional Bobbili created a gulf between the leader and followers. He impose his will over every person he deals with his loyal followers in the party or the long connected colleagues in the cabinet. He overbearing and autocratic alienated many of the sympathizers of the Justice party. In order to stabilize his position and power. He adopted all sorts of political plots which very much criticized by papers like "Sunday Chronicle". It highlighted the issue in a leading article entitled "Bobbilism at work". It was unfortunate that political opportunitism became his creed.

Check Your Progress Questions

1. Who organized first All Indian Non-Brahmin Congress?
2. Which Round Table Conference was attended by Ramasamy Mudaliar?

14.4 Raja of Panagal

Raja of Panagal was born on July 9th 1866 at Kalahasthi of Andhrapradesh. His original name was P.Ramarayaningar and he belonged to a aristocrat family. He finished his school education in Hindu High school and did his degree in Madras Presidency College. He was wellversed in Sanskrit language and literature. Raja of Panagal joined in the Justice party and he had been elected for the parliament. He was a great thinker and orator. His oratoty skill was appreciated by Viceroy Lord Hardinge. He was branded by the Brahmins as communalist. The spectacular achievements of the Justice Party in the initial years of diarchy were solely due to his efficiency. During his period Sanskrit is compulsory for students to join in the medical colleges. Raja of Panagal formed committees to select the students on the basis of the socio-economic background. It paved the way for the non-Brahmin students to enter into

the colleges easily. Due to his effort the depressed community people like Panchamar and Paraiyar were given the status as Adidravidas legally. He also brought some changes in the education department. Andhra University was opened during his period and the foundation was laid for the famous Annamalai University.

Raja of Panagal was appreciated many times by the British officials because of his administrative capacity. Responsibility, bravery, enthusiasm, honesty, creative power and showing respect to others. Though he was born in royal family he faced many hardships in his life. He delivered his services in efficient manner not only to the party but also to the government. He always wore blue turban. So he was called as "Blue Turban King". The Raja of Panagal was interested to know the siddha system of medicine. So he appointed a committee to make a thorough study of the problems relating to the system of Indian medicine. The outcome was the founding of the school of Indian Medicine by the Raja of Panagal. He provided many facilities for extensive research in Ayurveda, Siddha and Unani systems. The village reconstruction was one of the task personally undertaken by the Raja of Panagal. During his period many acts were enacted such as Madras University Act, Hindu Religions Endowments Act which earned immense appreciation. The Justice Party was reached its peak during the rule of Raja of Panagal.

He was successfully tackled with a social evil which has defined the efforts of many statesman in the past century. He found that huge amounts of money contributed to the service of God and humanity, were being diverted to scarcely useful and respectable purposes and he took to his heart to stop thuis dangerous and in human practice. Essentially a conservative by instinct and training he showed remarkable ability to perceive the trend of the popular upheaval in our province no less in social than in political matters and he showed supreme strategy and great ability in maintaining the influence and integrity of his party.when the leadership fell on him after the death of P.Thiyagaraya Chetti a few years ago. In many respects he was a difference to the other leader who was frank, outspoken and passionate in his life and conduct. The Rajah was on the other hand, always reserved and restrained tactful and polished to a degree

and his courtesy and consideration to friend and opponents alike has always been marked. The Raja of Panagal died on 15th December 1928 at the age of 62. Panagal Park and Panagal Palace are named after him.

14.5 Soundara Pandian

W.P.A. Soundara Pandian was born in a Nadar family of Pattiveeranpatty on 15th September 1893. He possessed coffee estates in Kodaikkanal. Soundara Pandian was a important person in the Nadar Mahajana Sangam. He was worked for the promotion and welfare of the Nadar community due to his political and economic participations. He became a member of the Madras Legislative Council from 1920 to 1937. He actively involved in the non-Brahmin movement and struggled for the rights of Nadars and the non-Brahmins. He was a noticeable member of the Periyar E.V. Ramasamy's Dravidian movement for transforming the society. For the appreciation of his social activities, a statue was raised for him the Pandi Bazar in Chennai.

The Justice Party became more powerful due to the tireless services of the non-Brhamin leaders like W.P.A.Soundara Pandian. Due to its own ideologies, methods with the support of renowned and important men and women of that period it was made a prominent party. The people of Tamil Nadu easily adopted the principles of the Justice Party due to its adoptability. The party performed its duties sharply with all intensity for the welfare of the people in all possible ways by using all its powers.

W.P.A. Soundara Pandian played vital role in the Self-respect movement, which was originated in the year 1925. So, Periyar nominated him as the leader of the first conference of the Self-respect movement at Chengelpet on February 17th, 1929. He presided over the conventions. The convention approved a resolution accusing the Vedas, Shastras, Puranas and religion for the lawfulness they supported to the varnashrama theory or the caste system. The rights of women, right to property and right to work were also proposed by in this convention.

W.P.A. Soundara Pandiyan was nominated by the Justice Party as the member of the Legislative Council. Due to this nomination the Nadar sangam went to closer to the Justice Party. After this, many members from the Nadar Sangam were joined into the Justice Party. W.P.A.Soundara

Pandian Nadar gave his voice for the welfare of the nadars in the Legislative Council. He became prominent leader in the Justice party. He also concentrated on the upliftment of the depressed classes. He structured lot of conferences for depressed class people. He provided the opportunity to them to travel in the buses. He also delivered amenities for the depressed class people to join in the educational institutions. So he had been emerged as the leader of the depressed classes.

In 1937, compulsory Hindi education was introduced by the Congress ministry under Rajaji. This infuriated the Tamil militants. Self-Respect movement decided to oppose the compulsory education of Hindi in Madras province. So Periyar started the anti-Hindi campaign and W.P.A.Soundara Pandian was the frontrunner of anti-Hindi agitations. The Justice Party formed a boycott committee in 1938 against this. The leaders of the Justice Party gathered huge amount of money for this protest. W.P.A. Soundara Pandian contributed much for this protest. W.P.A. Soundara Pandian rendered the valuable service to the Self-Respect movement and the Justice Party throughout his life. He was appreciated for his voice for the depressed classes also. He was died on February 22, 1953.

Check Your Progress Questions

3. In which title Raaja of Panagal was called?
4. Which year Soundara Pandian was the President of Self Respect Movement conference?

14.6 Annamalai Chettiar

Dr. Raja Sir Annamalai Chettiar was the forefather and Pro-Chancellor of the Annamalai University. He was born in Kanadukathan in chettinad on 30th September, 1881. He completed his schooling at Kanadukathan and Karur. After his studies, Annamalai Chettiar dedicated himself to the development of his business. He traveled Ceylon, Burma and the Far East and obtained first hand information of his organizations.

He was functioned as the Chairman of the Karaikudi Union and he took his chairmanship seriously. He enhanced the town during his tenure. He fulfilled the needs of the public and he was a member of numerous local organizations and of the District Board. The Viceroy conferred on

him the title of "Rao Bahadur" for the appreciation of his service to the public. He was selected to the Madars Legislative Council and he served from 1916 to 1920. He grabbed himself seriously in his new responsibility. He was one of the originatos of the Indian Bank and he played the leading role in the Directorate for many years. His efficiency to progress the banking and finance directed to his appointment as a Governor of the Imperial Bank of India when it was organised in 1921. He was associated with the Bank as Director till the end of his life. He established the Sri Meenakshi College at Chidambaram. In 1927, Annamalai Chettiar established a Sanskirt College and also a Tamil College at Chidambaram. It was regarded as his first note worthy step in the field of education.

Contribution to the society

Annamalai chettiar contributed liberally to many praise worthy and noble causes. He constructed the women and children's Hospital at Kanadukathan. He was donated liberally to many educational institutions. He was influenced that education was the most significance and progressive influence in affecting social transformation. His customary generosity and his humanitarian amenities won him impulsive appreciations everywhere. In acknowledgement of his illustrious services, the British Government conferred on Annamalai Chettiar the hereditary title of Raja of Chettinad in 1929.

His service to education

Annamali Chettiar prepared proper applications to Government for establishment of a University in Chidambaram in 1928. He presented to make over the Sri Meenakshi and other colleges which he had possessed with all the enclosed hostels, staff quarters and other belongings to the planned University, and also make a donation of twenty lakhs of rupees. The Annamalai University Act came into force on 1st January 1929. Annamalai Chettiar was functioned as Pro-Chancellor for nineteen years, he gave all his care and devotion to the progress of the University.

He constructed numerous buildings for class rooms, Departments, residential quarters and guest houses for this University. He was very intense to improve the University as centre of Tamil language and culture. He firmly believed that it is his duty to preserve and revive the Tamil

culture and Tamil learning. He also established Tamil Isai Movement. He encouraged research in Tamil music and also in science and Technolgy. The Faculty of Engineering and Technology was started in 1945 as the second Engineering Faculty in the state. He had the happiness on seeing the University extending its activities and effectiveness in several directions.

Check Your Progress Questions

5. Which title was given to Annamalai Chettiyar?
6. When did Annamalai University establish?

14.7 Answers to Check Your Progress Questions

1. Ramasamy Mudaliar
2. Second
3. Blue Turban King
4. 1929
5. Rao Bahadur
6. 1929

14.8 Summary

- Sir A.Ramasamy Mudaliar was a notable person in politics and also a great administrator.
- He served actively as a secretary in the Justice Party.
- Ramasamy Mudaliar organized the first All Indian Non-Brahmin Congress in 1924.
- He attended the Round Table Conference at London as a representative of Justice Party.
- From 1946 to 1949 he was a Diwan of Mysore province.
- Raja of Bobbili was the important leader of the Justice Party.
- Raja of Bobbili was the president of the Twelfth Annual Confederation of the Justice Party in 1932.
- During his period, the Madras Estates Land (Amendment) Act, also known as Inams Act was enacted in 1934.
- The Madras Elementary Education Act was revised two times during his period as Chief Minister.
- He eliminated some temple committees.

- Raja of Bobbili followed the all kinds of unethical practices to remain in his position.
- Under his leadership, the party organization had not made any progress but disappeared still further.
- Raja of Panagal was born on July 9th 1866 at Kalahasthi of Andhrapradesh.
- Raja of Panagal formed committees to select the students on the basis of the socio-economic background.
- Andhra University was opened during his period and the foundation was laid for the famous Annamalai University.
- The village reconstruction was one of the task personally undertaken by the Raja of Panagal.
- He always wore blue turban. So he was called as "Blue Turban King".
- W.P.A. Soundara Pandian was born in a Nadar family of Pattiveeranpatty on 15th September 1893.
- W.P.A. Soundara Pandian played vital role in the Self-respect movement.
- W.P.A. Soundara Pandiyan was nominated by the Justice Party as the member of the Legislative Council.
- Periyar nominated him as the leader of the first conference of the Self-respect movement at Chengelpet on February 17th, 1929.
- He was appreciated for his voice for the depressed classes also.
- Dr. Raja Sir Annamalai Chettiar was the founder of the Annamalai University.
- The Viceroy conferred on him the title of "Rao Bahadur" for the appreciation of his service to the public.
- In 1927, Annamalai Chettiar established a Sanskirt College and also a Tamil College at Chidambaram.
- The Annamalai University Act came into force on 1st January 1929.
- Annamalai Chettiar was functioned as Pro-Chancellor for nineteen years.
- He also established Tamil Isai Movement.

14.9 Key words

- Kudivaram - the share of the tenant.
- Turban - a man's head covering consisting of a long length of material wound around a cap or the head.
- Diwan - Diwan designated a powerful government official.

14.10 Self Assessment Questions

Short Answer Questions

1. What do you know about the functions of Ramasamy Mudaliar?
2. Write a short note on Bobbili Raja.
3. Write about the works of soundara Pandian.

Long Answer Questions

1. Describe the achievements of Raja of Panagal.
2. Analyze the contribution of Annamalai Chettiar to education.

14.11 Further Readings

Pillai.K.K., A Social History of the Tamils, Volume 1, Chennai : University of Madras, 1975

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Manoranjithamoni.C, History of Tamil Nadu Upto 1565 A.D., Tirunelveli : Dave-Beryl Publications, 2018

Varghese Jeyaraj. S, Socio-Economic History of Tamil Nadu 1565-1967, Uthamapalayam: Anns Publications, 2017

Paramarthalingam. C, Religion and Social Reform in Tamil Nadu, Madurai: Rajakumari Publications, 1997

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INTELLECTUAL HISTORY OF TAMIL NADU

Course Code - 32142

Time : 3 Hours Maximum : 75 marks

Part- A (10x2= 20 marks)

Answer All Questions

1. What do you know about Nedunalvadai?
2. How many chapters are in Thirukkural?
3. Who established the Pure Tamil Movement?
4. What is the importance of Second World Tamil Conference?
5. Define- Devadasi system.
6. Name the journals worked by Bharathiyar.
7. Who compiled the Devaram and Nalayira Dhivya Prapantham?
8. Who were the founders of Justice Party?
9. Why Periyar E.V.R. was called as Hero of Vaikom?
10. Who started the Tamil Isai Movement?

Part – B (5x5=25 marks)

Answer All questions choosing either (a) or (b)

11.a. Write a short note on Thol Kappiyam. (or)

b. Discuss the social thoughts of Elangi Adikal.

12. a. What are the works of Maramalai Adikal to Tamil literature? (or)

b. List out the World Tamil Conferences.

13. a. Mention about the religious thoughts of Vaikunda Swamigal. (or)

b. What are the social services rendered by Dr.Muthulakshmi Reddy?

14. a. Write about the features of Thirumantiram of Thirumular. (or)

b. Explain the contribution of G.U.Pope to tamil literature.

15. a. Describe the functions of Self-Respect Movement. (or)

b. Write a short note on Annamalai University.

Part – C (3x10=30 marks)

Answer any Three of the following Questions

16. Write an essay about the salient features of Thirukkural.
17. Anlyze the social and religious reforms of Vallalar.
18. Evaluate the role of Bharathiyar to the freedom movement and for the growth of Tamil literature.
19. Assess the intellectual contributions of religious saints.
20. Describe the role of Periyar in reforming the Tamil society.